



TUYỂN TẬP 5 ĐỀ THI B1 B2

NỘI DUNG CHÍNH

Giới thiệu cơ bản về kì thi B1 B2 và một số bài mẫu để
thi sinh làm quen

Sưu tầm và biên tập

Lê Thanh Tú Nhân

Thân tặng

.....

LỜI MỞ ĐẦU

"Hiện nay, người người, nhà nhà cần chứng chỉ Tiếng Anh để nâng cao trình độ, nâng hạng, nâng ngạch hay để thi đầu ra các trường Đại học, đầu vào thạc sĩ, tiến sĩ ... Với các bạn học IELTS, TOEIC thì tài liệu trên thị trường rất phong phú, người học có nhiều sự lựa chọn để tham khảo. Tuy nhiên khi nhắc đến chứng chỉ loại 6 bậc của Việt Nam theo khung tham chiếu Châu Âu, dạng VSTEP thì lại vô cùng hiếm hoi. Ngay cả tại các trường tổ chức dạng thi này như Đại học Ngoại Ngữ - Đại học Quốc gia Hà Nội, Đại học Sư phạm HCM, Đại học Ngoại ngữ Đà Nẵng cũng gần như không thấy. Nguyên nhân chính là do đề thi các trường Đại học ở Việt Nam tự thiết kế, trong khi sách ngoại ngữ đa phần là sách nước ngoài.

Để đáp ứng nhu cầu của các bạn tự học ở nhà, đội ngũ tác giả là giảng viên các trường Đại học Ngoại Ngữ, chuyên thiết kế dạng đề thi VSTEP và đã có nhiều năm kinh nghiệm luyện đề đã biên tập nên 7 bài Tests với đáp án được làm kĩ công, đặc biệt là phần viết phù hợp với trình độ của từng người. Hi vọng góp phần vào quá trình ôn luyện của các bạn ôn thi VSTEP B1 B2 C1"

Trích dẫn lời tựa từ nhóm tác giả tại Hà Nội, 3/2019

P/S: Qua quá trình tham khảo và giải đề trong sách, tôi thấy đây quả là tài liệu bổ ích cho cả các bạn thi B1 B2 C1 ở Huế, Đà Nẵng nên đã sử dụng một số bài tập làm mẫu cho các bạn học viên trên lớp. Thiết nghĩ đây là một tài liệu giá trị nên tôi chia sẻ rộng rãi tới các bạn học viên của mình với mong muốn giúp các bạn có một nguồn tài liệu đủ độ tin cậy cao để tham khảo trong quá trình tự học thêm ở nhà. Tuy nhiên, hiện đề thi ở Huế và Đà Nẵng những năm gần đây đã có những thay đổi, cá nhân tôi là một người dạy có một chút kinh nghiệm trong việc luyện thi cho các bạn học viên thi ở miền Trung, nên tôi có biên tập lại phần đề viết và đề nói kèm các bài giải mẫu để các bạn có tài liệu chính xác hơn khi học và thi tại các đơn vị này, phần reading và listening tôi vẫn giữ nội dung tài liệu gốc từ Hà Nội vì sự tôn trọng với nhóm tác giả.

Một lần nữa xin cảm ơn nhóm thầy cô biên tập và chúc các bạn học viên có một đợt thi thành công sau khi tham khảo tài liệu bổ ích này.

Lê Thanh Tú Nhân

thaynhantienganh@gmail.com

0906 535 797 - Fb.com/lethanhtunhan.

MỘT SỐ CÂU HỎI CƠ BẢN VỀ BÀI THI VSTEP

1. VSTEP là gì?

VSTEP (Vietnamese Standardized Test Of English Proficiency) là kỳ thi đánh giá năng lực tiếng Anh theo Khung năng lực ngoại ngữ 6 bậc (áp dụng tại Châu Âu) dùng cho Việt Nam (tương đương với trình độ A1, A2, B1, B2, C1, C2)

2. Dạng thi này dành cho đối tượng nào?

Hiện nay bài thi VSTEP là định dạng chuẩn áp dụng rộng rãi ở Việt Nam cho nhiều đối tượng:

- Sinh viên các trường ĐH yêu cầu đầu ra để xét tốt nghiệp, vd: sv Đại học Sư Phạm đầu ra là B1, sv Bách Khoa, Kinh Tế một số ngành chất lượng cao đầu ra B2, sv Đại học Ngoại ngữ chuyên ngành Tiếng Anh đầu ra C1
- Học viên chuẩn bị thi đầu vào hoặc đầu ra Thạc sĩ, Nghiên cứu sinh
- Công viên chức nhà nước chuẩn bị xét nâng ngạch, nâng hạng, chuyên viên chính
- Giáo viên tiếng Anh các trường, từ Tiểu học, Trung học, Đại học
- Hướng dẫn viên du lịch
- Một số đối tượng khác có thể được bổ sung sau này...
-

3. Bài thi VSTEP có định dạng và cách tính điểm như thế nào?

Bài thi VSTEP bao gồm 4 kỹ năng tương tự các kì thi phổ biến trên thế giới như IELTS, TOEIC 4 skills: Listening, Reading, Speaking, and Writing

- Kỹ năng Listening gồm 3 phần: Part 1, Part 2. Part 3 với 35 câu hỏi trắc nghiệm
- Kỹ năng Reading gồm 4 bài đọc hiểu: passage 1, 2,3,4 với 40 câu hỏi trắc nghiệm
- Kỹ năng Writing gồm 2 bài:
 - ✓ Task 1 - Email (Viết thư)
 - ✓ Task 2 - Essay (Viết luận)
- Kỹ năng Speaking gồm 3 phần:
 - ✓ Part 1 - Social Interaction (trả lời câu hỏi về bản thân hình thức vấn đáp)
 - ✓ Part 2 - Solution Discussion (giải quyết một tình huống thường hàng)
 - ✓ Part 3 – Topic Development (phát triển chuyên sâu một chủ đề)

Điểm của bài thi được tính là trung bình cộng của 4 kỹ năng, tính trên thang điểm 10, có làm tròn. Dạng thi này không có điểm liệt.

Mức điểm 4-5 sẽ tương ứng với trình độ **B1**

Mức điểm 6-8 sẽ tương ứng với trình độ **B2**

Mức điểm ≥ 8.5 sẽ tương ứng với trình độ **C1**

Ví dụ điểm của thí sinh A như sau: Listening: 3 điểm, Reading: 5 điểm, Writing: 3 điểm, Speaking: 4 điểm. Trung bình cộng của 4 kỹ năng này là 3.75 sẽ được làm tròn lên 4. Như vậy thí sinh A này qua cấp độ B1. Các thí sinh đăng kí thi ở trình độ B1 B2 C1 sẽ thi đề giống nhau.

* **Chú ý:** Tuy thực tế dạng bài thi không tính điểm liệt nhưng nếu bạn có kết quả rất thấp trong một phần thi, khả năng rất lớn điểm số trung bình 4 phần thi của bạn sẽ không đạt yêu cầu. Hiện tại bài thi để cấp chứng chỉ hầu hết đã được các đơn vị tổ chức dưới hình thức thi

trên máy tính với sự khách quan rất cao, nhằm đánh giá khả năng Tiếng Anh chính xác của người học nên lời khuyên cho mọi thí sinh là bạn cần phải có sự chuẩn bị kỹ càng về kiến thức (học từ vựng, cấu trúc, phát âm) và đặc biệt là về kỹ năng dùng Tiếng Anh (biết giao tiếp, nghe, đọc tài liệu, viết luận, thư) bằng cách luyện tập đều đặn để tự tin hơn khi bước vào phòng thi.

4. Các đơn vị nào tổ chức dạng VSTEP này?

Hiện tất cả các trường ĐH được Bộ Giáo dục cấp phép thi đánh giá năng lực ngoại ngữ tiếng Anh có thể tổ chức thi, kì thi thường được tổ chức hàng tháng, danh sách đơn vị có thể đã thay đổi tùy theo thời điểm (các bạn có thể dễ dàng tra cứu trên google để đăng kí thi tại đơn vị gần nhất).

- o ĐH Ngoại Ngữ - ĐH Quốc Gia
- o ĐH Hà Nội
- o ĐH SP HCM
- o ĐH Ngoại ngữ Huế
- o ĐH Ngoại ngữ Đà Nẵng

Thí sinh theo dõi lịch thi trên website và page chính thức của đơn vị tổ chức, có thể đăng kí thi online nhưng khuyến khích các bạn nên đến đăng kí thi trực tiếp tại đơn vị tổ chức thi ở địa phương của bạn nếu có. Nếu bạn ở Đà Nẵng, ghé văn phòng Đại học ngoại ngữ Đà Nẵng tại 131 Lương Nhữ Hộc để đăng kí. Nếu các bạn đăng kí và thi đạt, sẽ được cấp chứng nhận như hình bên dưới (hình ảnh cung cấp bởi 1 bạn cựu học viên mình hướng dẫn, FB: **My Nhu**)



MỤC LỤC

Test 1:	Trang 6
Test 2:	Trang 20
Test 3:	Trang 34
Test 4:	Trang 46
Test 5:	Trang 58
Tapescript:	Trang 71
Key Test 1:	Trang 94
Key Test 2:	Trang 100
Key Test 3:	Trang 106
Key Test 4:	Trang 113
Key Test 5:	Trang 119

TEST 1

A: LISTENING

Directions: This is the listening test for levels from 3 to 5 of the Vietnam's 6-level Language Proficiency Test. There are three parts to the test. You will hear each part once. For each part of the test there will be time for you to look through the questions and time for you to check your answers. Write your answers on the question paper. You will have 5 minutes at the end of the test to transfer your answers onto the answer sheet.

PART 1

There are eight questions in this part. For each question there are four options and a short recording. For each question, choose the correct answer A, B, C or D. You now have 45 seconds to look through the questions and the options in each question.

1. When is the man's appointment?

- A. Wednesday B. Thursday C. Friday D. Tuesday

2. Which is the aunt's postcard?

- A. a pretty village right by the sea B. big trees
C. a pretty village behind the tall trees D. a pretty village on the hills

3. What time will the plane to Milan leave?

- A. 01:00 B. 07:15 C. 08:15 D. 06:15

4. Which present has the girl bought her mother?

- A. earrings B. music CD C. pen D. notebook

5. What time will the pie be ready?

- A. four fifteen B. five o'clock C. twenty past five D. fifty past four

6. What time is the swimming lesson today?

- A. half past four B. fifteen to five C. fifteen past five D. four thirty

7. Which subject does the boy like best?

- A. information technology B. geography C. sports D. design

8. Which T-shirt does the boy decide to buy?

- A. a short-sleeved T-shirt with round neck B. a V-neck black T-shirt
C. a long-sleeved T-shirt D. a sleeveless white T-shirt

PART 2

You will hear three different conversations. In each conversation there are four questions. For each question, choose the correct answer A, B, C or D. You will hear the conversations only once.

Conversation 1. You will hear a conversation between a girl, Kate, and a boy, George.

9. What is Kate's health problem?

- | | |
|----------------------|-------------------------|
| A. She has coughs | B. She has headache |
| C. She has toothache | D. She has stomach ache |

10. What does Kate's problem affect her classmates?

- | | |
|-------------------------|---------------------------|
| A. It makes them funny. | B. It makes them annoyed. |
| C. It makes them happy. | D. It makes them excited. |

11. What did Kate have last year?

- | | |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------|
| A. She had coughs | B. She had headache |
| C. She had a fall off her bike | D. She had stomach ache |

12. What does Kate have now, too?

- | | |
|----------------------|------------------------|
| A. She has backache | B. She has headache |
| C. She has toothache | D. She has temperature |

Conversation 2. You will hear a conversation between a man and a woman at home.

13. Why does the man want to go out?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A. Because he feels bored staying at home. | B. Because he feels safe staying at home. |
| C. Because he feels cold staying at home. | D. Because he feels hot staying at home. |

14. Why does the woman want to stay at home?

- | | |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| A. Because she has coughs. | B. Because she feels tired. |
| C. Because she has toothache. | D. Because she has stomach ache. |

15. Why doesn't the woman want to watch an Italian film?

- | |
|---|
| A. Because she is short of money. |
| B. Because she is serious about it. |
| C. Because she's afraid she will fall asleep watching it. |
| D. Because she has stomach ache |

16. Why doesn't the woman want to watch a Robert de Niro?

- | |
|--|
| A. Because she feels too busy to watch it. |
| B. Because she feels too serious to watch it. |
| C. Because she doesn't want to watch it the third time. |
| D. Because she doesn't want to watch it the second time. |

Conversation 3. You will hear a conversation between a girl, Lisa, and a boy, Ben, about holidays.

17. What does the girl think about a good holiday?

- | | |
|-------------------------|------------------------------|
| A. It may be cheap. | B. It may be very cheap. |
| C. It may be expensive. | D. It may be very expensive. |

18. Why doesn't the boy want to walk?

- | |
|---------------------------------------|
| A. Because he feels too hot to do it. |
| B. Because he finds it hard to do it. |
| C. Because he doesn't like hard work. |

D. Because she doesn't like the sounds of people walking.

19. What does the girl think about the food in Youth Hostels?

- A. It is comfortable.
- B. It is good.
- C. It is not good.
- D. It is clean and cheap.

20. What does the boy decide to do in the end?

- A. go home
- B. leave home
- C. sell his home
- D. enjoy his holiday home

PART 3

You will hear three different talks or lectures. In each talk or lecture there are five questions. For each question, choose the correct answer A, B, C or D. You will hear the talks or lectures only once.

Talk/Lecture 1. You will hear a girl talking about her life since she left Vietnam.

21. Why did the speaker have to help her mother with the shopping?

- A. There were no Vietnamese people living near her.
- B. There were no Vietnamese working in the stores.
- C. There wasn't always someone to go shopping with her.
- D. Her mother could speak a little English.

22. Why did her father find working in a factory difficult?

- A. He couldn't speak any English.
- B. He didn't have many friends there.
- C. He had had a much better job in Vietnam.
- D. He couldn't get used to the working style.

23. Why are the speaker and her brother more fortunate than their sisters?

- A. They did not need extra English lessons.
- B. They look more American.
- C. They speak with American accents.
- D. They quickly adopted the way of life.

24. What has the speaker forgotten about life in Vietnam?

- A. Living close to other people
- B. The warm weather
- C. Wearing traditional clothes
- D. Traditional food

25. Why does she find it difficult to invite friends to her home?

- A. Her parents do not have much money.
- B. Her parents haven't adopted an American way of life.
- C. Her parents only know how to cook Vietnamese food.
- D. Her parents do not speak English well.

Talk/Lecture 2. Listen to a woman talking about boys and girls in American schools.

26. What happened in American schools before 1972?

- A. Girls didn't go to school.
- B. Every classroom was a mix of boys and girls.
- C. Boys could learn what they wanted.
- D. They didn't teach girls some subjects.

27. What is the reason that most American schools have mixed classes?

- A. Scientists said that it was the best thing.
- B. Teachers did not want to teach single-gender classes.
- C. A law gave girls an equal chance to learn.
- D. Boys and girls behave better in such classes.

28. Why might girls not get a chance to talk much in a class with boys?
- A. Because the teacher doesn't ask them questions
 - B. Because boys are louder and often talk first
 - C. Because boys know the correct answers
 - D. Because girls are often shy.
29. What is NOT the reason that some schools are reconsidering separating classes?
- A. They prefer the old teaching styles.
 - B. Boys learn differently than girls.
 - C. Boys and girls can bother each other.
 - D. Boys and girls like different things.
30. Which is one class that is not mentioned as being separated?
- A. Math
 - B. Social Studies
 - C. Science
 - D. Physical Education

Talk/Lecture 3. Listen to a talk about body language in American Culture at a student orientation meeting.

31. Who is listening to the orientation talk?
- A. the director of international students
 - B. new international students
 - C. the teachers of international department
 - D. all first-year students in the college
32. What is the purpose of this talk?
- A. to introduce the director for international student affairs
 - B. to deal with all international students' problems.
 - C. to inform the importance of using English in class.
 - D. to introduce common problems in non-verbal communication.
33. According to the speaker, what is body language?
- A. It's the use of verb tenses and modals.
 - B. It's the way to ask for directions
 - C. It's the language used in class only.
 - D. It's the language of movements and facial expressions.
34. In American culture, ...
- A. Eye contact is the same as most cultures.
 - B. making eye contact is a sign of disrespect.
 - C. people don't look in others' eyes while talking.
 - D. eye contact is considered as a sign of honesty.
35. According to the speaker, what is TRUE about handshakes in American Culture?
- A. A handshake shouldn't be too strong.
 - B. Handshakes are not common.
 - C. Handshakes need to be firm.
 - D. Shaking hands is not important.

B: READING

Time permitted: 60 minutes

Number of questions: 40

Directions: In this section you will read *FOUR* different passages. Each one is followed by 10 questions about it. For questions 1-40, you are to choose the best answer A, B, C or D, to each question. Then, on your answer sheet, find the number of the question and fill in the space that corresponds to the letter of the answer you have chosen. Answer all questions following a passage on the basis of what is stated or implied in that passage.

You have 60 minutes to answer all the questions, including the time to transfer your answers to the answer sheet.

PASSAGE 1 – Questions 1-10

A new study, conducted by scientists from Oxford University, the Chinese Academy of Medical Sciences and the Chinese Center for Disease Control, has warned that a third of all men currently under the age of 20 in China will eventually die prematurely if they do not give up smoking.

The research, published in *The Lancet* medical journal, says two-thirds of men in China now start to smoke before 20. Around half of those men will die from the habit, it concludes.

In 2010, around one million people in China died from tobacco usage. But researchers say that if current trends continue, that will double to two million people - mostly men - dying every year by 2030, making it a "growing epidemic of premature death".

But co-author Richard Peto said there was hope - if people can be persuaded to quit. "The key to avoid this huge wave of deaths is cessation, and if you are a young man, don't start," he said.

In many parts of China, meals often fit a comfortable pattern. After putting down their chopsticks, men commonly push their chairs back from the table and light cigarettes. No wonder China has struggled to impose a smoking ban in public places. Here, relationships are often built amid clouds of smoke.

Expensive brands of cigarettes, often decorated with gold detailing on the cartons, are given as gifts. And ordinary brands are affordable to all but the very poor, costing just 2.5 yuan (\$0.4; £0.25) a pack.

In a country where smoking is so ingrained in daily life, few understand the harmful effects of tobacco use. According to the World Health Organization (WHO), only 25% of Chinese adults can list the specific health hazards of smoking, from lung cancer to heart disease.

Perhaps it should come as no surprise, then, that only 10% of Chinese smokers quit by choice. Instead, most are forced to give up their cigarettes because they're too sick to continue.

While smoking rates have fallen in developed countries - to less than one in five in the US - they have risen in China, as cigarettes have become more available and consumers richer.

Authorities have shown concern over the rise, with Beijing even introducing a public smoking ban. But efforts have been **hampered** by the habit's popularity, and its usefulness as a source of tax - the government collects about 428 billion yuan (£44billion, \$67billion) in tobacco taxes each year.

Globally, tobacco kills up to half of its users, according to the World Health Organization.

1. How many Chinese men start to smoke before the age of 20?
A. one-third B two-thirds C. half D. all of them
2. What does the word **"those men"** in paragraph 2 refer to?
A. Men who smoke under the age of 20 B. Men who smoke above the age of 20
C. Men who give up smoking D. Men who smoke in public
3. By 2030, how many men in China may die from smoking every year?
A. one million B. two million C. three million D. four million
4. In many areas of China, when do men usually smoke?
A. Before a meal B. After a meal
C. Before they go to sleep D. When they get up
5. According to WHO, only _____ of Chinese adults can list bad effects of smoking.
A. one-third B. one-fourth C. one-fifth D. a half
6. **"Beijing"** refers to
A. China B. The city of Beijing
C. The Chinese government D. People who live in Beijing
7. What is Richard Peto's attitude toward smoking in China?
A. He doesn't believe that people will give up smoking
B. He is disappointed with the Chinese government.
C. He thinks that people possibly stop smoking if they see reasons.
D. He is sure about the rise of future deaths in China.
8. Which of the following words does the word **"hamper"** have closest meaning to?
A. basket B. assist C. prohibit D. restrict
9. What is the writer's purpose?
A. To argue over smoking policy in China B. To support smoking in China
C. To warn and prevent smoking in China D. To report the result of a research paper
10. What does the writer imply about Chinese government?
A. They do not want to stop people from smoking.
B. They have tried to stop people from smoking in public but with little success.
C. They have tried to close tobacco companies.
D. They do not care about smoking.

PASSAGE 2 – Questions 11-20

The evidence that humans are causing global warming is strong, but the question of what to do about it remains controversial. Economics, sociology, and politics are all important factors in planning for the future.

Even if we stopped emitting greenhouse gases (GHGs) today, the Earth would still warm by another degree Fahrenheit or so. But what we do from today forward makes a big difference. Depending on our choices, scientists predict that the Earth could eventually warm by as little as 2.5 degrees or as much as 10 degrees Fahrenheit.

A commonly cited goal is to stabilize GHG concentrations around 450-550 parts per million (ppm), or about twice pre-industrial levels. This is the point at which many believe the most damaging impacts of climate change can be avoided. Current concentrations are about 380 ppm, **which** means there isn't much time to lose. According to the IPCC, we'd have to reduce GHG emissions by 50% to 80% of what they're on track to be in the next century to reach this level.

Is this possible?

Many people and governments are already working hard to cut greenhouse gases, and everyone can help.

Researchers Stephen Pacala and Robert Socolow at Princeton University have suggested one approach that they call "stabilization wedges." This means reducing GHG emissions from a variety of sources with technologies available in the next few decades, rather than relying on an enormous change in a single area. They suggest 7 wedges that could each reduce emissions, and all of **them** together could hold emissions at approximately current levels for the next 50 years, putting us on a potential path to stabilize around 500 ppm.

There are many possible wedges, including improvements to energy efficiency and vehicle fuel economy (so less energy has to be produced), and increases in wind and solar power, hydrogen produced from renewable sources, biofuels (produced from crops), natural gas, and nuclear power. There is also the potential to capture the carbon dioxide emitted from fossil fuels and store it underground—a process called "carbon sequestration."

In addition to reducing the gases we emit to the atmosphere, we can also increase the amount of gases we take out of the atmosphere. Plants and trees absorb CO₂ as they grow, "**sequestering**" carbon naturally. Increasing forestlands and making changes to the way we farm could increase the amount of carbon we're storing.

Some of these technologies have **drawbacks**, and different communities will make different decisions about how to power their lives, but the good news is that there are a variety of options to put us on a path toward a stable climate.

11. The word "we" in paragraph 2 refers to

- A. humans
- B. economists, sociologists, and politicians
- C. animals
- D. scientists

12. According to paragraph 2, how many degrees could the Earth warm up?

- A. 2.5
- B. 2.5 or 10
- C. 10
- D. from 2.5 to 10

13. According to paragraph 3, why should we stabilize GHG concentrations around 450-550 parts per million?
- A. to avoid the most serious effects of climate change
 - B. to avoid all damaging impacts of climate change
 - C. to mend the most damaging impacts of climate change
 - D. to stop climate change
14. What does “which” in paragraph 3 refer to?
- A. current concentrations
 - B. that current concentrations are about 380 ppm
 - C. 380 ppm
 - D. ppm
15. Why does the author mention Stephen Pacala and Robert Socolow?
- A. To introduce two researchers in the field
 - B. To prove that researchers are working to reduce GHG emission
 - C. To introduce one way to reduce GHG emission
 - D. To introduce Princeton University
16. What stabilization wedges are NOT mentioned in the passage?
- A. create environment-friendly materials
 - B. capture and store carbon dioxide underground
 - C. increase the use of renewable energy
 - D. grow more trees
17. What does “them” refer to?
- A. researchers
 - B. humans
 - C. renewable resources
 - D. wedges
18. What is the best title for this passage?
- A. Arguments over Global Warming
 - B. Global Warming and its Causes
 - C. Global Warming Solutions
 - D. Global Warming’s Effect on Earth
19. “Sequestering” has closest meaning to
- A. absorb
 - B. isolate
 - C. release
 - D. emit
20. Why does the writer mention “drawbacks” in the last paragraph?
- A. To introduce the disadvantages of solutions in the following paragraph
 - B. To emphasize the disadvantages of the solutions in the previous paragraph
 - C. To recommend readers not to use the solutions
 - D. To emphasize the advantages of the solutions in different contexts

PASSAGE 3 – Questions 21-30

Art communicates to us primarily through our eyes. We look at art, and we try to find some meaning in the experience. If we are to begin to think about art more seriously, we might do well to become more aware of the process of seeing itself.

Science tells us that seeing is a mode of perception, or the recognition and interpretation of sensory data—in other words, how information comes in our senses, and what we make of it. In visual perception our eyes take in information in the form of light patterns; the brain processes these patterns to give them meaning. The mechanics of perception work much the same way for everyone, yet in a given situation we do not all see the same things.

We can take great pleasure in merely looking at art, just as we take pleasure in the view of a distant mountain range or watching the sun set over the ocean. But art, unlike nature, is a human creation. It is one of the many ways we express ourselves and attempt to communicate. A work of art is the product of human intelligence, and we can meet it with our own intelligence on equal footing. This is where study comes in.

The understanding of process - the how - often contributes quite a lot to our appreciation of art. If you understand why painting in watercolor may be different from painting in oil, why clay responds differently to the artist's hands than does wood or glass - you will have a richer appreciation of the artist's expression.

Knowing the place of a work of art in history - what went before and came after - can also deepen your understanding. Artists learn to make art by studying the achievements of the past and observing the efforts of their contemporaries. They adapt ideas to serve their own needs and then bequeath those ideas to future generations of artists. For example, Matisse assumed that his audience would know that Venus was the ancient Roman goddess of love. But he also hoped that they would be familiar with one Venus in particular, a famous Greek statue known as the Venus de Milo.

An artist may create a specific work for any of a thousand reasons. An awareness of the why may give some insight as well. Looking at Van Gogh's *The Starry Night*, it might help you know that Van Gogh was intrigued by the belief that people journeyed to a star after their death, and that there they continued their lives. "Just as we take the train to get to Tarascon or Rouen," he wrote in a letter, "we take death to reach a star." This knowledge might help you understand why Van Gogh felt so strongly about the night sky, and what his painting might have meant to him.

But no matter how much you study, Van Gogh's painting will never mean for you exactly what it meant for him, nor should it. Great works of art hold many meanings. The greatest of them seem to speak anew to each generation and to each attentive observer. The most important thing is that they mean something for you, that your own experiences, thoughts, and emotions find a place in them.

21. According to paragraph 2, the process of visual perception
- | | |
|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| A. is not the same for all people | B. begins with patterns of light |
| C. is not very scientific | D. requires other senses to function |
22. What did Matisse reinterpret?
- | | |
|-----------------------------|---------------------------------|
| A. A goddess from mythology | B. A painting by another artist |
| C. An ancient sculpture | D. A man in history |
23. The word "them" in the last paragraph refers to
- | | |
|------------------------------|--------------------------|
| A. each attentive observer | B. thoughts and emotions |
| C. a lifetime of experiences | D. great works of art |
24. The word "bequeath" in the passage is closest in meaning to
- | | | | |
|-------------|------------|--------------|------------|
| A. make out | B. pass on | C. look over | D. take in |
|-------------|------------|--------------|------------|
25. The author mentions all of the following ways to enhance the appreciation of art EXCEPT
- | | |
|---------------------------------------|---|
| A. understanding the artistic process | B. becoming familiar with the history |
| C. experiencing the art by copying | D. knowing about the life of the artist |

26. What is the main topic of this passage?
- A. Visual perception of sensory material
 - B. The historical context for artistic expression
 - C. Studying Van Gogh's *The Starry Night*
 - D. The appreciation of works of art
27. Which of the sentences below best expresses the information in the highlighted statement in the passage?
- A. We see images differently because of the mode of perception.
 - B. Although we see images differently, the mode of perception is similar.
 - C. Since the mode of perception is similar, we see images in the same way.
 - D. When the mode of perception is the same, we see the same images
28. Why might Van Gogh have painted *The Starry Night*?
- A. To symbolize the journey of life after death
 - B. To create a dramatic contrast with the sky
 - C. To place a strong image in the foreground
 - D. To include nature from his early experience
29. The word "intrigued" in the passage is closest in meaning to
- A. very pleased
 - B. very confused
 - C. very interested
 - D. very surprised
30. What can be inferred from the last paragraph?
- A. Greatest artworks are impossible to understand.
 - B. The author shows negative feelings toward contemporary art.
 - C. People need knowledge to understand art.
 - D. What we see in art is determined by our emotions, experiences, and thoughts.

PASSAGE 4 – Questions 31-40

Antibiotics block the life cycle of bacteria that invade the human body. The first of these antibiotics, penicillin, works by blocking the molecules that construct the cell walls of particular bacteria. The bacteria, with incomplete cell walls, are not able to reproduce.

When penicillin was introduced during World War II, it was truly a "miracle drug." Until that time, anyone who was cut or wounded stood a great risk of infection. Once penicillin became available, the situation changed. Wounded soldiers, children with ear infections, and many others began to benefit from the ability to block the growth of bacteria.

While humanity may have won that particular battle against bacteria, the war is far from over. The reason is that in any bacterial population, there are bound to be a few bacteria that, for one reason or another, are not affected by a particular antibiotic. For example, they may have a slightly differently shaped enzyme that builds cell walls, so that penicillin will not fit onto that particular shape of the enzyme. These bacteria will not be affected by that particular drug.

For that small group, the antibiotic is a real godsend. It doesn't affect them, but it does wipe out all of their competition. They are thus free to multiply, and, over time, all of the bacteria will have whatever properties that made those individuals resistant.

Traditionally, medical scientists have dealt with this phenomenon by developing a large number of antibiotics, each of which intervenes in the bacterial life cycle in a slightly different way.

Consequently, if you happen to have a bacterium that is resistant to one antibiotic, probably it will succumb to the action of another. You may, in fact, have had the experience of going to a doctor with an infection, being given an antibiotic, and then finding that it didn't work. In all likelihood, all your doctor had to do then was prescribe a different antibiotic and everything was fine.

The problem is that as time has passed, more and more bacteria have become resistant to antibiotics. In fact, currently, there is one strain of bacteria- *Staphylococcus*-that is resistant to every commercially available antibiotic except one, and in 1996, a bacterium with lowered resistance to that last antibiotic appeared in Japan.

The appearance of drug-resistant bacteria is not particularly surprising; in fact, it probably should have been **anticipated**. Nevertheless, in the late 1980s, there was a general sense of **complacency** among scientists on the antibiotic question. Little profit was to be made by developing the one-hundred-and-first antibiotic. Drug companies concentrated their efforts on other areas. Therefore, a gap developed between the production of new antibiotics and the development of resistance among bacteria.

By the early 1990s, this gap was recognized and highlighted in several national news magazines. More companies returned to develop new kinds of antibiotics, and currently, a number are undergoing clinical trials. By early in the twenty-first century, some of these new drugs will start to come on the market, and the problem will be "solved," at least for the moment.

Additional research will focus on the processes by which cells repair the constant damage to DNA, but the computer design of new drugs, the development of new antibiotics, and techniques to combat bacteria should remain a top priority.

31. How do antibiotics treat infections?
- A. They interfere with the reproductive cycle of bacteria.
 - B. They construct cell walls to resist bacteria.
 - C. They inject enzymes that explode in affected cells.
 - D. They increase the mitosis of healthy cells
32. The word "them" in paragraph 4 refers to
- A. whatever properties
 - B. resistant bacteria
 - C. their competition
 - D. those individuals
33. The word "anticipated" in the passage is closest in meaning to
- A. predicted
 - B. concealed
 - C. investigated
 - D. disregarded
34. Which of the following best expresses the main idea of this passage?
- A. The "miracle drug" penicillin
 - B. Drug-resistant bacteria
 - C. *Staphylococcus* infections
 - D. Gene therapy treatments
35. According to paragraph 4, why do some bacteria benefit from antibiotics?
- A. The antibiotic eliminates competing bacteria, allowing resistant bacteria to reproduce.
 - B. The resistant bacteria compete with the antibiotic, and the bacteria become stronger.
 - C. The competition helps the resistant bacteria to multiply by reproducing with the resistant type.
 - D. The properties of the antibiotic are acquired by the bacteria, making it resistant to the competition.

36. The word “**complacency**” in the passage is closest in meaning to
- A. consensus of agreement B. fear of consequences
 - C. lack of concern D. awareness of potential
37. Which of the sentences below best expresses the information in the highlighted statement in the passage?
- A. Some antibiotics affect a population of bacteria more efficiently than others.
 - B. There are several reasons why some bacteria do not respond to most antibiotics.
 - C. The effect of antibiotics on bacteria is to bind them together into one population.
 - D. A small number of bacteria in any sample will probably be resistant to a specific antibiotic.
38. The author mentions all of the following reasons for drug resistant bacteria to appear EXCEPT.....
- A. there was not enough profit incentive for companies to continue developing new antibiotics
 - B. statistically, some drug-resistant bacteria will occur naturally in any large population of bacteria
 - C. the newer antibiotics were not as strong and effective as the original penicillin-based drugs
 - D. competing bacteria are destroyed by antibiotics, allowing resistant bacteria to prosper.
39. It can be inferred from the passage that
- A. research to develop new antibiotics will not be necessary in the future
 - B. the scientific community was not surprised by the resistant strains of bacteria
 - C. antibiotics are not very expensive when they are made available commercially
 - D. it takes years for a new drug to be made available commercially for consumers
40. Which of the following statements is NOT a main idea of the passage?
- A. Many strains of bacteria have become resistant to the antibiotics currently available.
 - B. Funding for the production of new antibiotics has been allocated to drug companies.
 - C. The first antibiotics were very effective in blocking the reproduction of bacteria.
 - D. New antibiotics are being developed to combat bacteria that resist the older antibiotics.

C: WRITING

Time allowed: 60 minutes

No. of items: 2

TASK 1

You should spend about 20 minutes on this task.

Write a letter of complaint to a store where you purchased a faulty new phone. In your letter explain the following:

- where and when you purchased the phone
- what is wrong with it
- what action you would like the store to take

Your response will be evaluated in terms of task fulfillment, organisation, vocabulary and grammar. You should write at least 120 words.

TASK 2

You should spend about 40 minutes on this task.

In some countries, many more people are choosing to live alone nowadays than in the past. Do you think this is a positive or negative development?

Give reasons for your answer and include any relevant examples from your own experience or knowledge.

You should write at least 250 words.

D: SPEAKING

PART I: SOCIAL INTERACTION

Let's talk about house

1. Do you live in a house or a flat?
2. What are some advantages of living in an apartment?
3. Can you describe your dream house?

Now, let's talk about traveling

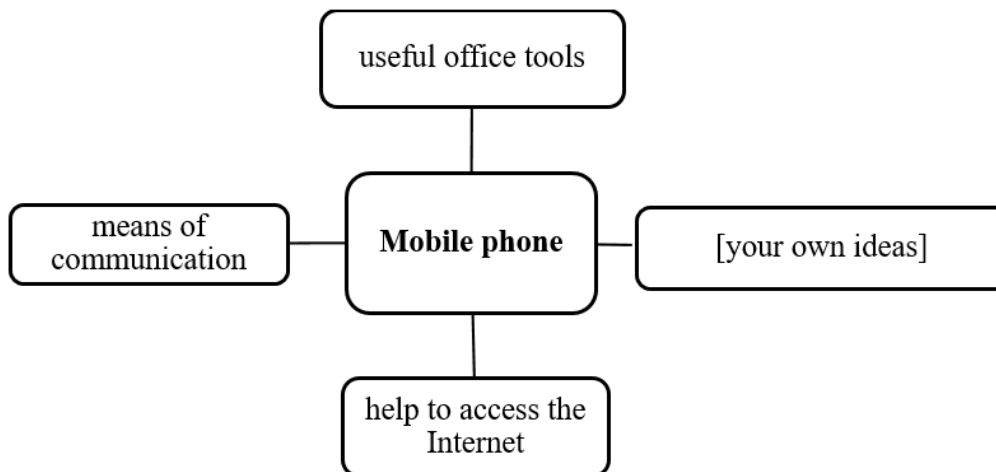
1. Do you like travelling?
2. Do you like travelling alone or with others?
3. What do you often do on your holiday?

PART II: SOLUTION DISCUSSION

You are planning your holiday. There are three suggestions: a beach holiday, a climbing holiday, and a sight-seeing holiday. Which do you think is the best choice for you?

PART III: TOPIC DEVELOPMENT

The reasons why mobile phones are useful tools at schools.



TEST 2

A: LISTENING

Directions: This is the listening test for levels from 3 to 5 of the Vietnam's 6-level Language Proficiency Test. There are three parts to the test. You will hear each part once. For each part of the test there will be time for you to look through the questions and time for you to check your answers. Write your answers on the question paper. You will have 5 minutes at the end of the test to transfer your answers onto the answer sheet.

PART 1

There are eight questions in this part. For each question there are four options and a short recording. For each question, choose the correct answer A, B, C or D. You now have 48 seconds to look through the questions and the options in each question.

1. What colour is Mary's coat?
A. yellow B. blue C. brown D. black
2. What did the woman repair?
A. chair B. shelf C. desk D. bed
3. What are they going to buy for Pam?
A. a book B. a plant C. some chocolates D. candies
4. What has the girl lost?
A. mobile phone B. purse C. pen D. bag
5. Which sport will the boy do soon at the centre?
A. waterskiing B. diving C. sailing D. swimming
6. Who lives with Josh in his house?
A. his grandmother B. his father C. his sister D. his mother
7. What will the girl take with her on holiday?
A. suitcase B. sports bag C. backpack D. overhead bag
8. Where do the boys decide to go?
A. cinema B. game store C. park D. library

PART 2

You will hear three different conversations. In each conversation there are four questions. For each question, choose the correct answer A, B, C or D. You will hear the conversations only once.

Conversation 1. You will hear a journalist interviewing Geoff Thompson, a British sportsman.

9. Where was Geoff Thompson born?
A. In London. B. In the North of England.
C. In the South of London. D. In Britain.
10. How did he know about karate?
A. He discovered karate by himself.
B. He's interested in karate owing to a sports center during a school visit.
C. His friend introduced it to him.

D. He knew it when moving to London.

11. When did he take part in the World Championships in Taiwan?

A. In 1972. B. In 1980. C. In 1982. D. After starting training with a British coach.

12. How many times has he got the World Champion?

A. Two times. B. Three times. C. Four times. D. Five times.

Conversation 2. You will hear a man telephoning to talk about the job in a hotel.

13. Which position does this hotel need?

A. A temporary staff. B. A stable staff.
C. A part-time receptionist. D. A full-time waiter.

14. What about the hour of work?

A. There are two shifts and two days off.
B. There are two shifts and one day off.
C. There's a day shift from 7 to 2 and a late shift from 4 till 11.
D. There is only afternoon shift.

15. What does the woman mention about the uniform?

A. It's prepared by the hotel. B. He needs to wear dark clothes.
C. He needs a white shirt and dark trousers. D. He needs wear uniform five days a week.

16. When does he start his job?

A. At the end of May. B. On the 10th of May.
C. On the 10th of June. D. On the 28th of June.

Conversation 3. Listen to part of a conversation at a university library.

17. What does the man plan to write his paper on?

A. The preservation of old books. B. The local coal industry.
C. The famous archives librarian. D. The collection of rare books.

18. What security procedures does the librarian tell the man he must follow?

A. Show her his note cards before leaving.
B. Show her his ID card.
C. Pay a fee.
D. Allow his ID card to be copied; sign in and out of the archives room.

19. Why did the librarian mention the age of the books?

A. They need to be handled with gloves.
B. The man can only look at photographs of them.
C. They were added to the collection recently.
D. They are value books.

20. How did the man collect his needed information about his paper?

A. He took a picture. B. He scanned these images.
C. He could just look them. D. He photocopied these books.

PART 3

You will hear three different talks or lectures. In each talk or lecture there are five questions. For each question, choose the correct answer A, B, C or D. You will hear the talks or lectures only once.

Talk/Lecture 1. You will hear a presentation about fashion at work.

- 21. The presenter doesn't wear a suit because ...**
A. He is not an important person.
B. He wants to talk about different fashion trend.
C. The presentation is not formal.
D. He works for a fashion company.
- 22. According to the speaker, which statement is TRUE?**
A. It's important to look casually-dressed in public.
B. A suit is necessary when meeting clients.
C. Wearing shorts is OK, sometimes.
D. Nobody can describe the way he's dressed.
- 23. What does the phrase "Dress-down Fridays" mean?**
A. Employees must wear fashionable clothes on Fridays.
B. Employees can wear anything they want on Fridays.
C. Employees are allowed to wear informally on Fridays.
D. Employees are required to wear special clothes on Fridays.
- 24. According to the speaker, who may be the most informal dressers?**
A. People working in IT
B. People working in banks.
C. People working in customer services.
D. People working with clients.
- 25. What does a customer feel about a man in uniform?**
A. reliable B. recognized C. expertised D. reassured

Talk/Lecture 2. Listen to a man talking about sleeping habits.

- 26. How many hours of sleep do experts suggest for kids?**
A. Ten B. About fifteen C. 1,400 D. 70
- 27. According to the speaker, why is sleep important for the brain?**
A. Sleep generates dreams so brain can relax.
B. Brain can rest in a sleep.
C. Sleep can save energy for the brain.
D. Sleep improves the effectiveness of the brain.
- 28. Why don't the students learn well when they are tired?**
A. They can't finish their homework.
B. They can't deal with troubles in class.
C. They get very excited.
D. They can't pay attention very well
- 29. Which is NOT a reason for poor sleep?**
A. drinking soda B. playing computer games
C. staying up late D. exercising before sleep
- 30. What should students try to do each night?**
A. Watch a scary movie B. Drink some hot tea
C. Go to bed at a regular time D. relax with a TV show

Talk/Lecture 3. Listen to a woman talking about northern lights.

31. Which is NOT the shape of the northern lights?

- A. a straight line B. a curved line
- C. a round shape D. an oval shape

32. What does "*aurora borealis*" exactly mean?

- A. northern lights B. northern dawn
- C. northern sky D. early morning lights

33. Where is the best place to see the northern lights?

- A. The northernmost point of Earth
- B. The north of Poland
- C. Anywhere in Scandinavian countries
- D. Most parts of the world

34. What is one of the stories developed by people before modern science?

- A. The lights were caused by foxes.
- B. The lights were the dance of animals.
- C. The lights appeared when people.
- D. The lights came from fires of northern gods.

35. Which of the following is NOT mentioned in this talk?

- A. A description of the lights
- B. The scientific explanation for the lights
- C. The discovery of the lights
- D. Beliefs about the lights

B: READING

Time permitted: 60 minutes

Number of questions: 40

Directions: In this section you will read *FOUR* different passages. Each one is followed by 10 questions about it. For questions 1-40, you are to choose the best answer A, B, C or, to each question. Then, on your answer sheet, find the number of the question and fill in the space that corresponds to the letter of the answer you have chosen. Answer all questions following a passage on the basis of what is stated or implied in that passage.

You have 60 minutes to answer all the questions, including the time to transfer your answers to the answer sheet.

PASSAGE 1 – Questions 1-10

Doctors treat patients for free at clinic in Ha Noi

Line For 20 years, Dang Thi Nhan, 67, has been waking up about 30 minutes earlier each day to bake cakes or prepare tea for two retired doctors in a clinic near her house in Ha Noi's Giap Bat Ward. That is all Nhan can offer as thanks to doctors who provide free health checks for herself, her paralysed husband and their 43-year-old disabled son. "If one day
5 they cannot take care of themselves and need some one to look after, I will do it voluntarily till the day they are gone," Nhan said.

The small clinic, situated on Kim Dong Street, has become familiar to many people in Ha Noi. It was established in 1992 by Dr Truong Thi Hoi To, 84, a former principal of Nam Dinh Medical College, Le Thi Soc, 87, a retired nurse from Saint Paul Municipal Hospital,
10 and Le Thanh Thuoc, the late deputy director of the Viet Nam National Cancer Hospital, who died last year. The clinic used to open every Monday and Thursday. However, after doctor Thuoc died and due to the deteriorating health of the two other medics, the clinic now only opens on Monday mornings at 8 am. Patients not only receive health checks, but they also receive free medicine. **A**

15 Since 2014, the clinic has treated about 8,500 patients, according to Giap Bat ward's Red Cross Association. On its first days, the clinic faced numerous difficulties due to lack of money. Mrs. To, founder of the clinic, had to spend her own pension and encourage her children and relatives to donate money to purchase medical equipment and medicine. The clinic also had to relocate seven times as To and her co-workers could not afford high
20 rents. Despite these difficulties, they never thought of giving up. "Being able to help my patients brings me unspeakable joy. This is also my life target. It warms my heart to see the happy faces of the patients," To said. **B**

Tran Thi Toan, 64, a patient from Nam Dinh Province, now works as a servant in Ha Noi. She is grateful to doctor To and nurse Soc not just for the free treatment, but for their caring manner. Toan said: "They give me meticulous treatment and clear, detailed instruction as well as advise me on a healthy and happy lifestyle". Toan feels shy about her
25 job, so the doctors' care and compassionate attitude have become her inspiration in life. **C**

To the doctors, the most precious thing they receive from their patients is confidence in their skills, which can only be achieved through ethics and medical
30 excellence. "The success of a doctor does not lie in how much money they earn, but how many people they help", Soc said. Sharing Soc's opinion, To said that "Medical practitioners should not consider their profession as a tool to get rich. They should not benefit from their patients' pain. Patients come first, not money." **D**

1. How old was Dang Thi Nhan when she first started to bake cakes or prepare tea for the two doctors?

A. 20

B. 67

C. 43

D. 47

2. The word "they" in paragraph 1 refers to
A. two doctors B. husband and son C. health checks D. cakes
3. The word "late" in paragraph 2 is closest in meaning to
A. last-minute B. behind C. delayed D. deceased
4. The word "its" in paragraph 3 refers to
A. Red Cross Association B. the clinic C. medicine D. pension
5. Who probably did not work in a hospital before retirement?
A. Le Thi Soc B. Le Thanh Thuoc
C. Truong Thi Hoi To D. All of them
6. In which lines does the author mention about the bad health condition of the doctors at the clinic.....
A. line 5 B. line 13 C. line 23 D. line 28
7. The word "donate" in paragraph 3 could be best replaced by
A. give B. take C. keep D. get
8. What has helped Mrs. Tran Thi Toan gain confidence in her life?
A. her job as a servant
B. her gratitude to all doctors
C. her healthy and happy lifestyle
D. doctors' caring manner and free treatment at clinic
9. In which space (marked A, B, C and D in the passage) will the following sentence fit?
"They treat me as a close member of their family. There is no discrimination between the rich and the poor. Everyone is treated equally." She added.
A. A B. B C. C D. D
10. The last paragraph indicates Mrs. Soc's opinion that a doctor is successful if
A. he/ she earns a lot of money
B. he/ she is confident in his/her skills
C. he/ she helps a lot of patients
D. he/ she benefits from their patients' pain

PASSAGE 2 – Questions 11-20

- To Get a Job in Your 50s, Maintain Friendships in Your 40s.**
- Line* We hear it all the time: People who are over 50 take longer to find jobs than younger people. Connie Wanberg, a professor at the Carlson School of Management at the University of Minnesota, had long heard gloom-and-doom stories to that effect, but she wondered how strong the data was to support them.
- 5 Very, as it turned out. According to a study by Professor Wanberg and others, job seekers over 50 were unemployed 5.8 weeks longer than those from the ages of 30 to 49. That number rose to 10.6 weeks when the comparison group was from 20 to 29. Professor Wanberg and three other researchers — Darla J. Hamann, Ruth Kanfer and Zhen Zhang — arrived at those numbers by analyzing and synthesizing hundreds of studies by economists,
- 10 sociologists and psychologists.

But it is important not to jump to conclusions about the cause, Professor Wanberg said. "It's not very unusual for everybody to think that the reason for the difficulty in finding jobs at 50s is discrimination," she said. That can sometimes be the case, but the reality is that the behavior required to find work does not play to many older people's strengths.

15 Once they become aware of this, they can act to compensate.

In **their** study, the researchers found that older people on average had smaller social networks than younger people, Professor Wanberg said. This is not necessarily bad — as we age, many of us find that the quality of our relationships is more important than the quantity. But in the job search process, the number of connections we maintain in our professional and personal networks is often **critical**.

20

As people age, they also tend to stay in the same job longer, consistent with a pattern of wanting to put down roots. During that time, the skills people have learned and the job search strategies they once used may become outdated — especially as technology evolves ever more quickly.

25

The cure for **these drawbacks** is fairly straightforward. Once you hit your early 40s, even if you are not looking for a job, work to learn new skills and stretch yourself, Professor Wanberg said. Also, keep your networks strong by staying in touch with former colleagues and classmates, along with current co-workers and clients whom you don't see regularly, she said.

30

Finding a job after 50 doesn't have to be as discouraging as it is often portrayed to be, Professor Wanberg said. Just recognize that some of the obstacles you face are inherent to the aging process, she said. She stressed that her findings reflected only averages and that individual behavior varies greatly. Certainly, many older people maintain wide social circles and often learn skills. But in general, older job seekers must take more steps to find employment than younger ones, she said.

35

Once older workers do find a new employer, they can use their knowledge, wisdom and emotional intelligence — qualities that older people often possess in abundance — to thrive in their new positions.

11. The word "**gloom-and-doom**" in the first paragraph could be best replaced by

- A. hopeless B. interesting C. cheerful D. strange

12. According to the study, which age group has the least unemployed time?

- A. less than 20 B. from 20 to 29 C. from 30 to 49 D. over 50

13. In the third paragraph, what best paraphrases the sentence "**It's not very unusual for everybody to think that the reason for the difficulty in finding jobs at 50s is discrimination**"?

- A. People do not usually think about the cause of discrimination in finding jobs at 50s.
B. People do not usually think that discrimination is the reason for the difficulty at 50s.
C. People commonly believe that finding jobs at 50s causes discrimination.
D. People commonly believe that discrimination makes finding jobs at 50s difficult.

14. The word "**their**" in paragraph 4 refers to

- A. the researchers B. older people
C. social networks D. younger people

15. The word "**critical**" in paragraph 4 could be best replaced by

- A. huge B. demanding C. trivial D. important

16. What advice does Professor Wanberg give to over 50 year-old job seekers when they are still at early 40s?

- A. maintaining small but strong social networks
- B. becoming aware of their strengths
- C. learning new skills and keeping wide social circles
- D. staying in the same job longer.

17. The word "these drawbacks" in paragraph 6 refers to

- A. outdated skills and job search strategies
- B. small numbers of connection networks
- C. lost social circles with co-workers and clients
- D. low quality and small quantity of relationships

18. What of the following statements is not true according to the passage?

- A. Finding a job after 50 is not at all hopeless
- B. Older people hardly learn new skills and maintain wide social networks
- C. Older people often have many good qualities
- D. Findings of the study does not hold true for all older people.

19. Which of the following would best describe Professor Wanberg's attitude towards finding a job after 50?

- A. hopeless
- B. frustrated
- C. optimistic
- D. discouraging

20. What is the purpose of this passage?

- A. To report the difficulties of finding jobs at 50s.
- B. To discuss the advantages and disadvantages of 50 year-old job seekers.
- C. To warn people against skipping jobs at later ages.
- D. To raise awareness on the importance of maintaining social connections and learning new skills at early stages.

PASSAGE 3 – Questions 21-30

Line

MARY'S FIRST JOB

When I was just fifteen, my father purchased an old hostel in the country where we lived and decided to turn it into a luxury hotel. At the early stages of the hotel, he experimented with everything. None of us had ever worked in a hotel before, but my dad had a vision of what guests wanted. His standards were extremely high and he believed that to reach those standards the most important thing was work.

For a month that summer I worked as a waitress at breakfast and dinner. As part of the job I had to lay the tables in the dining room beforehand and clean up afterwards. This gave me the middle of the day free for studying because my school report predictably had not lived up to my father's high expectations.

Like all the other waitresses, I was equipped with a neat uniform and told to treat the guests as though they were special visitors in my own home. Although I felt more like a stranger in theirs, I did not express my feelings. Instead I concentrated on doing the job as well as, if not better than, the older girls.

In the kitchen I learned how to deal with Gordon, the chef, who I found rather daunting. He had an impressive chef's hat and a terrifying ability to lose his temper and get violent for no clear reason. I avoided close contact with him and always grabbed the dishes he gave me with a cold look on my face. Then, as I walked from the kitchen to the dining room, my cold expression used to change into a charming smile.

I found waiting at breakfast was more enjoyable than at dinner. The guests came wandering into the dining room from seven-thirty onwards, staring with pleasure at the view of the sea and the islands through the dining room window. I always made sure that everyone got their order quickly and I enjoyed getting on well with the people at each table.

In the evenings it was funny how differently people behaved; they talked with louder, less friendly voices, and did not always return my smile. However, that all changed when Dad created a special role for me which improved my status considerably.

I started by making simple cakes for guests' picnics and soon progressed to more elaborate cakes for afternoon teas. I found that recipes were easy to follow and it was amusing to improvise. This led to a nightly event known as Mary's Sweet Trolley. I used to enter the dining room every evening pushing a trolley carrying an extraordinary collection of puddings, cakes and other desserts. Most of them were of my own invention, I had cooked them all myself, and some were undeniably strange.

21. The word "it" in line 2 refers to

- A. an old hostel
- B. the country
- C. a luxury hotel
- D. Mary's first job

22. What did the people working at the hotel have in common?

- A. They knew what the guests expected.
- B. They shared all the jobs.
- C. They lacked experience.
- D. They enjoyed the work.

23. Mary's working day was organized in order to give her

- A. time for her school work.
- B. working experience.
- C. time at midday to relax.
- D. time to have lunch with her father.

24. In the second paragraph, what best paraphrases the sentence "*my school report predictably had not lived up to my father's high expectations*"

- A. The school made a report about my expectations to my father.
- B. My father has not satisfied with my results at school.

- C. The report from school is highly predictable to my father.
D. My father expects to receive the school report soon.
25. What does the writer mean by "*daunting*" in line 16?
A. disgusting B. frightening C. interesting D. strange
26. What did Mary do while she walked from the kitchen to the dining room?
A. She smiled at Gordon in a friendly way.
B. She avoided touching Gordon.
C. She checked the food Gordon gave her.
D. She started to look more friendly.
27. Why did Mary enjoy serving breakfasts more than dinners?
A. She enjoyed the view from the dining room while working.
B. She had a better relationship with the guests.
C. The guests were more punctual than at dinner.
D. She worked more efficiently at breakfast.
28. How did Mary's father improve her position in the hotel?
A. He put her in charge of the restaurant.
B. He asked her to provide entertainment for the guests.
C. He made her responsible for part of dinner.
D. He gave her a special uniform.
29. What was special about the food on Mary's Sweet Trolley?
A. Mary made it following traditional recipes.
B. Mary made the same food for picnics.
C. Mary and Gordon made it together.
D. Mary made most of it without following recipes.
30. What impression does Mary give of her job throughout the passage?
A. It brought her closer to her father. B. It was sometimes uncomfortable.
C. It was always enjoyable. D. It was quite easy to do.

PASSAGE 4 – Questions 31-40

Line Potash (the old name for potassium carbonate) is one of the two alkalis (the other being soda, sodium carbonate) that were used from remote antiquity in the making of glass, and from the early Middle Ages in the making of soap: the former being the product of heating a mixture of alkali and sand, **the latter** a product of alkali and vegetable oil. Their importance in the communities of colonial North America need hardly be stressed.

Potash and soda are not **interchangeable** for all purposes, but for glass-or soap-making either would do. Soda was obtained largely from the ashes of certain Mediterranean sea plants, potash from those of inland vegetation. Hence potash was more familiar to the early European settlers of the North American continent.

The settlement at Jamestown in Virginia was in many ways a microcosm of the economy of colonial North America, and potash was one of its first concerns. It was required for the glassworks, the first factory in the British colonies, and was produced in sufficient quantity to permit the inclusion of potash in the first cargo shipped out of Jamestown. The second ship to arrive in the settlement from England included among its passengers experts in potash making.

The method of making potash was simple enough. Logs was piled up and burned in the open, and the ashes collected. The ashes were placed in a barrel with holes in the bottom, and water was poured over them. The solution draining from the barrel was boiled down in iron kettles. The resulting mass was further heated to fuse the mass into what was called potash.

In North America, potash making quickly became an **adjunct** to the clearing of land for agriculture, for it was estimated that as much as half the cost of clearing land could be recovered by the sale of potash. Some potash was exported from Maine and New Hampshire in the seventeenth century, but the market turned out to be mainly domestic, consisting mostly of shipments from the northern to the southern colonies. For despite the beginning of the trade at Jamestown and such encouragements as a series of acts to encourage the making of potash, beginning in 1707 in South Carolina, the softwoods in the South proved to be poor sources of the substance.

31. What aspect of potash does the passage mainly discuss?

- A. How it was made
- B. Its value as a product for export
- C. How it differs from other alkalis
- D. Its importance in colonial North America

32. All of the following statements are true of both potash and soda EXCEPT

- A. They are alkalis.
- B. They are made from sea plants.
- C. They are used in making soap.
- D. They are used in making glass.

33. The phrase "**the latter**" in paragraph 1 refers to

- A. alkali
- B. glass
- C. sand
- D. soap

34. The word "**stressed**" in paragraph 1 could be best replaced by

- A. defined
- B. emphasized
- C. adjusted
- D. mentioned

35. The word "**interchangeable**" in paragraph 2 is closest in meaning to

- A. convenient
- B. identifiable
- C. equivalent
- D. advantageous

36. It can be inferred from the passage that potash was more common than soda in colonial North America because
- A. the materials needed for making soda were not readily available
 - B. making potash required less time than making soda
 - C. potash was better than soda for making glass and soap
 - D. the colonial glassworks found soda more difficult to use
37. According to paragraph 4, all of the following were needed for making potash EXCEPT
- A. wood
 - B. fire
 - C. sand
 - D. water
38. The word "**adjunct**" in paragraph 5 is closest in meaning to
- A. addition
 - B. answer
 - C. problem
 - D. possibility
39. According to the passage, a major benefit of making potash was that
- A. it could be exported to Europe in exchange for other goods
 - B. it helped finance the creation of farms
 - C. it could be made with a variety of materials
 - D. stimulated the development of new ways of glassmaking
40. According to paragraph 5, the softwoods in the South posed which of the following problems for southern settlers?
- A. The softwoods were not very plentiful.
 - B. The softwoods could not be used to build houses.
 - C. The softwoods were not very marketable.
 - D. The softwoods were not very useful for making potash.

C: WRITING

Time allowed: 60 minutes

No. of items: 2

TASK 1

You should spend about 20 minutes on this task.

Recently you had a party at your house. There was a lot of noise late at night and you disturbed your next door neighbour. Write a letter to your neighbour. In your letter

- explain the reasons for the noise
- apologise
- describe what action you will take to prevent it from happening again

Your response will be evaluated in terms of task fulfillment, organisation, vocabulary and grammar. You should write at least 120 words.

TASK 2

You should spend about 40 minutes on this task.

Although more and more people read news on the Internet, newspapers will remain the most important source of news. Do you agree or disagree?

Give reasons for your answer and include any relevant examples from your own experience or knowledge.

You should write at least 250 words.

D: SPEAKING

PART I: SOCIAL INTERACTION

Let's talk about movies

1. Do you like watching movies?
2. What kind of movies do you like? Why?
3. Do you prefer watching films on TV at home or at the cinema?

Now, let's talk about neighbours

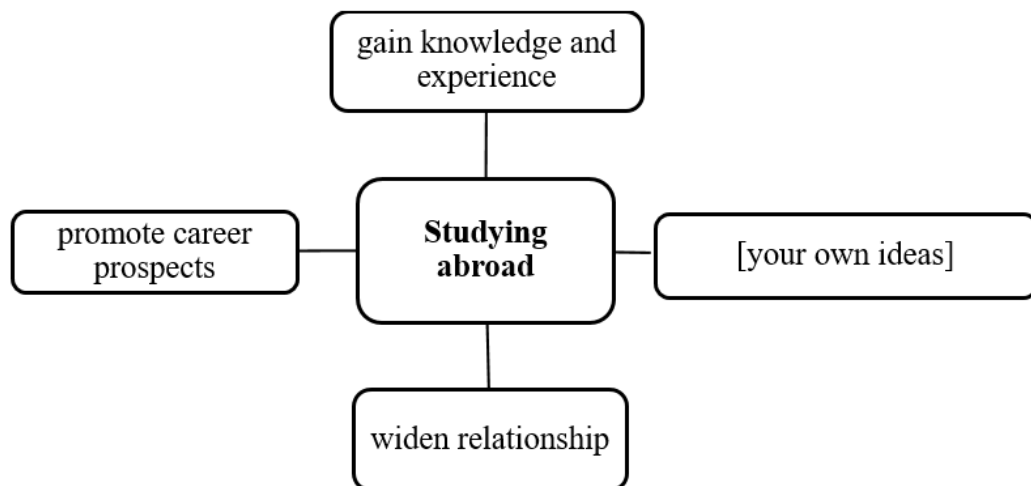
1. Do you know the people who live next door to you?
2. Do you get on well with your neighbors?
3. In what way are neighbors helpful?

PART II: SOLUTION DISCUSSION

You are considering having a holiday after a hard working week. Three places are suggested: a resort near the beach, a cottage in the countryside, a hotel in the mountainous area. Which do you think is the best choice?

PART III: TOPIC DEVELOPMENT

Discuss the advantages of studying abroad



TEST 3

A. LISTENING

Directions: This is the listening test for levels from 3 to 5 of the Vietnam's 6-level Language Proficiency Test. There are three parts to the test. You will hear each part once. For each part of the test there will be time for you to look through the questions and time for you to check your answers. Write your answers on the question paper. You will have 5 minutes at the end of the test to transfer your answers onto the answer sheet.

PART 1

There are eight questions in this part. For each question there are four options and a short recording. For each question, choose the correct answer A, B, C or D. You now have 48 seconds to look through the questions and the options in each question.

1. What have they forgotten?
A. ticket B. camera C. passport D. bag
2. What time does the train go?
A. 06.15 B. 07.40 C. 06.10 D. 07.10
3. How did the woman get to work?
A. by bicycle B. by bus C. by car D. by train
4. Where are the man's shoes?
A. under the chair B. by the television
C. by the door with the other rubbish D. under the table
5. What will Paul get at the shop?
A. mushrooms B. onions C. carrots D. red pepper
6. How were they told to do their homework?
A. write it in the books B. write it on paper C. type it D. email it
7. What did Helen buy?
A. gloves B. sweater C. socks D. hat
8. How did the woman get to work today?
A. by bus B. a neighbour offered her a lift C. by bike D. walk

PART 2: You will hear three different conversations. In each conversation there are four questions. For each question, choose the correct answer A, B, C or D. You will hear the conversations only once

Conversation 1. You will hear a conversation between a boy, Tyrone, and a receptionist.

9. What hours does the speaker work on Monday?
A. Noon to 6 PM B. 8:15 AM to 5 PM C. 7 AM to 12 PM D. 5 PM to 9 PM

10. On which two days does the speaker have the same schedule?

- A. Monday and Tuesday
- B. Wednesday and Thursday
- C. Tuesday and Thursday
- D. Thursday and Friday

11. What is the main purpose of the speaker's talk?

- A. To discuss the importance of the job
- B. To compare the work of doctors and dentists
- C. To describe a typical week at work
- D. To explain the details of a day at work

12. What does the speaker think of her work?

- A. She enjoys sleeping late every morning.
- B. It is difficult to describe her schedule.
- C. She enjoys helping the patients.
- D. It is too complicated to remember.

Conversation 2: Listen to the conversation and answer the questions

13. According to the conversation, which item did the woman NOT purchase with her credit card?

- A. a digital camera
- B. DVD player
- C. a TV
- D. a stereo

14. What is one reason to explain why the woman obtained a student credit card?

- A. She wants to buy things at a discount using the card
- B. She hopes to establish a good credit rating.
- C. She doesn't want to borrow from her parents.
- D. She can be financially independent.

15. What does the woman imply about how she plans on resolving her credit card problems?

- A. She hopes that someone will give her the money.
- B. She plans on getting rid of her student credit cards.
- C. She'll get a part-time job
- D. She is going to return the items she purchased on the card.

16. What is the man going to do for the woman to help her manage her money?

- A. help her find a better paying job to cover her expenses
- B. teach her how to prepare a financial management plan
- C. show her how she can apply for low-interest student credit cards
- D. teach her how to shop wisely.

Conversation 3. Listen to a conversation between a man and a florist.

17. Why does the customer not buy the recommended sandwich at the beginning of the conversation?

- A. It is too expensive.
- B. He is not interested in ordering a burger.
- C. It is not tasty.
- D. He fears the food will make him sick.

18. How does the specialty drink get its name?

- A. It contains a wide range of ingredients.
- B. It is prepared in the kitchen sink.
- C. It contains chicken soup.
- D. It comes in a very large cup.

19. Why was the man surprised by the price of his meal?
- A. He thought the drink should have been included.
 - B. He felt the meal was way overpriced.
 - C. He was charged for two sandwiches instead of one.
 - D. It was lower than he had expected.
20. What does the customer decide to do at the end of the conversation?
- A. He orders something from the restaurant menu.
 - B. He plans to come back at weekend.
 - C. He decides to look for another place to eat.
 - D. He plans to come in a week when the prices are lower.

PART 3

You will hear three different talks or lectures. In each talk or lecture there are five questions. For each question, choose the correct answer A, B, C or D. You will hear the talks or lectures only once.

Talk/Lecture 1. You will hear a woman called Sandy talking to a group of students about her job.

21. What did Sandy Duffy want to be when she was at school?
- A. a journalist B. a musician C. A director D. A basketball player
22. What did Sandy study at university?
- A. Math and Physics B. film making C. Technology D. Art
23. How did Sandy get her first job as a video game writer?
- A. She answered a job advertisement.
 - B. She met someone at a conference.
 - C. She sent some information about herself to a company.
 - D. She was invited by a friend.
24. What does Sandy like best about being a video game writer?
- A. the prizes she has won. B. the high salary
 - C. the people she works with D. the great working condition
25. What does Sandy dislike about being a video game writer?
- A. She has to travel a lot. B. She has to work long hours.
 - C. She often has to change her job. D. She has to live far from home.

Talk/Lecture 2: Listen and answer the questions

26. How long does the trek last?
- A. a day B. three days C. five days D. a week
27. The trek aims to raise money for
- A. health care B. school education C. hospital D. the old people
28. The cost of the trek includes
- A. flight and airport taxes B. medical provision and taxes
 - C. Foods D. Food and accommodation

29. Participants must

- A. walk across a glacier.
- B. complete a fitness course.
- C. agree to raise funds for the charity.
- D. pay amount of money.

30. The trip starts on

- A. 1st of November
- B. 3rd of November
- C. 13th of November
- D. 23th of November

Talk/Lecture 3. Listen to a woman talking about changes of India.

31. Where do many of the rich people live?

- A. next to the new road
- B. in the cities.
- C. in the countryside.
- D. in isolated places.

32. How long is the road?

- A. 600 kilometres
- B. 6,000 kilometers
- C. 60,000 kilometres
- D. 60 miles

33. What can you see on the computers at the road's headquarters in Delhi?

- A. small vehicles on the road
- B. any vehicle and problems on the road
- C. big vehicles on the road
- D. serious problems on the road

34. What types of transport can you see on the road?

- A. all types
- B. mostly cars
- C. mostly motorbikes
- D. the presenter doesn't say

35. Why does the presenter describe the new road as a symbol of India's future?

- A. because it's the same shape as the country of India.
- B. because it is modern, it is helping the economy grow.
- C. Because India has big population
- D. Because India has lots of transport

B: READING

Time permitted: 60 minutes

Number of questions: 40

Directions: In this section you will read *FOUR* different passages. Each one is followed by 10 questions about it. For questions 1-40, you are to choose the best answer A, B, C or D, to each question. Then, on your answer sheet, find the number of the question and fill in the space that corresponds to the letter of the answer you have chosen. Answer all questions following a passage on the basis of what is stated or implied in that passage.

You have 60 minutes to answer all the questions, including the time to transfer your answers to the answer sheet.

PASSAGE 1 – Questions 1-10

Phillis Wheatley was born in Gambia (in Africa) on May 8, 1753 and died in Boston on December 5, 1784.

When she was 7 or 8, she was sold as a slave to John and Susanna Wheatley of Boston. She was named after the ship that brought her to America, The Phillis.

The Poetry Foundation describes her sale:

In August 1761, "in want of a domestic," Susanna Wheatley, ... purchased "a slender, frail female child ... for a trifle" ... The captain of the slave ship believed that the waif was terminally ill, and he wanted ... at least a small profit before she died. ... The family surmised the girl—who was "of slender frame and evidently suffering from a change of climate," nearly naked, with "no other covering than a quantity of dirty carpet about her" - to be "about seven years old ... from the circumstances of shedding her front teeth." (<http://www.poetryfoundation.org/bio/phillis-wheatley>)

Phillis was very intelligent. The Wheatley family taught her to read and write, and encouraged her to write poetry. Her first poem "On Messrs. Hussey and Coffin" was published when she was only twelve. In 1770, "An Elegiac Poem, on the Death of that Celebrated Divine, and Eminent Servant of Jesus Christ, the Reverend and Learned George Whitefield" made her famous. It was published in Boston, Newport, and Philadelphia.

When she was eighteen, Phillis and Mrs. Wheatley tried to sell a collection containing twenty-eight of her poems. Colonists did not want to buy poetry written by an African. Mrs. Wheatley wrote to England to ask Selina Hastings, Countess of Huntingdon, for help. The countess was a wealthy supporter of evangelical and abolitionist (anti-slavery) causes. She had *Poems on Various Subjects, Religious and Moral* published in England in 1773. This book made Phillis famous in England and the thirteen colonies. She wrote a poem for George Washington in 1775, and he praised her work. They met in 1776. Phillis supported independence for the colonies during the Revolutionary War.

After her master died, Phillis was emancipated. She married John Peters, a free black man, in 1778. She and her husband lost two children as infants. John would be imprisoned for debt in 1784. Phillis and her remaining child died in December of 1784 and were buried in an unmarked grave. Nevertheless, the legacy of Phillis Wheatly lives on. She became the first African American and the first slave in the United States to publish a book. She proved that slaves or former slaves had a valuable voice in the Revolutionary era.

1. It can be inferred from the passage that the Countess of Huntingdon ...
 - A. didn't care about Phillis' poetry
 - B. helped Phillis get her writings published
 - C. believed in slavery
 - D. was surprised that Phillis could read and write
2. What question is answered in last paragraph?
 - A. Who did Phillis marry?
 - B. Where were Phillis' works published?
 - C. What did Phillis prove?
 - D. Why was Phillis a slave?

3. Phillis finally became free ...
 - A. when she published her poems in England
 - B. after meeting the Countess of Huntingdon
 - C. when she became wealthy
 - D. after her master died
4. Phillis' first attempt at selling her poetry in America (the colonies) was ...
 - A. illegal
 - B. imaginary
 - C. unsuccessful
 - D. successful
5. Which of the following is TRUE about Phillis Wheatley?
 - A. She was the first African-American slave to visit England.
 - B. She was the first African-American and slave to publish a book in the United States.
 - C. She was the first African-American and slave to be able to read and write
 - D. She was the first African-American and slave to meet George Washington.
6. The Wheatley family estimated the age of the slave girl they named "Phillis" by ...
 - A. her size
 - B. the condition of her teeth
 - C. her color
 - D. her weight
7. By the age of twelve, Phillis was ...
 - A. no longer a slave
 - B. married
 - C. a published poet
 - D. still not able to read or write
8. The slaveowner who sold Phillis to the Wheatley family believed ...
 - A. she would soon recover from her illness
 - B. she was very intelligent
 - C. she was worth a lot of money
 - D. she would soon die
9. Who was John Peters?
 - A. A military general
 - B. Somebody who Phillis admired greatly
 - C. Phillis' husband
 - D. A slave owner
10. Where is Phillis Wheatley buried?
 - A. No one knows
 - B. Africa
 - C. Boston
 - D. Virginia

PASSAGE 2 – Questions 11-20

The conservatism of the early English colonists in North America, their strong **attachment to** the English way of doing things, would play a major part in the furniture that was made in New England. The very tools that the first New England furniture makers used were, after all, not much different from those used for centuries- even millennia: basic hammers, saws, chisels, planes, augers, compasses, and measures. These were the tools used more or less by all people who worked with wood: carpenters, barrel makers, and shipwrights. At most the furniture makers might have had planes with special edges or more delicate chisels, but there could not have been much specialization in the early years of the colonies.

The furniture makers in those early decades of the 1600' s were known as "joiners," for the primary method of constructing furniture, at least among the English of this time, was that of mortise-and-tenon joinery. The mortise is the hole chiseled and cut into one piece of wood, while the tenon is the tongue or **protruding** element shaped from another piece of wood so that it fits into the mortise; and another small hole is then drilled (with the auger) through the mortised end and the tenon so that a whittled peg can secure the joint- thus the term "joiner." Panels were fitted into slots on the basic frames. This kind of construction was used for making everything from houses to chests.

Relatively little hardware was used during this period. Some nails- forged by hand- were used, but no screws or glue. Hinges were often made of leather, but metal hinges were also used. The cruder varieties were made by blacksmiths in the colonies, but the finer metal elements were imported. Locks and escutcheon plates - the latter to **shield** the wood from the metal key- would often be imported. Above all, what the early English colonists imported was their knowledge of, familiarity with, and dedication to the traditional types and designs of furniture **they** knew in England.

11. The phrase "**attachment to**" in line 1 is closest in meaning to
A. control of B. distance from C. curiosity about D. preference for
12. The word "**protruding**" in line 12 is closest in meaning to
A. parallel B. simple C. projecting D. important
13. The relationship of a mortise and a tenon is most similar to that of
A. a lock and a key B. a book and its cover
C. a cup and a saucer D. a hammer and a nail
14. For what purpose did woodworkers use an auger
A. To whittle a peg B. To make a tenon
C. To drill a hole D. To measure a panel
15. Which of the following were NOT used in the construction of colonial furniture?
A. Mortises B. Nails C. Hinges D. Screws
16. The author implies that colonial metalworkers were
A. unable to make elaborate parts B. more skilled than woodworkers
C. more conservative than other colonists D. frequently employed by joiners
17. The word "**shield**" in line 20 is closest in meaning to
A. decorate B. copy C. shape D. protect
18. The word "**they**" in line 25 refers to
A. designs B. types C. colonists D. all
19. The author implies that the colonial joiners
A. were highly paid
B. based their furniture on English models
C. used many specialized tools
D. had to adjust to using new kinds of wood in New England
20. Which of the following terms does the author explain in the passage?
A. "millennia" B. "joiners" C. "whittled" D. "blacksmiths"

PASSAGE 3 – Questions 21-30

In addition to their military role, the forts of the nineteenth century provided numerous other benefits for the American West. The establishment of these posts opened new roads and provided for the protection of **daring** adventurers and expeditions as well as established settlers. Forts also served as bases where enterprising entrepreneurs could bring commerce to the West, providing supplies and refreshments to soldiers as well as to pioneers. Posts like Fort Laramie provided supplies for wagon trains traveling the natural highways toward new frontiers. Some posts became stations for the pony express; still **others**, such as Fort Davis, were stagecoach stops for weary travelers. All of these functions, of course, suggest that the contributions of the forts to the civilization and development of the West extended beyond patrol duty.

Through the establishment of military posts, yet other contributions were made to the development of western culture. Many posts maintained libraries or reading rooms, and some - for example, Fort Davis- had schools. Post chapels provided a setting for religious services and weddings. Throughout the wilderness, post bands provided entertainment and **boosted** morale. During the last part of the nineteenth century, to reduce expenses, gardening was encouraged at the forts, thus making experimental agriculture another activity of the military. The military stationed at the various forts also played a role in civilian life by assisting in maintaining order, and civilian officials often called on the army for protection.

Certainly, among other significant contributions the army made to the improvement of the conditions of life was the investigation of the relationships among health, climate, and architecture. From the earliest colonial times throughout the nineteenth century, disease ranked as the foremost problem in defense. It slowed construction of forts and **inhibited** their military functions. Official documents from many regions contained innumerable reports of sickness that virtually incapacitated entire garrisons. In response to the problems, detailed observations of architecture and climate and their relationships to the frequency of the occurrence of various diseases were recorded at various posts across the nation by military surgeons.

21. Which of the following statements best expresses the main idea of the passage?

- A. By the nineteenth century, forts were no longer used by the military.
- B. Surgeons at forts could not prevent outbreaks of disease.
- C. Forts were important to the development of the American West
- D. Life in nineteenth-century forts was very rough.

22. The word "**daring**" in line 3 is closest in meaning to

- A. lost
- B. bold
- C. lively
- D. foolish

23. Which of the following would a traveler be likely be LEAST likely to obtain at Fort Laramie?

- A. Fresh water
- B. Food
- C. Formal clothing
- D. Lodging

24. The word "**others**" in line 7 refers to

- A. posts
- B. wagon trains
- C. frontiers
- D. highways

25. The word "**boosted**" in line 13 is closest in meaning to

- A. influenced
- B. established
- C. raised
- D. maintained

26. Which of the following is the most likely inference about the decision to promote gardening at forts?

- A. It was expensive to import produce from far away.
- B. Food brought in from outside was often spoiled
- C. Gardening was a way to occupy otherwise idle soldiers.
- D. The soil near the forts was very fertile.

27. According to the passage, which of the following posed the biggest obstacle to the development of military forts?
- A. Insufficient shelter B. Shortage of materials
C. Attacks by wild animals D. Illness
28. The word “inhibited” in line 22 is closest in meaning to
- A. involved B. exploited C. united D. hindered
29. How did the military assist in the investigation of health problems?
- A. By registering annual birth and death rates
B. By experiments with different building materials
C. By maintaining records of diseases and potential causes
D. By monitoring the soldiers’ diets
30. The author organizes the discussion of forts by
- A. describing their locations
B. comparing their sizes
C. explaining their damage to the environment
D. listing their contributions to western life

PASSAGE 4 – Questions 31-40

Anyone who has handled a fossilized bone knows that it is usually not exactly like its modern counterpart, the most obvious difference being that it is often much heavier. Fossils often have the quality of stone rather than of organic materials, and this has led to the use of the term “petrification” (to bring about rock). The implication is that bone, and other tissues, have somehow been turned into stone, and this is certainly the explanation given in some texts. But it is wrong interpretation; fossils are frequently so dense because the pores and other spaces in the bone have become filled with minerals taken up from the surrounding sediments. Some fossil bones have all the interstitial spaces filled with foreign minerals, including the marrow cavity, if there is one, while others have taken up but little from their surroundings. Probably all of the minerals deposited within the bone have been recrystallized from solution by the action of water percolating thru them. The degree of mineralization appears to be determined by the nature of the environment in which the bone was deposited and not by the antiquity of the bone. For example, the black fossil bones that are so common in many parts of Florida are heavily mineralized, but they are only about 20,000 years old, whereas many of the dinosaur bones from western Canada, which are about 75 million years old, are only partially filled in. Under optimum conditions the process of mineralization probably takes thousands rather than millions of years, perhaps considerably less.

The amount of change that has occurred in fossil bone, even in bone as old as that of dinosaurs, is often remarkably small. We are therefore usually able to see the microscopic structures of the bone, including such fine details as the lacunae where the living bone cells once resided. The natural bone mineral, the hydroxyapatite, is virtually unaltered too - it has the same crystal structure as that of modern bone. Although nothing remains of the original collagen, some of its component amino acids are usually still detectable, together with amino acids of the noncollagen proteins of bone.

31. What does the passage mainly discuss?
- A. The location of fossils in North America B. The composition of fossils
C. Determining the size and weight of fossils D. Procedures for analyzing fossils

32. The word “**counterpart**” in line 2 is closest in meaning to
A. species B. version C. change D. material
33. Why is fossilized bone heavier than ordinary bone?
A. Bone tissue solidifies with age. B. The marrow cavity gradually fills with water
C. The organic materials turn to stone D. Spaces within the bone fill with minerals.
34. The word “**pores**” in line 6 is closest in meaning to.....
A. joints B. tissues C. lines D. holes
35. What can be inferred about a fossil with a high degree of mineralization?
A. It was exposed to large amounts of mineral-laden water throughout time.
B. Mineralization was complete within one year of the animal’s death.
C. Many colorful crystals can be found in such a fossil.
D. It was discovered in western Canada.
36. Which of the following factors is most important in determining the extent of mineralization in fossil bones?
A. The age of fossil
B. Environmental conditions
C. The location of the bone in the animal’s body.
D. The type of animal the bone came from
37. Why does the author compare fossils found in western Canada to those found in Florida?
A. To prove that a fossil’s age cannot be determined by the amount of mineralization.
B. To discuss the large quantity of fossils found in both places
C. To suggest that fossils found in both places were the same age.
D. To explain why scientists are especially interested in Canadian fossils
38. The word “**it**” in line 20 refers to
A. hydroxyapatite B. microscopic structure
C. crystal structure D. modern bone
39. The word “**detectable**” in line 22 is closest in meaning to
A. sizable B. active C. moist D. apparent
40. Which of the following does NOT survive in fossils?
A. Noncollagen proteins B. Hydroxyapatite C. Collagen D. Amino acid

C: WRITING

Time allowed: 60 minutes

No. of items: 2

TASK 1

You should spend about 20 minutes on this task.

You are planning to spend a weekend at a hotel with your family. Write a letter to the hotel making the arrangements. Ask them the following:

- when you want to arrive and leave
- what type of rooms you would like and ask how much they will cost
- you are interested to now about activities and places of interest near the hotel

Your response will be evaluated in terms of task fulfillment, organisation, vocabulary and grammar. You should write at least 120 words

TASK 2

You should spend about 40 minutes on this task.

People who live in large cities face a range of problems in their daily life.

What are the main problems people in cities face, and how can these problems be tackled?

Give reasons for your answer and include any relevant examples from your own experience or knowledge.

You should write at least 250 words.

D: SPEAKING

PART I: SOCIAL INTERACTION

Let's talk about parks

1. Do you like to go to the park?
2. Do people go to parks in your area?
3. What make a good park?

Now, let's talk about pets

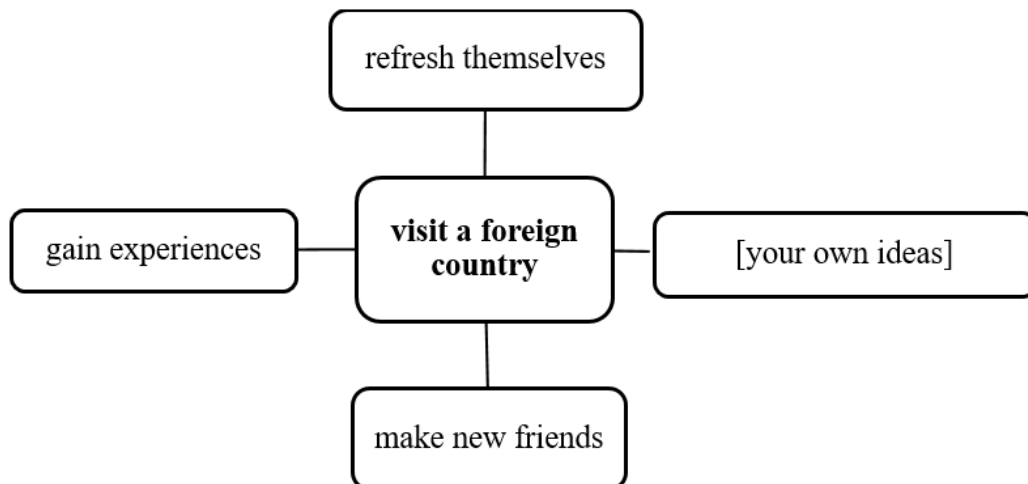
1. What is your favorite pet?
2. Do you have a pet at home?
3. What are the benefits of keepingpets?

PART II: SOLUTION DISCUSSION

Your friend wants to take up a new hobby. He is considering three activities: doing yoga, playing the piano and joining a charity club. Which do you think is the best choice for him?

PART III: TOPIC DEVELOPMENT

Why visiting a foreign country is a valuable experience for people



TEST 4

A: LISTENING

Directions: This is the listening test for levels from 3 to 5 of the Vietnam's 6-level Language Proficiency Test. There are three parts to the test. You will hear each part once. For each part of the test there will be time for you to look through the questions and time for you to check your answers. Write your answers on the question paper. You will have 5 minutes at the end of the test to transfer your answers onto the answer sheet.

PART 1

There are eight questions in this part. For each question there are four options and a short recording. For each question, choose the correct answer A, B, C or D. You now have 48 seconds to look through the questions and the options in each question.

1. What is John going to do tonight?

- A. swimming B. cycling C. playing football D. running

2. Which bag does the woman buy?

- A. square bag B. small and round bag C. a big bag D. an oval bag

3. How much did the woman pay for the apples?

- A. 30 pence B. 35 pence C. 40 pence D. 34 pence

4. When must the boys get on the coach?

- A. 12:50 B. 01:30 C. 02:30 D. 03:20

5. What fruit do they take?

- A. oranges B. bananas C. grapes D. apples

6. Which present has the man bought?

- A. book B. bag C. gloves D. flowers

7. Where are the photographs?

- A. on the bookshelf B. on the TV
C. on the table with the coffee cups D. in the café shop

8. What did Ben break?

- A. vase B. glass C. cup D. dinner bowls

PART 2

You will hear three different conversations. In each conversation there are four questions. For each question, choose the correct answer A, B, C or D. You will hear the conversations only once.

Conversation 1. You will hear a conversation between a boy, Tyrone, and a receptionist.

9. When is the picnic?

- A. on Thursday B. on Friday C. on Saturday D. on Sunday

10. Where is the picnic being held?

- A. at a park B. at the beach C. at Dave's house D. by a river

11. How many packages of hot dogs do they decide to buy?

- A. 6 B. 7 C. 8 D. 9

12. What does Dave suggest Scott make for the picnic dessert?

- A. cherry pie B. chocolate cake. C. oatmeal cookies D. fudge brownies

Conversation 2: Listen and answer the following questions

13. What does the boy want to do at the beginning of the conversation?

- A. go play outside B. play video games C. watch TV D. play football

14. What does the boy have to do in his bedroom?

- A. put away his books B. make his bed
C. pick up his dirty clothes. D. clean the floor.

15. What is the father going to do while the boy is doing his household chores?

- A. wash the car B. paint the house.
C. work in the yard D. clean the floor

16. Where will the father and son go after the housework is done?

- A. to a movie B. out to eat C. to a ball game D. to a shopping center.

Conversation 3: Listen and answer the following questions

17. What time does the plane depart?

- A. 6:00 AM B. 7:30 AM C. 8:00 AM D. 9:00 AM

18. How will the group get to the hotel from the airport?

- A. They will take taxis B. They will ride the subway.
C. They will be going by bus. D. They can choose either bus or subway

19. What is the group planning to do around Times Square for about an hour?

- A. They're going to have lunch. B. They will have time to do some shopping.
C. They will see a festival. D. They will be having a tour of the area.

20. What are they going to do after dinner?

- A. The group is going to watch a musical. B. They will catch an exciting movie.
C. They will be attending a Broadway play. D. They will see a football match.

PART 3

You will hear three different talks or lectures. In each talk or lecture there are five questions. For each question, choose the correct answer A, B, C or D. You will hear the talks or lectures only once.

Talk/Lecture 1. You will hear a man called Frank, talking on the radio about looking for ships that sank at sea long ago.

21. The first old ship which Frank found was

- A. covered by rocks B. older than he first thought
- C. easy to find D. had a lot of gold

22. Why did Frank find the ships so quickly?

- A. reads history books. B. is a professional driver.
- C. his friends helped him. D. uses the latest equipment.

23. What does Frank say about the ship called The Seabird?

- A. It was so expensive. B. It was built in 1859.
- C. It sank in a storm. D. It was badly made.

24. What did Frank say about his wedding ring?

- A. was made from gold he found himself. B. it was given by someone
- C. is worth 88,000 pounds. D. was found by a friend.

25. How did Frank learn to dive?

- A. by joining a diving club B. by asking the dive tutor
- C. by teaching himself D. by going on a diving holiday

Talk/Lecture 2. You will hear an interview with a woman called Rachel who is talking about the shows she puts on for children.

26. The Black Rock Caves have been home for....

- A. Two million years B. A million year
- C. A half a million year D. centuries

27. When can the cave attract the tourists?

- A. from April to October B. April C. October D. August

28. Salter house was built in

- A. 1765s B. 1756s C. 1928s D. 1982s

29. The things that are worth to visit in Salter house is

- A. the furniture B. the paintings C. the enormous meals D. the kitchen

30. What should tourists do as visiting The Old Port?

- A. take an old trek to visit the riverside B. buy different traditional costumes
- C. try sweets made in the Tea Shop D. visit the village factory

Talk/Lecture 3. Listen to a lecture about culture study.

31. What does the professor say about the elements in the body?

- A. Ideally, these should be different amounts of each.
- B. The amount of each in the body is not very important.
- C. They can be out of balance.
- D. Different people have different elements.

32. According to the professor, what are yin and yang?

- A. They are opposite forces.
- B. They are what make a person healthy.
- C. They are four different elements.
- D. They are the land and the ocean.

33. What does the professor say about yin and yang?

- A. They are always in balance.
- B. They are always changing.
- C. They don't need to be in balance.
- D. They compare with each other.

34. According to the Chinese, five elements of Yin and Yang are studied for the work of

- A. the body and spirit
- B. body, mind and spirit work
- C. balance and harmony

35. Why does the professor says "Yin and Yang should be considered as opposite forces like, uhh, like land and ocean, for example"?

- A. To correct something she said earlier
- B. To explain a term she just introduced
- C. To explain what is wrong with a particular theory
- D. To remind the students of something discussed earlier

B: READING

Time permitted: 60 minutes

Number of questions: 40

Directions: In this section you will read *FOUR* different passages. Each one is followed by 10 questions about it. For questions 1-40, you are to choose the best answer A, B, C or, to each question. Then, on your answer sheet, find the number of the question and fill in the space that corresponds to the letter of the answer you have chosen. Answer all questions following a passage on the basis of what is stated or implied in that passage.

You have 60 minutes to answer all the questions, including the time to transfer your answers to the answer sheet.

PASSAGE 1 – Questions 1-10

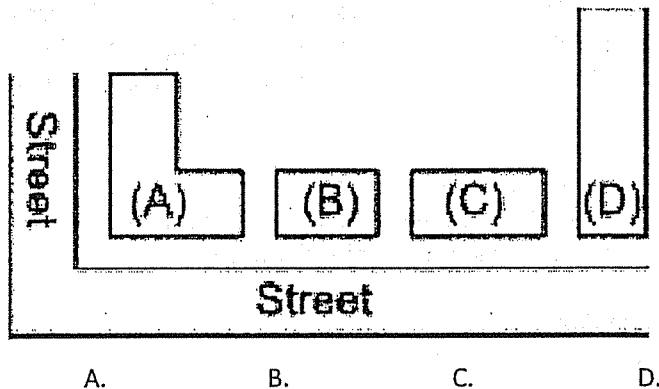
In the last third of the nineteenth century a new housing form was quietly being developed. In 1869 the Stuyvesant, considered New York's first apartment house was built on East Eighteenth Street. The building was financed by the developer Rutherford Stuyvesant and designed by Richard Morris Hunt, the first American architect to graduate from the Ecole des Beaux Arts in Paris. Each man had lived in Paris, and each understood the economics and social potential of this Parisian housing form. But the Stuyvesant was at best a limited success. In spite of Hunt's *inviting* facade, the living space was awkwardly arranged. Those who could afford them were quite content to remain in the more *sumptuous*, single-family homes, leaving the Stuyvesant to young married couples and bachelors.

The fundamental problem with the Stuyvesant and the other early apartment buildings that quickly followed, in the 1870's and early 1880's was that they were confined to the typical New York building lot. That lot was a rectangular area 25 feet wide by 100 feet deep - a shape perfectly suited for a row house. The lot could also accommodate a rectangular tenement, though it could not *yield* the square, well-lighted, and logically arranged rooms that great apartment buildings require. But even with the awkward interior configurations of the early apartment buildings, the idea caught on. It met the needs of a large and growing population that wanted something better than tenements but could not afford or did not want row houses.

So while the city's newly emerging social leadership commissioned their mansions, apartment houses and hotels began to sprout in multiple lots, thus breaking the initial space constraints. In the closing decades of the nineteenth century, large apartment houses began dotting the developed portions of New York City, and by the opening decades of the twentieth century, spacious buildings, such as the Dakota and the Ansonia finally transcended the tight confinement of row house building lots. From there it was only a small step to building luxury apartment houses on the newly created Park Avenue, right next to the fashionable Fifth Avenue shopping area.

1. The new housing form discussed in the passage refers to
A. single-family homes B. apartment buildings
C. row houses D. hotels
2. The word "*inviting*" in line 6 is closest in meaning to
A. open B. encouraging C. attractive D. asking
3. Why was the Stuyvesant a limited success?
A. The arrangement of the rooms was not convenient.
B. Most people could not afford to live there.
C. There were no shopping areas nearby.
D. It was in a crowded neighborhood.

4. The word “sumptuous” in line 8 is closest in meaning to
A. luxurious B. unique C. modern D. distant
5. It can be inferred that the majority of people who lived in New York’s first apartments were
A. highly educated B. unemployed C. wealthy D. young
6. It can be inferred that the typical New York building lot of the 1870’s and 1880’s looked MOST like which of the following?



7. It can be inferred that a New York apartment building in the 1870’s and 1880’s had all of the following characteristics EXCEPT
A. Its room arrangement was not logical. B. It was rectangular.
C. It was spacious inside. D. It had limited light.
8. The word “yield” in line 13 is closest in meaning to
A. harvest B. surrender C. amount D. provide
9. Why did the idea of living in an apartment become popular in the late 1800’s?
A. Large families needed housing with sufficient space.
B. Apartments were preferable to tenements and cheaper than row houses.
C. The city officials of New York wanted housing that was centrally located.
D. The shape of early apartments could accommodate a variety of interior designs.
10. The author mentions the Dakota and the Ansonia in line 22 because
A. they are examples of large, well designed apartment buildings
B. their design is similar to that of row houses
C. they were built on a single building lot
D. they are famous hotels

PASSAGE 2 – Questions 11-20

A snowfall consists of myriads of **minute** ice crystals that fall to the ground in the form of frozen precipitation. The formation of snow begins with these ice crystals in the subfreezing strata of the middle and upper atmosphere when there is an adequate supply of moisture present. At the core of every ice crystal is a minuscule nucleus, a solid particle of matter around which moisture condenses and freezes. Liquid water droplets floating in the supercooled atmosphere and free ice crystals cannot coexist within the same cloud, since the vapor pressure of ice is less than that of water. This enables the ice crystals to rob the liquid droplets of their moisture and grow continuously. The process can be very rapid, quickly creating sizable ice crystals, some of which **adhere** to each other to create a cluster

of ice crystals or a snowflake. Simple flakes possess a variety of beautiful forms, usually hexagonal, though the symmetrical shapes reproduced in most microscope photography of snowflakes are not usually found in actual snowfalls. Typically, snowflakes in actual snowfall consists of broken fragments and clusters of adhering ice crystals.

For a snowfall to continue once it starts, there must be a constant inflow of moisture to supply the nuclei. This moisture is supplied by the passage of an airstream over a water surface and its subsequent lifting to higher regions of the atmosphere. The Pacific Ocean is the source of moisture for most snowfalls west of the Rocky Mountains, while the Gulf of Mexico and the Atlantic Ocean feed water vapor into the air currents over the central and eastern sections of the United States. Other geographical features also can be the source of moisture for some snowstorms. For example, areas adjacent to the Great Lakes experience their own unique lake-effect storms, employing a variation of the process on a local scale. In addition, mountainous section or rising terrain can **initiate** snowfalls by the geographical lifting of a moist airstream.

11. Which of the following questions does the author answer in the first paragraph?
A. Why are snowflakes hexagonal? B. What is the optimum temperature for snow?
C. In which months does most snow fall? D. How are snowflakes formed?
12. The word "minute" in line 1 is closest in meaning to
A. tiny B. quick C. clear D. sharp
13. What is at the center of an ice crystal?
A. A small snowflake B. A nucleus C. A drop of water D. A hexagon
14. The word "adhere" in line 8 is closest in meaning to
A. belong B. relate C. stick D. speed
15. What is the main topic of the second paragraph?
A. How ice crystals form
B. How moisture affects temperature
C. What happens when ice crystals melt
D. Where the moisture to supply the nuclei comes from
16. The word "it" in line 13 refers to
A. snowfall B. snowflake C. cluster D. moisture
17. What is necessary for a snowfall to persist?
A. A decrease in the number of snowflakes B. Lowered vapor pressure in ice crystals
C. A continuous infusion of moisture D. A change in the direction of the airstream
18. How do lake-effect snowstorms form?
A. Water temperature drop below freezing.
B. Moisture rises from a lake into the airstream.
C. Large quantities of wet air come off a nearby mountain.
D. Millions of ice crystals form on the surface of a large lake.
19. The word "initiate" in line 20 is closest in meaning to
A. enhance B. alter C. increase D. begin

20. Which of the following could account for the lack of snowfall in a geographical location close to mountains and a major water source?

- A. Ground temperatures below the freezing point
- B. Too much moisture in the air
- C. Too much wind off the mountains
- D. Atmospheric temperatures above the freezing point.

PASSAGE 3 – Questions 21-30

Social parasitism involves one species relying on another to raise its young. Among vertebrates, the best known social parasites are such birds as cuckoos and cowbirds; the female lays an egg in a nest belonging to another species and leaves it for the host to rear.

The dulotic species of ants, however, are the supreme social parasites. Consider, for example, the unusual behavior of ants belonging to the genus *Polyergus*. All species of this ant have lost the ability to care for themselves. The workers do not forage for food, feed their brood or queen, or even dean their own nest. To compensate for these deficits, *Polyergus* has become specialized at obtaining workers from the related genus *Formica* to do these chores.

In a raid, several thousand *Polyergus* workers will travel up to 500 feet in search of a *Formica* nest, penetrate it, drive off the queen and tier workers, capture the pupal brood, and transport it back to their nest. The captured brood is then reared by the resident *Formica* workers until the developing pupae emerge to add to the *Formica* population, which maintains the mixed-species nest. The *Formica* workers forage for food and give it to colony members of both species. They also remove wastes and excavate new chambers as the population increases.

The true extent of the *Polyergus* ants' dependence on the *Formica* becomes apparent when the worker population grows too large for the existing nest. *Formica* scouts locate a new nesting site, return to the mixed-species colony, and recruit additional *Formica* nest mates. During a period that may last seven days, the *Formica* workers carry to the new nest all the *Polyergus* eggs, larvae, and pupae, every *Polyergus* adult, and even the *Polyergus* queen.

Of the approximately 8,000 species of ants in the world, all 5 species of *Polyergus* and some 200 species in other genera have evolved some degree of parasitic relationship with other ants.

21. Which of the following statements best represents the main idea of the passage?

- A. Ants belonging to the genus *Formica* are incapable of performing certain tasks.
- B. The genus *Polyergus* is quite similar to the genus *Formica*.
- C. Ants belonging to the genus *Polyergus* have an unusual relationship with ants belonging to the genus *Formica*.
- D. *Polyergus* ants frequently leave their nests to build new colonies.

22. The word "raise" in line 1 is closest in meaning to.....

- A. rear
- B. lift
- C. collect
- D. increase

23. The author mentions cuckoos and cowbirds in line 2 because they

- A. share their nests with each other
- B. are closely related species
- C. raise the young of other birds
- D. are social parasites

24. The word "it" in line 3 refers to

- A. species
- B. nest
- C. egg
- D. female

25. What does the author mean by stating that "The dulotic species of lifts... are die supreme social parasites" (line 4)?
- A. The Polyergus are more highly developed than die Formica.
 - B. The Formica have developed specialized roles.
 - C. The Polyergus are heavily dependent on the Formica.
 - D. The Formica do not reproduce rapidly enough to care for themselves
26. Which of the following is a task that an ant of the genus Polyergus might do?
- A. Look for food.
 - B. Raid another nest
 - C. Care for the young.
 - D. Clean its own nest.
27. The word "excavate" in line 14 is closest in meaning to
- A. find
 - B. clean
 - C. repair
 - D. dig
28. The word "recruit" in line 18 is closest in meaning
- A. create
 - B. enlist
 - C. endure
 - D. capture
29. What happens when a mixed colony of Polyergus and Formica ants becomes too large?
- A. The Polyergus workers enlarge the existing nest.
 - B. The captured Formica workers return to their original nest.
 - C. The Polyergus and the Formica build separate nests.
 - D. The Polyergus and the Formica move to a new nest.
30. According to the information in the passage, all of the following terms refer to ants belonging to the genus Formica EXCEPT the
- A. dulotic species of ants
 - B. captured brood
 - C. developing pupae
 - D. worker population

PASSAGE 4 – Questions 31-40

The Winterthur Museum is a collection and a house. There are many museums devoted to the decorative arts and many house museums, but rarely in the United States is a great collection displayed in a great country house. Passing through successive generations of a single family, Winterthur has been a private estate for more than a century. Even after the extensive renovations made to it between 1929 and 1931, the house remained a family residence. This fact is of importance to the atmosphere and effect of the museum. *The impression of a lived-in house is apparent to the visitor*; the rooms look as if they were vacated only a short while ago whether by the original owners of the furniture or the most recent residents of the house can be a matter of personal interpretation. Winterthur remains, then, a house in which a collection of furniture and architectural elements has been assembled. Like an English country house, it is an organic structure; the house, as well as the collection and manner of displaying it to the visitor, has changed over the years. The changes have coincided with developing concepts of the American arts, increased knowledge on the part of collectors and students, and a progression toward the achievement of a historical effect in period-room displays. The rooms at Winterthur have followed this current, yet still retained the character of a private house.

The concept of a period room as a display technique has developed gradually over the years in an effort to present works of art in a context that would show them to greater effect and would give them more meaning for the viewer. Comparable to the habitat group in a natural history museum, the period room represents the decorative arts in a lively and interesting manner and provides an opportunity to assemble objects related by style, date, or place of manufacture.

31. What does the passage mainly discuss?

- A. The reason that Winterthur was redesigned
 - B. Elements that make Winterthur an unusual museum
 - C. How Winterthur compares to English country houses
 - D. Historical furniture contained in Winterthur
32. The phrase "devoted to" in line 1 is closest in meaning to
- A. surrounded by
 - B. specializing in
 - C. successful with
 - D. sentimental about
33. What happened at Winterthur between 1929 and 1931?
- A. The owners moved out.
 - B. The house was repaired.
 - C. The old furniture was replaced.
 - D. The estate became a museum.
34. What does the author mean by stating "The impression of a lived-in house is apparent to the visitor" (line 6)?
- A. Winterthur is very old.
 - B. Few people visit Winterthur.
 - C. Winterthur does not look like a typical museum.
 - D. The furniture at Winterthur looks comfortable.
35. The word "assembled" in line 9 is closest in meaning to
- A. summoned
 - B. appreciated
 - C. brought together
 - D. fundamentally changed
36. The word "it" in line 10 refers to
- A. Winterthur
 - B. collection
 - C. English country house
 - D. visitor
37. The word "developing" in line 11 is closest in meaning to
- A. traditional
 - B. exhibiting
 - C. informative
 - D. evolving
38. According to the passage, objects in a period room are related by all of the following EXCEPT
- A. date
 - B. style
 - C. place of manufacture
 - D. past ownership
39. What is the relationship between the two paragraphs in the passage?
- A. The second paragraph explains a term that was mentioned in the first paragraph.
 - B. Each paragraph describes a different approach to the display of objects in a museum.
 - C. The second paragraph explains a philosophy of art appreciation that contrasts with the philosophy explained in the first paragraph.
 - D. Each paragraph describes a different historical period.
40. Where in the passage does the author explain why displays at Winterthur have changed?
- A. lines 1-3
 - B. lines 4-6
 - C. lines 5-7
 - D. lines 9-12

C: WRITING

Time allowed: 60 minutes

No. of items: 2

TASK 1

You should spend about 20 minutes on this task.

You recently subscribed to a new magazine. A representative of magazine has asked you to give some feedback on their magazine. Write a letter to the representative of the magazine that includes the following information:

- detail of why you bought the magazine
- what you liked about the latest edition
- any improvements you would recommend

Your response will be evaluated in terms of task fulfillment, organisation, vocabulary and grammar. You should write at least 120 words.

TASK 2

You should spend about 40 minutes on this task.

Many students work while attending university for many different reasons

In your opinion, do the advantages of students' doing part time job outweigh its disadvantages?

Give reasons for your answer and include any relevant examples from your own experience or knowledge.

You should write at least 250 words.

D: SPEAKING

PART I: SOCIAL INTERACTION

Let's talk about hobbies

1. What do you do in your spare time?
2. Do you prefer spending your time alone or with others?
3. What are good hobbies and bad hobbies?

Now, let's talk about computer games

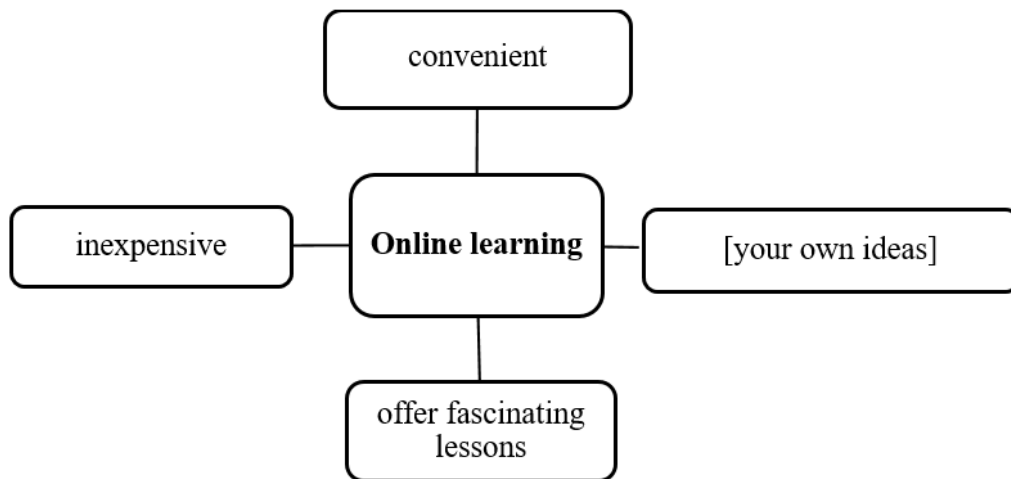
1. Do you enjoy playing computer games? Why/why not?
2. What kinds of games have you ever played?
3. Do you think computer games are good for small children?

PART II: SOLUTION DISCUSSION

Your friend is considering three ways to improve his/her English: Watching films, reading books and talking with foreigners. Which do you think is the best choice for him/her?

PART III: TOPIC DEVELOPMENT

Why online learning is beneficial to students



TEST 5

A: LISTENING

Directions: This is the listening test for levels from 3 to 5 of the Vietnam's 6-level Language Proficiency Test. There are three parts to the test. You will hear each part once. For each part of the test there will be time for you to look through the questions and time for you to check your answers. Write your answers on the question paper. You will have 5 minutes at the end of the test to transfer your answers onto the answer sheet.

PART 1

There are eight questions in this part. For each question there are four options and a short recording. For each question, choose the correct answer **A, B, C** or **D**. You now have 48 seconds to look through the questions and the options in each question.

1. What time is it?

- A. 02.10 B. 02.20 C. 02.30 D. 03.20

2. What's Michelle going to read?

- A. book B. letter C. newspaper D. magazine

3. How much did the tickets cost?

- A. \$19 B. \$90 C. \$99 D. \$9

4. What is the man going to buy?

- A. sunglasses B. something to read C. pills D. food

5. Which dress is Kate talking about?

- A. a dress with no button B. a dress with many buttons
C. a dress with collar D. a dress with no collar

6. When will Jane meet them?

- A. 08:00 B. 08:30 C. 08:45 D. 03:15

7. Which morning activity is for beginners?

- A. windsurfing B. swimming C. sailing D. running

8. Which painting does the woman decide to buy?

- A. a painting with boats B. a painting with flowers
C. a painting with horses D. a painting with white clouds

PART 2

You will hear three different conversations. In each conversation there are four questions. For each question, choose the correct answer **A, B, C** or **D**. You will hear the conversations only once.

Conversation 1. You will hear a conversation between Matthew and his mother

9. Why doesn't his mother lend him her car?

- A. Because her car doesn't work well today B. Because he can't drive
C. Because she needs the car D. Because he can walk

10. What will Matthew do after class?

- A. move his books B. move his flat C. help his friend D. repair his car

11. When is his mother's meeting?

- A. Thursday 19th B. Friday 9th C. Wednesday 9th D. Not discussed

12. What is true about the conversation?

- A. Matthew forgot to ask his mother about her car
B. His mother refused to lend him her car.
C. His mother agrees to take him to school by car
D. This problem is due to his mother's mistake

Conversation 2. Listen to an interview about indoor skydiving

13. Where does he play this sport?

- A. in a wind tunnel B. from an aeroplane outdoor C. in a park D. from a high hill

14. What is the name of the sport center?

- A. Vertical Tunnel center B. Extreme sports center
C. Runaway D. Adventure sports center

15. What is it like to be in the wind tunnel?

- A. you stand on bars B. you stay afloat
C. your hair is dried D. you fly up high.

16. How dangerous is this sport?

- A. Glass might break and hurt you B. You suffer from small injuries
C. You might fly off the tunnel D. You can't stop flying up

Conversation 3. Listen to a conversation between a director of study in an English language center and a student representative talking about their self-access center.

17. What are the main topic of the conversation?

- A. to know how students used the center
B. to know what to do with the center
C. to talk about the effectiveness of the library
D. to learn how to use the library effectively

18. What are the main problem of the center?

- A. too many resources B. slow computers
C. lack of valuable resource D. lack of computers

19. The director complains that students are using computer for

- A. looking for personal resources B. relocating documents
C. reading their emails D. learning computer skills

20. What are they likely to do with the center?

- A. move it to the library B. purchase more equipment
C. ask teacher to come to the center D. ask students to stop using emails

PART 3

You will hear three different talks or lectures. In each talk or lecture there are five questions. For each question, choose the correct answer A, B, C or D. You will hear the talks or lectures only once.

Talk/Lecture 1. You'll hear part of a talk about dolls

21. What is the main purpose of the talk?

- A. To describe how the man's favorite dolls look like.
- B. To explain how dolls used to look like in the twelfth century.
- C. To compare the differences in all doll examples in the museum.
- D. To explain how dolls were made differently in times.

22. The dolls that the man interested in

- A. Existed from the twentieth century.
- B. Existed from the seventeenth century.
- C. Existed from the eighteenth century.
- D. Existed from the nineteenth century.

23. At the beginning of the twentieth century, dolls were

- A. Babies.
- B. Adults.
- C. Elderly.
- D. Males.

24. What makes the dolls in the seventeenth century special?

- A. They existed fairly early.
- B. They were made from solid wood.
- C. They are very expensive today.
- D. Their decorations are original.

25. What can you do with the nineteen- century dolls?

- A. Buy them with thousands of pounds.
- B. Take off their hair.
- C. Replace their hair with real hair.
- D. See the maker's name on the body.

Talk/Lecture 2. Listen to a man called Stephen Mills talking to a group of people about a trip to India to see tigers

26. When is the best time to see the tigers?

- A. November
- B. October
- C. September
- D. The following day

27. How long will they be in the park?

- A. Twenty days.
- B. Eighteen days.
- C. Ten days
- D. No information

28. What is arranged to make sure the visitors are comfortable?

- A. Meals.
- B. Transportation.
- C. Accommodation
- D. Schedule.

29. What is Stephen Mill's profession?

- A. Photographer.
- B. Tour guide.
- C. Traveller.
- D. Artist.

30. What is not included in the program?

- A. Going sightseeing in Delhi.
- B. Going shopping in Delhi.
- C. Breakfast on the last day.
- D. Lunch on the last day.

Talk/Lecture 3. You'll hear a talk on local radio about a children theme park.

31. Simon's idea for a theme park came from

- A. his childhood hobby.
- B. his interest in landscape design.
- C. his visit to another park
- D. his wife's idea.

32. When they started, the family decided to open the park only when

- A. The weather was expected to be good.
- B. There were not many people in the neighborhood.
- C. The children weren't at school.
- D. There were fewer farming commitments.

33. Since opening the park has had

- A. 50. 000 visitors.
- B. 1000. 000 visitors.
- C. 5000 visitors.
- D. 1,500,000 visitors.

34. What did their children love?

- A. Trains.
- B. Theme park.
- C. Farm work.
- D. We weather.

35. The park today is

- A. Closed on holidays.
- B. Opened all year.
- C. Closed every two months.
- D. Opened on weekdays.

C: READING

Time permitted: 60 minutes

Number of questions: 40

Directions: In this section you will read *FOUR* different passages. Each one is followed by 10 questions about it. For questions 1-40, you are to choose the best answer A, B, C or D, to each question. Then, on your answer sheet, find the number of the question and fill in the space that corresponds to the letter of the answer you have chosen. Answer all questions following a passage on the basis of what is stated or implied in that passage.

You have 60 minutes to answer all the questions, including the time to transfer your answers to the answer sheet.

PASSAGE 1 – Questions 1-10

The Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) is the main political and economic organization for that area. The leaders summit is their last meeting before the launch of the ASEAN Economic Community, or AEC, on December 31.

The AEC will be equivalent to the world's seventh largest economy. It was set up to create a highly competitive single market and production area. Organizers hope it will ease the movement of capital, goods, investment, services and skilled labor across ASEAN countries. The goal is to make the whole area more competitive and economically successful. But, some business leaders have low expectations for the ASEAN summit. Anthony Nelson is a director at the US – ASEAN Business Council in Washington. He believes that security will be an important issue at the meetings, especially after the terrorist attacks in Paris last week.

"The November summit includes the East Asia Summit, which primarily focuses on political and security issues. So that's going to be a big part of what is actually going on around the summit. A lot of the work that business gets really involved in tends to happen around the ASEAN economic ministers' meeting in August." But, the AEC may have only limited influence on business activity when it comes into being next year. Experts expect little to change at first because there is still much to be done.

"The ASEAN single window, which is a customs project, is still very much a work in progress. But beginning next year they will start limited trials with five of the 10 ASEAN countries. And there have been past mutual recognition agreements for **credentials** of skilled professionals. But there's still a lot of work to be done in terms of actually **implementing** those agreements." Some critics say the AEC will mainly help businesses, not the majority of people in Southeast Asia. Earlier this year, the ASEAN Civil Society Conference and ASEAN Peoples' Forum expressed concern about regional economic **integration**. In a statement, the group said such a move would mean unequal and unsustainable economic growth. This, it said, would result "in worsening poverty and inequalities of wealth." Jerald Joseph is co – chair of the ASEAN People's Forum. He says people crossing borders to find employment need more protections. He said: "Cross – border migrant workers don't have the same level of protection or interest in the whole negotiation. So that's a little bit of a pity, a wasted chance, if it's not reflected in the coming document." The 27th ASEAN Summit includes the organization's partners. Nations including China, India, Japan and the United States are to attend.

1. ASEAN is the main political and economic organization in.....
A. East Asia B. Southeast Asia C. West Asia D. North Asia
2. What does the word "**It**" in paragraph 2 refer to?
A. ASEAN B. Organizer C. AEC D. Business Council
3. According to Anthony Nelson, what is the important issue at the meetings?
A. Security B. Climate change C. Business D. Economy

4. According to the passage, what aspect tends to happen around the ASEAN economic ministers?
A. Security B. Climate change C. Business D. Economy
5. According to the passage, how many countries in the ASEAN will start limited trials?
A. 3 B. 5 C. 7 D. 10
6. The word “credentials” in line 19 can be replaced by
A. letters B. salutations C. invitations D. certificates
7. The word “implementing” in line 20 is closest in meaning to
A. carrying out B. producing C. concentrating D. focusing
8. The word “integration” in line 23 can be replaced by
A. utilization B. contribution C. combination D. separation
9. According to the passage, what would delay the increase of the economy?
A. the recession B. the poverty C. the move D. the employment
10. According to the passage, who require more assurance?
A. travellers B. immigrants C. residents D. tourists

PASSAGE 2 – Questions 11-20

In 1969, a key milestone in space travel was reached when Neil Armstrong set foot on the moon. In 2001, another landmark event took place when the first civilian traveled into space as a paying tourist. As a teenager, Dennis Tito dreamed of visiting outer space. As a young man, he aspired to become an astronaut and earned a bachelor's and a master's degree in aerospace engineering. However, Tito did not have all the qualities necessary to become a professional astronaut; so instead, he went to work as a space engineer in one of NASA's laboratories for five years. Later, Tito set up his own financial investment company and, eventually, he became a multi – millionaire. Later in life, the ex – rocket engineer, still passionate about space travel, began looking into ways to make a trip into space.

In the early 1990s, the Soviet Space Agency was offering tickets for a visit to the Mir space station to anyone who could afford it. Tito jumped at the chance for this once – in – a – lifetime experience. Due to political and economic changes in the former Soviet Union, however, Tito's trip was postponed and later, Mir was decommissioned. In 2001, Tito's dream was finally came true when he paid a rumored \$20 million and took off aboard a SOYUZ rocket to deliver supplies to the International Space Station, a joint venture between the space agencies of Japan, Canada, Europe, Russia, and the U.S.

In preparation for the trip, Tito trained at the Gagarin Cosmonauts Training Center at Star City in Russia. There, he underwent eight months of physical fitness training, weightless simulations, and a variety of other exercises to prepare him for space travel. Although the Russians believed that Tito was adequately prepared for the trip, NASA thought otherwise. Dennis Tito had to sign an agreement with international space officials taking financial responsibility for any equipment he damaged or broke on his trip. He was also barred from entering any part of the space station owned by the U.S. unless escorted.

Although Tito made history and paved the way for the future of space tourism, factors such as cost, and the amount of training required, stand in the way of space vacations becoming an option for most people in the near future. In spite of this, Japanese and North American market data shows that there is definite public interest in space travel. In a 1993 survey of 3,030 Japanese, 80 percent of those under the age of forty said they would like to visit space at least once. Seventy percent of this group would pay up to three month's salary for the trip. In 1995, 1,020 households in North America were surveyed and of those, 60 percent were interested were under forty years of age. Just over 45 percent said they

would pay three month's salary, around 18 percent said they would pay six month's salary, and nearly 11 percent would pay a year's salary. Two – thirds of those who want to visit space would like to do so several times. Since the nature of this type of travel makes it hazardous to humans, it would have to be restricted to those who are physically fit and able to take responsibility for the risks involved.

11. According to the passage, what was the main event in 1969?
 - A. Scientists planned to travel to space.
 - B. People started to concern space travel.
 - C. The dream of space travel became true.
 - D. Neil Armstrong was ready for heading to the moon.
12. When did Dennis Tito dream of becoming an astronaut?
 - A. When he was at kindergarten.
 - B. When he was at primary school.
 - C. When he was at his teen.
 - D. When he was at university.
13. Dennis Tito made the first trip as a space tourist _____.
 - A. in the late '60s.
 - B. in the early '90s.
 - C. this century.
 - D. in the late '50s.
14. Which of the following is NOT true about Dennis Tito?
 - A. He has an advanced degree in aerospace engineering.
 - B. He is now an astronaut for NASA.
 - C. He eventually became a very wealthy man.
 - D. He used to dream of travelling to outer space.
15. Tito's first trip into space was with _____ to _____.
 - A. the Russian/ the International Space Station.
 - B. the Americans/SOYUZ
 - C. members of the former Soviet Union/ the Mir space station
 - D. the Japanese agency
16. Which of the following describes NASA's feelings about Tito's trip into space?
 - A. extremely proud
 - B. somewhat eager
 - C. very concerned
 - D. disappointed
17. According to Japanese survey, which of the following is true?
 - A. Eighty percent of all those interviewed would be interested in travelling to space.
 - B. Some people would pay a quarter of their annual salary to visit space.
 - C. Only people under the age of forty are interested in space travel.
 - D. Seventy percent of Japanese would pay three quarters of their annual salary to visit space.
18. According to a North American survey on space travel, which is true?
 - A. Seventy – five percent of those surveyed would be interested in travelling to space.
 - B. Most people would pay a year's salary to visit space as a tourist.
 - C. Most of the people interested in space travel were under the age of forty.
 - D. Nearly sixty percent of those surveyed were interested in a vacation in space travel.
19. According to the passage, who did not believe that Tito was trained well enough for the trip to space?
 - A. Russian Training Center.
 - B. Japanese Training Center.
 - C. European Training Center.
 - D. NASA

20. Which of the following would probably prevent you from becoming a space tourist in the near future?

A. health

B. wealth

C. youth

D. age

PASSAGE 3 – Questions 21-30

During the **heyday** of the railroads, when America's rail system provided the bulk of the country's passenger and freight transportation, various types of railroad cars were in service to accomplish the varied tasks handled by the railroads. One type of car that was not available for public use prior to the Civil War, however, was a sleeping car; ideas for sleeping cars abounded at the time, but these ideas were unworkable. It unfortunately took the death of a president to make the sleeping car a viable reality.

Cabinet-maker George M. Pullman had recognized the demand for sleeping cars and had worked on developing experimental models of sleeping cars in the decade leading up to the Civil War. However, in spite of the fact that he had made successful test runs on the Chicago and Alton Railroads with his models, he was unable to sell his idea because his models were too wide and too high for existing train station and bridges. In 1863, after spending time working as a storekeeper in a Colorado mining town, he invested his savings of twenty thousand dollars, a huge fortune at that time and all the money that he had in the world, in a luxurious sleeping car that he named the Pioneer. Pullman and friend Ben Field built the Pioneer on the site of the present-day Chicago Union Station. For two years, however, the Pioneer sat on a railroad siding, useless because it could not fit through train stations and over bridges.

Following President Lincoln's assassination in 1865, the state of Illinois, Lincoln's birthplace, wanted to transport the presidential casket in the finest fashion possible. The Pullman Pioneer was the most elegant car around; in order to make the Pullman part of the presidential funeral train in its run from Springfield to Chicago, the state cut down station platforms and raised bridges in order to accommodate the luxurious railway car. The Pullman car greatly impressed the funeral party, which included Lincoln's successor as president, General Ulysses S. Grant, and Grant later requested the Pioneer for a trip from Detroit to Chicago. To satisfy Grant's request for the Pioneer, the Michigan Central Railroad made improvements on its line to accommodate the wide car, and soon other railroads followed. George Pullman founded the Pullman Palace Car Company in partnership with financier Andrew Carnegie and eventually became a millionaire.

Pullman cars were normally a dark "Pullman green", although some were painted in the host railroad's colors. The cars carried individual names, but usually did not carry visible numbers. In the 1920s, the Pullman Company went through a series of restructuring steps, which in the end resulted in a parent company, Pullman Incorporated, controlling the Pullman Company (which owned and operated sleeping cars) and the Pullman-Standard Car Manufacturing Company.

21. Which of the following best states the main idea of the passage?

A. America's railroads used to provide much of the country's transportation.

B. President Lincoln's assassination in 1865 shocked the nation.

C. George Pullman was the only one to come up with the idea for a sleeping car.

D. Pullman's idea for a sleeping car became workable after Lincoln's death.

22. A "heyday" in line 1 is most probably a

A. time for harvest.

B. a period with low prices.

C. a period of great success.

D. a type of railroad schedule.

23. It can be inferred from the passage that before the Civil War, sleeping cars

A. were used abundantly.

B. were thought to be a good idea.

C. were only used privately.

D. were used by presidents.

24. What is the main idea of paragraph 2?
- A. Pullman had been successful in selling his sleeping cars.
 - B. Though Pullman had been successful in test runs with his sleeping cars model; it could not be suitable with the transportation in Chicago.
 - C. Pullman had recognized the demand for sleeping cars.
 - D. Pullman had invested much money on developing the sleeping cars.
25. What was the initial problem that made Pullman's card unusable?
- A. They were too large.
 - B. They were too expensive.
 - C. They were too slow.
 - D. They were too unusual.
26. What is stated in the passage about George Pullman?
- A. He once had a job in a store.
 - B. He always lived in Chicago.
 - C. He worked in a mine.
 - D. He saved money for his project.
27. What is true about the sleeping cars?
- A. The experimental models of sleeping cars had not been successful until 1863.
 - B. The Pioneer did not cost Pullman a fortune.
 - C. The Pioneer was considered to be the most charming cars in comparison with others.
 - D. The Pullman car was extremely beneficial because of its fitness through train station and bridges.
28. Why did the state of Illinois want to use the Pullman in Lincoln's funeral train?
- A. It was superior to other cars.
 - B. It was the only railroad car that could make it from Springfield to Chicago.
 - C. Ulysses S. Grant requested it.
 - D. The Pullman Palace Car Company was a major Illinois business.
29. It can be inferred from the passage that the Michigan Central Railroad
- A. was owned by George Pullman.
 - B. controlled the railroad tracks between Detroit and Chicago.
 - C. was the only railroad company to accommodate wider cars.
 - D. was the sole manufacturer of the Pioneer.
30. This passage would most likely be assigned in which of the following courses?
- A. Engineering
 - B. Political science
 - C. Finance
 - D. History

PASSAGE 4 – Questions 31-40

Garbage cans are not magical portals. Trash does not disappear when you toss it in a can. Yet, the average American throws away an estimated 1,600 pounds of waste each year. If there are no magic garbage fairies, where does all that trash go? There are four methods to managing waste: recycling, land-filling, composting, and incinerating. Each method has its strengths and weakness. Let's take a quick look at each.

Recycling is the process of turning waste into new materials. For example, used paper can be turned into paperboard, which can be used to make book covers. Recycling can reduce pollution, save materials, and lower energy use. Yet, some argue that recycling wastes energy. They believe that collecting, processing, and converting waste uses more energy than it saves. Still, most people agree that recycling is better for the planet than land-filling.

Land-filling is the oldest method of managing waste. In its simplest form, land-filling is when people bury garbage in a hole. Over time the practice of land-filling has advanced. Garbage is **compacted** before it is thrown into the hole. In this way more garbage can fit in each landfill. Large liners are placed in the bottom of landfills so that toxic garbage juice doesn't get into the ground water. Sadly, these liners don't always

work. Landfills may pollute the local water supply. Not to mention that all of that garbage stinks. Nobody wants to live next to a landfill. This makes it hard to find new locations for landfills.

As landfill space increases, interest in composting grows. Composting is when people pile up organic matter, such as food waste, and allows it to decompose. The product of this decomposition is compost. Compost can be added to the soil to make the soil richer and better for growing crops. While composting is easy to do onsite somewhere, like home or school, it's hard to do after the garbage gets all mixed up. This is because plastic and other inorganic materials must be removed from the compost pile or they will pollute the soil. There's a lot of plastic in garbage, which makes it hard to compost on a large scale.

One thing that is easier to do is burning garbage. There are two main ways to incinerate waste. The first is to create or harvest a fuel from the waste, such as methane gas, and burn the fuel. The second is to burn the waste directly. The heat from the **incineration** process can boil water, which can power steam generators. Unfortunately, burning garbage pollutes the air. Also, some critics worry that incinerators destroy valuable resources that could be recycled.

Usually, the community which you live manages waste. Once you put your garbage in that can, what happens to it is beyond your control. But you can make choices while it is still in your possession. You can choose to recycle, you can choose to compost, or you can choose to let someone else deal with it. The choice is yours.

31. Which best explains why the author begins the text by talking about magical garbage fairies?
- A. He is putting a common misconception to rest.
 - B. He is trying to get the reader's attention.
 - C. He is addressing his concern in a serious way.
 - D. He is supporting his argument with evidence.
32. Which best expresses the meaning of the word "**compacted**" as it is used in the third paragraph?
- A. Garbage is burned before it is thrown in a hole.
 - B. Garbage is put in trucks before it is thrown in a hole.
 - C. Garbage is crushed smaller before it is thrown in a hole.
 - D. Garbage is put in a can before it is thrown in a hole.
33. Which was **NOT** cited in the third paragraph as an issue with land-filling?
- A. Landfills are smelly.
 - B. Usable materials are wasted in landfills.
 - C. Landfills may pollute the water supply.
 - D. It is difficult to find locations for landfills.
34. Which best expresses the main idea of the fourth paragraph?
- A. Landfills take up a lot of space.
 - B. Composting is good for the soil but it can be.
 - C. The process of composting is very complicated and scientific.
 - D. There is a lot of plastic garbage in landfills.
35. Which best defines the meaning of **incineration** as it is used in the text?
- A. To bury waste materials in a large hole
 - B. To allow waste products to decompose and become fertilizer
 - C. To burn waste materials and harvest the energy
 - D. To turn waste materials into products like book covers
36. Which conclusion could be supported with text from the passage?
- A. Each method of waste management has its drawbacks.
 - B. Recycling is without a doubt the best way to handle waste.
 - C. Incineration is the best way to process waste.
 - D. All large cities should create massive compost piles.

37. Which best expresses the author's main purpose in writing this?
- A. To convince readers to recycle and compost
 - B. To persuade readers that recycling is a waste of resources
 - C. To compare and contrast recycling and land-filling
 - D. To inform readers of methods of waste management
38. Which is **NOT** included in this text?
- A. A description of how trash is collected
 - B. A description of the uses of compost
 - C. A description of the two methods of incinerating trash
 - D. A description of how landfills have advanced over time
39. Which best explains why composting is not feasible on a large scale?
- A. People wouldn't want to touch all of that gross rotting food.
 - B. It would smell too bad in densely populated cities.
 - C. It would attract rodents that would spread disease.
 - D. Plastic would get into the compost and turn it into a pollutant.
40. Which title best expresses the main idea of this text?
- A. *The Magic of Recycling: Bringing Back What Was Once Lost*
 - B. *Methods of Waste Management: Pros and Cons*
 - C. *Recycling Land-filling or Composting: Which is Best For You?*
 - D. *Do Your Part: How to Save the Earth by Recycling and Composting*

C: WRITING

Time allowed: 60 minutes

No. of items: 2

TASK 1

You should spend about 20 minutes on this task.

You live in Ho Chi Minh City. You just took a trip to Ha Long Bay with an English friend named Daisy. You received an email from her after she returned to London. Read part of her email below.

.....

I hope you like the photos we took in Ha Long Bay. Did you get home all right?

I'm back at work now, but it's a bit difficult to start again. I wish we were still on holiday.

Why don't we plan another trip this spring if you've got time and money? Any suggestions where we could go?

.....

Daisy

Write a reply to Daisy. In your email, you have to tell her that you really like the photos and the time you got together, describe a problem you had at the airport to her and suggest the time and place for the next trip.

Your response will be evaluated in terms of task fulfillment, organisation, vocabulary and grammar. You should write at least 120 words.

TASK 2

You should spend about 40 minutes on this task.

Some people believe that studying at university or college is the best route to a successful career, while others believe that it is better to get a job straight after school.

Discuss both views and give your opinion

Give reasons for your answer and include any relevant examples from your own experience or knowledge.

You should write at least 250 words.

D: SPEAKING

PART I: SOCIAL INTERACTION

Let's talk about jogging

1. Do you like jogging? Why/why not?
2. Do you prefer to go jogging alone or in groups?
3. Is jogging a popular daily exercise in your country?

Now, let's talk about clothes

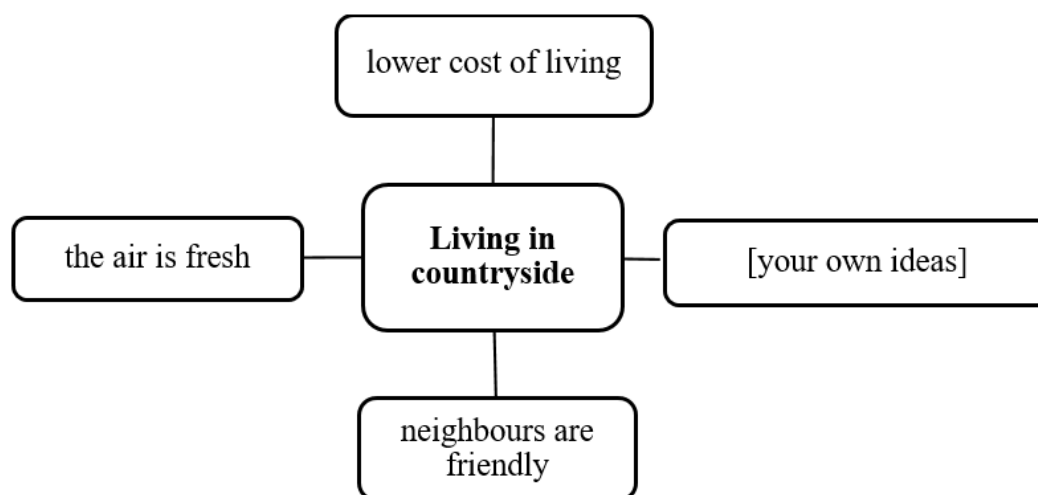
1. Do you often buy clothes?
2. What kinds of clothes do you prefer to wear?
3. Do you think men and women have the same view of clothing?

PART II: SOLUTION DISCUSSION

Your friend is considering three ways to improve his/her English: Watching films, reading books and talking with foreigners. Which do you think is the best choice for him/her?

PART III: TOPIC DEVELOPMENT

Discuss some benefits of living in the countryside



TAPESCRIPTS

TEST 1

PART 1:

1. When is the man's appointment?

A: Good morning. I'd like someone to cut my hair, please. Can I make an appointment?

B: Certainly. Wednesday or Thursday morning or Friday afternoon?

A: On Friday I'm going to go to France. What about Thursday afternoon? I'm afraid I have a meeting all day Wednesday.

B: Well. It's a little bit difficult but that's the only afternoon you can come. So we'll see you then.

2. Which is the aunt's postcard?

A: Look, Sandra. I've got this really nice postcard for my aunt.

B: Oh what a pretty village. And it's right by a river. Isn't it in the mountain?

A: Yes. But you can't see them in the picture.

B: Perhaps, they're behind those tall trees.

3. What time will the plane to Milan leave?

A: Excuse me. What time is the next plane to Milan?

B: It should leave at 7:15 but an hour late today.

A: Oh. That's a problem. If it doesn't leave until 8:15, I'll be one hour late for my meeting.

B: I'm sorry, Sir. There's nothing I can do.

4. Which present has the girl bought her mother?

Hi. It's me, Jane. I've got Mom's birthday present. I think she'll like it. ...yes, that's right, a gold colored one. She's always writing letters so she'll find it useful. I thought about a CD but I'm never really sure what music she likes and dad bought her a new pair of earrings for her birthday anyway. I'm sure she'll like what I've got her.

5. What time will the pie be ready?

A: What time is it Mom? Do you think the apple pie will be ready yet?

B: It's 4:35

A: And the pie went into the oven at 4:15

B: That's right. You could check it at 5:00. And turn the heat down a bit but don't take out until 20 past. That's 45 minutes to go.

A: OK. I'm hungry already.

6. What time is the swimming lesson today?

A: Hi Chidy. Do you want to play tennis after school? Say about 4:30

B: That's would be fun but I've got a swimming lesson. It's usually at 5:15 but it's half an hour earlier this evening, at 4:45. It takes me ages to cycle to the swimming pool so I really don't think I have time today. Let's try it tomorrow

A: OK

7. Which subject does the boy like best?

I really like the new IT teacher. Our project for this term is to design a new website. I've always wanted to know how to do that. The sports teacher is much more serious. But that's still my favorite subject. Last year, I usually like geography but the teacher we have now gives us so much homework.

8. Which T-shirt does the boy decide to buy?

A: I'd like to buy a black T-shirt with short sleeves, please, large size.

B: I'm afraid the black one has long sleeves. But we've got short sleeves in a lighter color. Do you want a round neck or a V-neck?

A: It must be round neck. Let me think ...OK, I'll take one of the short sleeve ones. The color's not so important, really.

PART 2:

Conversation 1:

Kate: I don't remember much of that lecture. The doctor gave me this medicine for my cough, but I don't like it; it seems to make me awfully sleepy and I can't follow my lectures.

George: Well, if you don't take it, none of us will be able to follow our lectures; all we'll hear is you coughing!

Kate: Oh dear, do you think I'll annoy everybody?

George: Yes. You could study at home for a couple of days; you know, have some time off until it gets better.

Kate: Oh, I couldn't do that! I'd miss too much and I get really uncomfortable when I have a lot of catching up to do. Last year I missed a whole week when I fell off my bike and had that enormous bandage on my hand. It took me ages to do all the work when I came back.

George: Oh, you worry too much. You can work at home. Just get Mr. Gray to tell you which parts of the course-book we'll be covering and read it yourself at home. All he does is go through the book anyway; you might as well do it yourself.

Kate: Oh, that's a bit unfair! I think Mr. Gray's really nice. He's always willing to stay behind after class if you don't understand something.

George: Being 'really nice' and never in a hurry doesn't make him a good lecturer. Anyway, I think you should look after your health first and ours! If we sit in that small, hot room with you for the next three days, we'll all have your cough by the end of it.

Kate: Mm, perhaps you're right. I don't care about myself, but I wouldn't like other people to blame me for their illnesses. I have got a bit of a temperature now, too; so maybe I'll go and see Mr. Gray after lunch and tell him I won't be at this afternoon's lecture.

George: Or the next two ... come on, you've got to get better.

Kate: I suppose you're right.

George: Then we can all go out as we planned at the weekend.

Kate: OK then, I don't want to miss that... and I do feel ill...

Conversation 2:

Man: What shall we do tonight? Shall we go out somewhere?

Woman: No, I'm tired. I've had a really hard day.

Man: That's a bit boring! Come on, let's go to a cinema or see that new play at the theatre.

Woman: Not tonight. Why don't we rent a video and stay in?

Man: Well, I'd rather go out... but if you're tired ... OK. So what shall we have? How about that new Italian film?

Woman: No, far too serious for me. I'd fall asleep! Why can't we get something funny, a film with RikMoranis or someone like that.

Man: A comedy? No thanks. I'm not wasting my money.

Woman: Well, I'll pay, if you're going to be difficult about it.

Man: I'm not being difficult; I just don't want to see a comedy.

Woman: Fine. What else do you suggest then?

Man: How about a Robert de Niro?

Woman: We've seen them all.

Man: Maybe, but they're great films. Let's watch one again.

Woman: Now you're suggesting something that's a real waste of money! And I hate seeing films twice, you know that.

Man: OK, OK. What, then?

Woman: Oh, forget it. We're obviously not going to agree anyway!

Man: No, I tell you what, you go down to the video shop and choose a film. Whatever it is, I'll watch it.

Woman: Really? And you won't be difficult or make me feel guilty?

Man: No. Go on, off you go. I'll make something to eat while you're out.

Woman: Great. See you in a few minutes then.

Man: Bye.

Conversation 3:

Girl: Hi, Ben! Only one more week at college, and then the summer holidays begin. Great, isn't it!

Boy: I don't know. It might get a bit boring. I don't think I've got enough money to go anywhere nice for a holiday this year.

Girl: It would be nice to have lots of money to spend, but a good holiday doesn't have to be expensive!

Boy: Oh yes it does! The best holiday I ever had was a few years ago when I went to Greece. I want to fly off somewhere hot, and lie on the beach and go swimming.

Girl: Yes. Well, I can't afford to do that, either.

Boy: So, what are you doing this summer?

Girl: I'm going on a walking holiday in Scotland with some friends. We went last year. We really enjoyed it. We walked all day and spent the nights in Youth Hostels. Why don't you come with us? We're going for two weeks. It won't cost much, and you'll come home feeling really relaxed and fit.

Boy: I'm not sure. Walking all day sounds like hard work to me. And surely you're not hoping for lots of sunshine in Scotland?

Girl: It did rain a bit last year, but most of the time it was sunny. Anyway, it's not good walking in the heat. You have to stop all the time to rest and have drinks.

Boy: Well, I like the sun, and I like to stay in comfortable hotels, not Youth Hostels!

Girl: But they are comfortable. They're basic, and the food's often not very good, but they're very clean and cheap. In fact, I prefer them to hotels because the people are always so friendly.

Boy: Maybe. Look Lisa, thanks a lot for asking me, but I think I'll just stay home and get bored!

PART 3:

Talk/Lecture 1

I was a small child when I left Vietnam and moved with my family to live in America. For me and my little brother, it didn't take long before we felt American, but for my parents and two older sisters, it was a different story. The biggest problem for my mother was the language. We were living in New York and although there were quite a lot of Vietnamese families near us they didn't work in the stores. This meant my mother had to take me with her when she went shopping and I was usually at school.

For my father the most important thing when we arrived was to find a job. Luckily he had friends who knew us in Vietnam and they helped him get a job in a factory. It was hard for him to do that sort of work. In Saigon he had been a doctor.

My two older sisters went to high school. They worked hard and did well and the school gave them extra English lessons. Even now, though, they speak with Vietnamese accents. My brother and I are lucky. We may look Vietnamese but we speak with American accents!

My family found the way of life very different. In Vietnam my mother used to spend a lot of time visiting her sisters and brothers and looking after her mother and father. She feels quite lonely now. She says that in America you live inside your house but in Vietnam you take your house outside onto the street and share your life with everybody. I don't remember that but I do find the winters are quite hard to put up with in New York. It's very cold and snows a lot.

My mother still wears traditional Vietnamese clothes at home and always cooks us rice and noodles. I must admit I prefer burgers and chips! Although my friends like to visit us I often feel a bit embarrassed by my parents' way of life. They do not understand Americans and I think I am more American than Vietnamese now. I suppose it is sad for them to have such a strange daughter.

Talk/Lecture 2:

In American schools, almost every classroom is a mix of boys and girls. However, it was not always this way. In the past, schools did not teach girls subjects like science and math. In 1972, a law called Title IX was made in America. It gave girls an equal chance at education. Since then, boys and girls have been taught together.

Recently, though, some schools are reconsidering separating classes. This is different than in the past, however. Girls still learn the same subjects as boys. They just study without boys in the classroom. Why? Well, scientists know that boys and girls learn differently.

They also behave differently in the classroom. Boys are louder and more confident. They like to talk and show what they know. In general, girls are quieter. They prefer to listen and think carefully before they give their answers. When boys and girls are together, the boys can be too dominant. Also, boys and girls can bother each other. Instead of thinking about the lesson, they think about each other. In a separated classroom, they behave better and can focus on studying.

Another reason for separated classes is that boys and girls often like different things. For instance, boys prefer stories with action and adventure. In an all-boys English class, the teacher can choose books that will be interesting to boys. This way, they will be more excited about the stories.

Not all the classes are separated - just the main subjects like English, math, science, and social studies. Still, some teachers think that separate education is not good. They worry that boys and girls will not learn how to work well together. Right now, less than six hundred schools are trying separate classrooms. Time will show if it is a good idea or something that should be left in the past.

Talk/Lecture 3:

Hi! I'd like to welcome all of you to the international student orientation at Norwalk College. I hope that your travels from your home country have been easy and that you all are settling in well. I believe I've met everyone, but just in case, I'm the director for international student affairs - the person you can come to if you are having problems with your classes, your housing, visas... You are always welcome to stop by my office.

We'll have several short workshops today and will be talking about some common issues that international students face. The first one that I want to deal with is about communication, and in particular, non-verbal communication.

Now all of you have been studying English for some time. You have a good vocabulary, and you probably know all about verb tenses and modals, and can ask directions, and order from a menu. But communication is not only verbal. That is, talking is not the only language we use to communicate. Another way we communicate is through non-verbal communication, or body language.

The term body language means the movements we use and the facial expressions we have (like smiling or frowning), the way we sit or stand, the way we touch or look at someone, the distance we stand from another person. Some psychologists say that more than 60% of our communication is actually done through body language. We do it without thinking, or without ever having been specifically taught what the gestures or expressions mean. The problem is that body language is a little bit different in each culture and this can often cause some problems with communication.

Here's an example. In many places it may be a little rude or disrespectful to look at another person directly in their eyes as you talk with them, so many international students will avoid this eye contact. But in America, we expect it. We think of eye contact as a sign of honesty and straightforwardness. American parents actually encourage their children to look people in the eye when speaking. Just imagine a conversation where an international student was trying to be respectful by not looking into the eyes of her American classmate. The American might wonder why her classmate wouldn't look directly at her, and the international classmate would be wondering why she was being stared at. The end result is an awkward and frustrating interaction.

Here's another one. Americans shake hands firmly when they greet each other because to Americans, a firm handshake signifies strength and power. But a soft or limp handshake is considered a sign of weakness. In some cultures, handshakes are less common, or a gentle, soft handshake is acceptable. So students need to know that when shaking hands, it's important to be firm.

In America, a "thumbs up" sign - a thumb...

TEST 2

PART 1:

1. What colour is Mary's coat?

A: Hi, Mary. What have you bought?

B: This coat. Do you like it?

A: Yes. Yellow looks good on you.

B: Do you think I can use my blue bag with it?

A: Your brown one will look better.

2. What did the woman repair?

A: Hi. What have you done today?

B: You know that broken shelf above my desk. Well, I repaired it and then I went shopping.

A: What did you buy?

B: A new chair.

3. What are they going to buy for Pam?

A: Last year we gave Pam a book for her birthday. Shall we buy another one this year?

B: I think we should give her a plant or some chocolates

A: But she doesn't like sweet things.

B: Let's get her something to put in her garden. But not a book again.

4. What has the girl lost?

A: Can I help you? You look worried. Is everything alright?

B: Well, I was in the playground about 10 minutes ago with my friends. And I got a call on my mobile phone. I have to get a pen out of my bag to write something down. And I think my purse fell out. I can't find it now. Do you know anyone has handed it in.

A: You know. You're not supposed to bring phone to school. Anyway, let me go and check. What color is it?

5. Which sport will the boy do soon at the centre?

A: Have you been to the new water sports centre yet?

B: Oh yes. It's brilliant. There are two indoor pools. One for underwater diving and one for swimming lessons. And you can also have sailing lessons on the lake.

A: That's what I'm doing there next weekend, actually. I was hoping to take water skiing lesson but the leaflet says they're not starting those until next year.

6. Who lives with Josh in his house?

A: Does your house seem empty now as your sister left home.

B: Not really. My grandmother moved into her room and she doesn't go out much. It's really nice having her there because my dad never comes home until later and if mother's out for the evening, grandmother cooks supper for me.

7. What will the girl take with her on holiday?

A: Have you packed for your holiday?

B: No. I need to go shopping before I can do that. Last holiday, my suitcase handles got broken. So I need something new to put my stuff in but suitcases are so heavy to carry.

A: I always take a backpack. You can carry more that way.

B: Yes, I thought to buy one of those. But good quality ones are expensive. I'll get one of those big sports bags. You know you can pull along. They don't cost much

8. Where do the boys decide to go?

A: So we've got three hours. Shall we go skateboard in the park? What do you think?

B: Well. There's little space there which isn't meant to be good. Oh there's a new computer game shop which has just opened.

A: Oh, well. I haven't got enough money to buy a new game anyway.

B: Let's go and watch a film.

A: Ok. We can go skateboard in anytime

PART 2:

Conversation 1. You will hear a journalist interviewing Geoff Thompson, a British sportsman.

Journalist: Good evening, Geoff.

Geoff: Hi.

Journalist: Perhaps you could tell me a bit about your background. Where are you from exactly?

Geoff: Well, I was actually born in 1958, up in the north of England. My parents came to live in Britain after the war.

Journalist: It sounds great.

Geoff: We moved south to London after that. We were completely broke and I did all sorts of odd jobs to try and make money.

Journalist: Goodness, how dramatic! But?...

Geoff: But I was lucky – I discovered karate.

Journalist: Ah! How, exactly?

Geoff: There was a school trip – nothing special really – but we went to this sports center and I just thought "That's for me!".

Journalist: Just like that?

Geoff: Yup. Anyway, I started training. I found myself a Japanese coach and things just happened. I found it came naturally to me and I worked my way up till I found myself in Taiwan for the World Championships. That was in 1982.

Journalist: And you won?

Geoff: Yeah, suddenly I was World Heavyweight Champion. It was great.

Journalist: And you were world champion at that weight five times in all?

Geoff: Yeah, that's right.

Journalist: And then you retired?

Geoff: Well, I didn't have much choice.

Journalist: And now you've got others projects on the go all around the country and even abroad?

Geoff: Mm...yeah...we're going from strength to strength.

Conversation 2. You will hear a man telephoning to talk about the job in a hotel.

Woman: Hello, West Bay Hotel. Can I help you?

Man: Oh, good morning. I'm ringing about your advertisement in the Evening Gazette.

Woman: Is that the one for temporary staff?

Man: That's right. Could you tell me what kind of staff you are looking for?

Woman: We're looking for waiters at the moment.

Man: Right. Erm, what are the hours of work?

Woman: There are two different shifts – there's a day shift from 7 to 2 and a late shift from 4 till 11.

Man: What about time off?

Woman: You get one day off.

Man: Do you know what the rates of pay are?

Woman: Yes, I've got them here. You get £5.50 an hour, and that includes a break.

Man: Oh good. Yes, so let's see. I'd get er, two hundred and twenty one, no, two hundred and thirty one pounds a week?

Woman: You'd also get tips – our guests tend to be quite generous.

Man: Erm, is there a uniform? What about clothes?

Woman: Yes, I forgot to mention that. You need to wear a white shirt, just a plain one, and dark trousers.

Man: Erm, one last thing – I don't know what the starting date is.

Woman: Just a minute. I think it's some time around the end of June. Yes, the 28th in time for the summer.

Man: That's great. I'm available from the 10th. Well, thanks very much for your help.

Woman: You're welcome. Bye.

Man: Bye.

Conversation 3. Listen to part of a conversation at a university library

Man: Hi. May I speak to the...uh, the archives librarian?

Woman: I'm the archives librarian. What can I help you with?

Man: Well, actually, I'm not a student here.

Woman: Are you the...sorry. I don't remember your name, but the librarian over there asked me about giving someone access to the Jacobson collection. Is that you?

Man: Yes, that's right. See, my paper is on the development of the coal – mining industry.

Woman: Did your librarian explain what our system is here?

Man: A little. She told me to make sure I brought my college ID so I could get in the door.

Woman: Yes, well, I'll need to take a copy of it too. Even our own students who look at items from our archive collections have to leave a copy of their ID with us. You'll also have to sign into the archives room whenever you enter and sign out whenever you leave. There's a desk. You know, for security.

Man: I'll be careful.

Woman: Thank you. The other thing is, the things in the Jacobson collection are over 100 years old, so I'll have to ask you to wear special gloves while handling the books. Also, I'm afraid you won't be able to photograph anything.

Man: I figured that. Can I...I don't know, take a picture, or something?

Woman: Well, I can't let you take a picture. But we have scans images of all the pages in the collection.

Man: Well, I guess given how rare these things are...Okay so you want a copy of my ID, and then can you tell me how to get to the archives room so I can get started?

PART 3:

Talk1/Lecture 1:

- Welcome everybody to this presentation about creating a corporate image for your company. I wonder if, when you came in today, you thought, 'Hey, this guy hasn't got a suit on. This could be an interesting day!' You see, I believe that the way you dress is very important. I decided to come here rather casually dressed not because I wanted to make a fashion statement but because I wanted to let you know that this is not going to be a formal presentation. On the other hand, I want you to work hard and get something out of the day. I'm not wearing shorts and a T-shirt, for instance. So how would you describe the way I'm dressed?

- Smart but casual.

Exactly. But I also believe there are particular occasions when you need to wear a suit such as meeting a client - especially if you expect the client to be wearing one. Which brings me to a recent trend which we've picked up from the Americans: 'Dress down Friday'. How many of you are dressing more informally on a Friday? Quite a lot of you. How many of you go as far as wearing jeans? Not so many. Probably many of that small group work in the IT sector? I thought so.

So you see it's not just the day of the week or what clients may expect of you, it's the business you're in. If, for example, you work in a bank you're probably going to be in a dark suit every day of the week. And then there are those of us who are expected to wear a uniform. What you are doing here is projecting a very specific image of your company or service. Usually it's to do with reliability, expertise and efficiency. Customers and the general public feel reassured about someone in a

recognisable uniform. Dress down Friday is a long way off for this group of employees. Now let's have a look at other ways in which a company projects its image . . .

Talk 2/Lecture 2;

Do you get enough sleep at night? Do you ever feel tired during school? You may not be the only one. According to the National Sleep Foundation, kids aren't getting enough sleep. And it's affecting how they do in school.

Experts say that kids need about ten hours of sleep each night. Your body needs sleep so it can rest for the next day. Animals need sleep to stay healthy. Cats and dogs sleep for about fifteen hours each day!

Sleep is also important for your brain. Just like your body, your brain needs a little vacation every night. Without enough sleep, students can't learn as well. They cannot pay attention, follow directions, or solve problems as well. Also, tired kids act in ways that they usually don't. They can easily get angry with their friends or get in trouble in class.

Scientists at the National Sleep Foundation talked to 1,400 kids. They asked them about their sleeping habits. They found that about seventy percent of kids were not getting enough sleep. The scientists think that soda and television are part of the reason. Drinks like cola, coffee, and tea have caffeine in them. Caffeine makes people stay awake. Kids who had drinks with caffeine got less sleep than other kids. Television is also a problem. When kids watch too much TV, they have to stay up later to finish their homework. Scientists also found that many kids had a TV in their room. These kids often stayed up late to watch a show.

So what can you do to make sure that you get enough sleep? Try not to drink anything with caffeine, especially at night. Sleep experts suggest that you try to go to bed at the same time every night. Don't do anything exciting before you go to bed. For instance, don't watch a scary movie or exercise. Try to do something relaxing, like reading a book or listening to quiet music.

Talk3/Lecture 3:

If you have ever seen the northern lights, you know that they are one of most beautiful sights. People often seeing a faint glow appear on the horizon in the night sky. Then they may see wonderful colors such as green, red, blue, or purple stretch the sky. The shape of the northern lights can be straight lines, or it may be curved like the letter S, or round, just like a wheel. The colored lights and shapes move across the night sky, like ocean waves. No matter what the color or shape is, the northern lights are truly an amazing sight.

Many people know them by their common name "the northern lights." But do you know the meaning of the real name? The scientific name for the northern lights from Latin. It is *aurora borealis*. In English, the Latin word *aurora* translates to "dawn," which means "early morning." The Latin word *borealis* means "northern." So *aurora borealis* can be translated as "northern dawn," which describes the look of the northern sky in the very early morning.

If you have never seen *aurora borealis*, you are not alone. This natural phenomenon is not common in most parts of the world. In fact, many people travel or go on tours to places where they can see the northern lights. Where are these places? The best place to see *aurora borealis* is near the North Pole - the northernmost point of Earth - especially in areas such as northern Greenland, Scandinavia, and Alaska.

Many years ago, before modern science, people developed stories, myths, and legends to explain natural phenomena such as *aurora borealis*. Finnish people called them "fox fires," and believed the lights were caused when foxes made fires to keep warm. The Inuit people of northern Canada and Greenland believed that the *aurora* was the dance of animal spirits such as deer, seals, and whales.

The way the northern lights work is similar to a neon sign. Gas travels along magnetic lines. The lights occur when electric particles - electrons - collide with gas atoms, causing the atoms to give off light. The result is the amazing sweeps and waves of color that you can see. It's a wonderful sight if you happen to be in the right place at the right time.

TEST 3

ART 1

1. What have they forgotten?

Speaker 1: I've got the passports here.

Speaker 2: And the tickets are in my bag.

Speaker 1: What about the camera?

Speaker 2: Oh no. I have left it at home. And I really want to take some holiday photos.

2. What time does the train go?

Speaker 1: Hurry up! we'll be late

Speaker 2: what time does the train go?

Speaker 1: At six fifteen. We've got to leave in ten minutes.

Speaker 1: I'm nearly ready

3. How did the woman get to work?

Speaker 1: The traffic is terrible today.

Speaker 2: Yes it took me forty minutes by bus

Speaker 1: Well I drove and it took me an hour

Speaker 2: An hour? it's probably quicker by bicycle.

4. Where are the man's shoes?

Speaker 1: Have you seen my old shoes? I thought they were under the chair by the television

Speaker 2: Not any more. They're by the door with the other rubbish, inside the flat.

Speaker 1: Well the living room looks very nice but you're not throwing my old shoes away all the same.

5. What will Paul get at the shop?

Right. Now.. what do we need for the sauce so Paul can get for me ... let me see.. onions, tomatoes, one red pepper, mushrooms and two carrots. So what I've got. Onions? I've got those. Tomatoes, yes, red pepper, no, I need one of those. I've got mushrooms, oh dear, no carrots. Paul. Could you go to the shop for me, please?

6. How were they told to do their homework?

Speaker 1: Wow your homework looks great

Speaker 2: Thanks. I typed it on my dad's computer.

Speaker 1: But did Mrs Smith tell us we have to write in our books?

Speaker 2: Oh, No. You're right. What am I going to do now?

7. What did Helen buy?

Speaker 1: Look. Roger I've been shopping. They've got some great things in Star Right

Speaker 2: That's brilliant, lovely colors and it'll keep you warm in the winter

Speaker 1: Yes, but are the sleeves too short for me?

Speaker 2: No. they look fine.

8. How did the woman get to work today?

Oh I'm so sorry I'm late. I missed the bus and I was trying to decide whether to walk or go back and get my bike when I saw my neighbor. Luckily he offered me a lift because he works near here.

PART 2

Conversation 1:

My daily schedule as a dental hygienist is a little complicated. That's because it's different every day. Monday, I don't go into work until late in the afternoon. So I have time to spend, most of the day, doing washing of clothes, shopping, and my banking. I leave for work around four o'clock in the afternoon, I work from five to nine p.m. Tuesday, I wake up at six thirty a.m. and leave for work, at seven thirty. My first patient is scheduled for eight fifteen. Each patient, is allotted forty-five minutes. Lunch break is twelve-thirty to one-thirty. I finish up at five p.m. and get home, at around six p.m. Wednesday starts an hour earlier. I wake up at five-thirty a.m., leave for work at six-thirty, and see my first patient at seven a.m., I also finish early on Wednesday, at twelve-noon. Thursday is the same schedule as Tuesday... getting up at six-thirty a.m., leaving for work at seven-thirty, and seeing my first patient at eight-fifteen. I get home about six p.m. in the evening. Friday is another early start. I wake up at five-thirty a.m., leave the house at six thirty and finish up my last patient at three o'clock in the afternoon. I like to get finished early on Friday. That is a typical work week for me.

Conversation 2:

Man: Hi, Sis. I just came over to drop off the DVDs you wanted, and . . . Hey, wow!? Where did you get all of this stuff?

Woman: I bought it. So, what do you think of my new entertainment center? And the widescreen TV..

Man: Bought it?

Woman: . . . and my new DVD player. Here, let me show you my stereo. You can really rock the house with this one.

Man: But where did you get the dough to buy all this? You didn't borrow money from mom and dad again, did you?

Woman: Of course not. I got it with this!

Man: This? Let me see that . . . Have you been using Dad's credit card again?

Woman: No, silly. It's mine. It's student credit card.

Man: A student credit card? How in the world did you get one of these?

Woman: I got an application in the mail.

Man: Well, why did you get one in the first place?

Woman: Listen. Times are changing, and having a credit card helps you build a credit rating, control spending, and even buy things that you can't pay with cash . . . like the plane ticket I got recently.

Man: What plane ticket?

Woman: Oh yeah, my roommate and I are going to Hawaii over the school break, and course, I needed some new clothes for that so . . .

Man: I don't want to hear it. How does having a student credit card control spending? It sounds you've spent yourself in a hole. Anyway, student credit cards just lead to impulse spending . . . as I can see here. And the interest rates of student credit cards are usually sky-high, and if you miss a payment, the rates, well, just jump!

Woman: Ah. The credit card has a credit limit . . .

Man: . . . of \$20,000?

Woman: No, no quite that high. Anyway, . . .

Man: I've heard enough.

Woman: Did I tell you we now get digital cable with over 100 channels? Oh, and here's your birthday present. A new MP3 player . . .

Man: Yeah. Oh, don't tell me. Charged on the credit card. Listen. Hey, I don't think having a student credit card is a bad idea, but this is ridiculous. And how in the world are you going to pay off your credit card bill?

Woman: Um, with my birthday money? It's coming up in a week.

Man: Hey, let's sit down and talk about how you're going to pay things back, and maybe we can come up with a budget that will help you get out of this mess. That's the least I can do.

Conversation 3:

Server: Hi. Welcome to Joe's Hamburger Restaurant. [Hi] Home of the one-pound superdeluxe hot and spicy cheeseburger. Will this be for here or to go?

Customer: Uh, to go.

Server: Okay. What would you like today? Would you like to try the one-pound super hot and spicy cheeseburger?

Customer: Uh. I don't think so. I'd probably have heartburn for a week after downing that monster.

Server: Well. It's our house special this week, and it comes with fries, and a large specialty drink called "Everything-but-the-kitchen-sink."

Customer: A what? "Everything-but-the-kitchen-sink"? What in the world is that?

Server: Well, it's a little mix of everything in a large cup: Pepsi, Sprite, Fanta Orange, and lemonade with crushed ice and a scoop of ice cream.

Customer: Ah, that sounds disgusting.

Server: Hey, it'll grow on you.

Customer: Nay, I think I'll just order a hamburger with some mustard and lettuce and a glass of water.

Server: Boring. Hey. Would you care for anything else like a side order of amazing cheesy onion rings?

Customer: No thank you. Onion rings usually don't agree with me.

Server: Hmm. Okay. Your total comes to ten ninety (\$10.90).

Customer: Ten ninety? For just a hamburger?! You've got to be kidding

Server: Well, the one-pound super deluxe hamburger is nine dollars.

Customer: Hey, I didn't order a one-pound burger. I just wanted a simple burger. That's all.

Server: Well, sir. Joe's Hamburger Restaurant only serves one-pound burgers. [Man!] The one-pound super hot and spicy, the one-pound barbecue burger, the one-pound bacon cheese burger, the one-pound . . .

Customer: No, no. Those are all huge.

Server: Well, sir. If you really want something smaller [Yeah], you should order from the kids' menu: The half-pound super hot and spicy burger, the half-pound barbecue burger, the half-pound bacon cheese burger, the half-pound . . .

Customer: No. Those are still giant burgers.

Server: Well, in these parts, we are hearty eaters.

Customer: Okay, but you said my total was ten ninety, but the burger only comes to ten bucks. What about the other ninety cents?

Server: Well, sir. We only serve natural spring water from yonder hills, and . . .

Customer: Okay, okay. I'll take the giant burger and a bottle of your spring water. The sandwich should feed me for a week.

PART 3

Talk/Lecture 1

Hello everyone, My name's Sandy Duffy and I'm here to tell you about my career as a video game writer. I work with game developers and designers to think of good stories, and I write all the dialogue in the game. When I was in secondary school, I never imagined that I would do this job. I played guitar that's what I planned to do as my job. But I had an accident when I was playing basketball and hurt my hand, so I had to think of another career. My mother wanted me to be a journalist, but I didn't think it was for me.

I didn't know what to study at university. I was good at lots of science subjects, including physics and math, but I also loved entertaining people and I was good at Art. In the end, I went to film school where I studied lighting, special effects, how to use camera...all that! It was there that I started to think about working in the video game industry.

Now, a question that every always asks me is "How did you get your first job?" Well, I had a friend whose job was organizing conferences, at one of the conferences, she met a man who owned a company that made video games. I wrote to him and sent my CV. He obviously liked what he read because he gave me an interview and offered me a job as a junior.

People also ask me what I like best about being a video game writer. Well, the money is good and it's quite exciting, just last night, for example, I was at a big dinner where they were giving prizes for new games. But what I love is the fact that I get on well with everyone in the business. That's what makes my job so much fun.

Obviously, no job is perfect though, and there are things I don't like. I've just started a new job and I have to spend a lot of time on the road or at the airport, which I find very hard. I'd really like to be able to spend more time at home.

Talk/Lecture 2

Do you want to take part in a trip of a lifetime? Then join Go4Health India. This amazing five – day trek will take you through one of the world's most beautiful mountain ranges, the Indian Himalayas. You will also be helping raise vital funds for our charity which aims to promote health care all over the world.

The trip starts in the city of Delhi where you will have the chance to see one of the charity's health care projects in action. The following day we set off on our incredible journey into the mountains.

During the trek you will pass colourful towns and villages and enjoy the most magnificent mountain views. You will experience all this before you even reach the peak of our trek to see the stunning Dhauladhar mountain range. Once at the top you can climb even higher if you want to and experience walking on a glacier to reach Lahes cave. You will soon know what it feels like to be on top of the world. And on the way down you will be able to admire the wonderful views across the valley.

To join Go4Health India all you need to do is pay an entry fee of 250 pounds. You also need to promise to raise a minimum of 2500pounds before the start of the trip. Fundraising is part of the challenge, but don't worry our fundraising team is on hand to help you. Once you have signed up you will receive an information pack. This includes details of the trek as well as the work of the charity. It also contains useful tips and advice on fundraising. And you will also get a charity cap to wear with pride. You will also receive a full training guide which will help you reach a reasonable level of fitness. Our top training tips will definitely improve your physical ability so that you can get the most out of the trek!

The cost of the trip includes your flights, accommodation, food, tour guides and medical support. However, please note that airport and tax is not included. You will have to meet this additional cost yourself.

Dates for this year's Go4Health India are 3rd to 13th November. Visit our website www.Go4Health.uk and sign up today!

Talk/Lecture 3

Last year in India, people bought around 1.5 million new cars. This will probably go up to three million a year in the next few years. That's how the India economy is changing. Many Indians in the big cities are richer than ever and they want to spend money on new products. However, most of the money is still in the big cities. There is still a lot of poverty in the villages and countryside.

Now the government hopes a new road in India can help to change India's economy. The golden Quadrilateral road or GQ connects the country's four biggest cities. Delhi, Mumbai, Chennai and Kolkata. Hopefully, the road will carry business from the giant cities to the smaller and poorer villages and the other half of the India's population.

The GQ is nearly 6.000 kilometre long and the most hi – tech high way in the world. At the administration headquarters in Delhi, you can watch thousands of vehicles moving around the country on a computer screen. If there is a problem anywhere with the road, electronic sensors tell the headquarters and engineers instantly drive there.

When you drive on the high way, there is every kind of transport. There are animals pulling cars, motorcycles, lines of old trucks and fast moving modern cars. Sometimes the road goes right through middle of a city. So there are often traffic jams and pedestrians trying to cross the six lanes. Industry is also growing along the new highway.

When a large company opens a factory, lots of other smaller factories and offices also open. Trucks then drive and deliver all over India along the new high way. For India, all this is a symbol of the country's future.

TEST 4

PART 1

1. What is John going to do tonight?

Speaker 1: Hello Mrs Brown. Is John there?

Speaker 2: No. He's out on his bicycle at the moment

Speaker 1: Uh Can he go swimming tonight?

Speaker 2: Sorry, Paul. He's got a football match tonight

2. Which bag does the woman buy?

Speaker 1: I want to buy a present for Diana?

Speaker 2: What about a bag?

Speaker 1: Yes. This one's nice. It's small and round

Speaker 2: I think she prefers a square bag

Speaker 1: No. this is better. I'll get the round one.

3. How much did the woman pay for the apples?

Speaker 1: Can I help you?

Speaker 2: Yes. I'd like a pound of apples please.

Speaker 1: Do you want the ones at 30 pence, 35 pence or 40 pence?

Speaker 2: The one at 30 pence, please.

4. When must the boys get on the coach?

The football match starts at 2:30. But we should get there at half past one. The coach will pick you up at ten to one. As it takes about 40 minutes to drive there. So we'll meet in a school car park. Don't be late boys, will you?

5. What fruit do they take?

Speaker 1: Mom, Have we got any fruit to take on the picnic. There were some oranges and bananas.

Speaker 2: Here are the bananas. Let's take those. Oh. The oranges were gone. What about taking some grapes or apples as well?

Speaker 1: Ok. Let's take the grapes. That would be enough.

6. Which present has the man bought?

Speaker 1: Is the book in the bag for Mom then? I didn't think she's particularly interested in flowers.

Speaker 2: I thought she liked it, to give her some good ideas for the garden. Although she never reads it. It's got some lovely photos.

Speaker 1: I thought you were going to get those gloves I show you in that shop last Saturday. They match the scarf I bought her

7. Where are the photographs?

Speaker 1: Have you seen my new passport photographs? I put them on the bookshelf. Oh here they are with your coffee cups. I hope they aren't dirty.

Speaker 2: Oh sorry. I was showing them to Pat. He said they make you look like that newsreader on the television

8. What did Ben break?

Speaker 1: Ben. What's this broken cup doing here?

Speaker 2: Sorry mom. I had an accident when I was washing up. You know those big dinner plates.

Speaker 1: You have broken them as well.

Speaker 2: Oh just a couple. They slipped out of my hands into the sink and the cup got broken as well

PART 2

Conversation 1

Scott: Dave. I'm going to the supermarket to pick up food and drink for Saturday's picnic later. Any suggestions?

Dave: Well, everyone has been talking about having a barbecue down by the river, so why don't you pick up some hamburger and hot dogs?

Scott: Okay, but how much hamburger meat are we going to need? And hot dogs too?

Dave: Uh, I don't know. How about three pounds of hamburger and a couple packages of hot dogs?

Scott: Oh, that's not going to be enough. Do you remember the last picnic we went on? Your roommate, Jim, ate about ten hamburgers by himself!

Dave: You're right. Let's see. I'd better write this down. Uh, let's see about nine pounds of hamburger meat and, uh . . . , seven packages of hot dogs.

Scott: And you better pick up some chicken for those who don't like hamburger or hot dogs.

Dave: Okay. How about five or six bags of potato chips?

Scott: Humm. Better make that eight or so.

Dave: Alright. Oh, and we're gonna [going to] need some hamburger and hot dog buns. How about five packages a piece? I think that sounds about right.

Scott: Yeah, you better pick up some mustard, catchup, and mayonnaise too.

Dave: Okay. What else? Uh, we're gonna [going to] need some soft drinks. How about ten of those big 2-liter bottles?

Scott: Sounds fine, but be sure to buy a variety of drinks.

Dave: Okay. And what about dessert?

Scott: Well, maybe we could ask Kathy to make a few cherry pies like she did last time.

Dave: Well, I wouldn't mind that, but you know, she's been very busy working two jobs, so I'd hate to ask her, [Oh, hum . . .] and uh . . . Hey, why don't you whip up some of your oatmeal cookies? [Well . . .] Hey, you could even ask, uh . . . , what's her name . . . yeah that new girl, Susan, the one that moved in across the street! [Well . . .] I bet she'd be willing to help you! [I don't know . . .] She's a real knockout!

Scott: Nah, I don't think I could ask her . . . [Ahh!] I don't know her phone number, plus . . .

[Door bell rings . . .]

Dave: Hey, you don't need to. She's at the door!

Scott: What do you mean?

Dave: Well, I thought you two would hit it off, so I called her up saying I was you, and I invited her over to watch a movie.

Scott: You did what???

Dave: Wait, wait, wait . . . [uhhhhhh . . .]

Conversation 2

Son: Dad. Can I go outside to play?

Dad: Well, did you get you Saturday's work done?

Son: Ah, Dad. Do I have to?

Dad: Well, you know the rules. No playing until the work is done.

Son: So, what is my work?

Dad: Well, first you have to clean the bathroom including the toilet. And don't forget to scrub the bathtub.

Son: No, I want to do the family room.

Dad: Well, okay, but you have to vacuum the family room and the hall, and be sure to dust everything. Oh, and don't forget to wipe the walls and clean the baseboards. [Okay.] And after that. [Oh, no.] Next, sweep and mop the kitchen floor and be sure to polish the table in the living room.

Son: Okay. Okay.

Dad: And make your bed and pick up all your toys and put them away. And . . .

Son: More?

Dad: Yeah. And then, how about going out for lunch and getting a big milk shake, but you probably don't want to do that.

Son: No, No. I want to.

Dad: Okay. While you're doing your work, I'll be out in the yard raking leaves and pulling weeds.

Conversation 3

Okay, everyone. I want to review the first two days of our travel itinerary for the trip. Okay, yeah, please take out the paper that I handed out earlier. Okay. Uh. First of all, we have been very fortunate to have been able to purchase discount tickets to cover most of the transportation costs and scheduling (scheduled) activities. And I want to also thank the, uh, group of parents who, uh, worked very hard in order to, uh, raise funding, uh, through different businesses in the community. I really appreciate that.

Uh, let's see. Okay, everyone should meet at the airport at 6:00 a.m. This will give you time to check in and get through security. Our plane departs at 9:00.

Uh, our plane arrives in New York at 3:00 p.m, and we will take a bus from the airport to the hotel. We've been able to get great rates on this hotel because we're staying on a weekday instead of the weekend.

In the morning, for any of you who like to get exercise, we will be meeting in the lobby around 6:00 a.m. to go jogging around Central Park for about 45 minutes, and we'll get back to the hotel about the time when the restaurant opens, so you'll enough time to grab a quick breakfast before we leave the hotel at 8:00. We'll be taking a ferry ride to Ellis Island and then to Liberty Island to visit the Statue of Liberty. I mean, this is something that you really can't miss, and later, we will go to Times Square where you can have lunch on your own for about an hour from about 1 to 2.

Later in the afternoon, you have the choice of visiting the Empire State Building or the Metropolitan Museum of Art. Either one of these is . . . are great, and we have some great, uh, group discounts. Uh, we will meet back at the hotel at 6:00 p.m., and we'll have dinner at a very nice Italian restaurant downtown, and then we'll catch an exciting Broadway musical around 8:30 p.m.

Uh, any questions?

PART 3

Talk 1

Well, there's nothing quite like finding your first old ship – it was 300 years old. Well, there's nothing quite like finding your first Ok just lying at the bottom of the sea, so it wasn't difficult to find. Most are covered in sand and rocks – but this one wasn't.

I'm actually a teacher, not a full time diver – I dive in my free time but I often get to them before the professional divers, because I have good up-to-date equipment. Another thing that helps is talking to fish-men who tell me about their local area. I've even written a book about some of their experiences.

At the moment, I'm looking for the gold from a ship called The Sea Bird. It was an enormous well-built ship and it was coming from Australia on a winter night in 1859. Everything was going fine until the ship reached the English coast, when it crashed into some rocks in a very strong wind and sank to the bottom of the sea. It was carrying gold from Australia, and most it is still at the bottom of the sea.

My wedding ring is actually made from gold which I found on an eighteenth – century sailing ship. A friend of mine, another diver, has already found 88,000 pounds worth of gold from different ship. He's now decided to give up his job and become a full – time diver.

My house is full of things like coins, bottles and old guns. My wife is always complaining about the number of objects around the house – she says I should open an antiques shop – but I love all these old things. Anyway, in the end, I gave some things from my collection to museums, because I didn't want to sell them. But my wife still wasn't very pleased, I'm afraid.

As diving is a dangerous hobby, It's not a good idea to try to teach yourself. I'd advise anyone interested to do what I did. There are some excellent diving clubs like the one I joined, which run courses for beginners. It is best to do one of these before you go on a diving holiday...

Talk 2

Are you interested in history? Well, I'd like to tell you about some of the historical places open to visitors in this part of the country.

Let's start with the oldest first, Black Rock Caves have been here for over two million years. And, for half a million year, they were home to people and various animals, particularly tigers. You can explore these ancient homes and imagine what life was like for the people who lived there. The caves are open daily from April to October. A special attraction on evenings in August is a walk by candle light. Don't take this tour if you are afraid of the dark.

Next I recommend a visit to Salter house. This was built by Sir Joshua Salter and dates back to seventeen sixty – five. The Salter family are still living there today. The house became famous in nineteen eighty two when the television series Aunt Dorothy was filmed there. The furniture and paintings are well worth seeing, but the attraction nobody wants to miss is the kitchen. This is where Aunt Dorothy cooked her enormous meals and gave advice to anyone who passed through this part of the house.

And don't forget to visit the Old Port. You will need several hours to see everything there, especially if you take a trip along the riverside in an old tram as far as the fishing village. The guides there all wear traditional costume and you too get the chance to try on clothes from hundred years ago. You can buy gifts in the old village stores and eat delicious snacks in the Tea Shop. If you visit the village factory, you can see how sweets were made a hundred years ago, and taste them, too.

So, you see there's plenty of...

Talk 3

This lecture is going to introduce you to traditional Chinese philosophy. First, you will learn about, uh, the yin and yang philosophy. Secondly, we will look at the five elements of this philosophy. It is important that you remember these five elements as we will be discussing them throughout the lecture. The five elements of yin and yang are: water, wood, fire, earth, and umm, metal. Ok, so those are the five elements, Umm, let's begin with the definition of yin and yang. Yin and yang should be considered as opposite forces like, uhh, like land and ocean, for example. These are opposite, Now, these opposites do not compete with each other. They are complementary. When you think of yin and yang, think complementary opposites.

So, moving from complementary opposites, let's return to the five elements we mentioned earlier. If you recall, we said they were water, wood, fire, earth and metal. The Chinese divided yin and yang into five elements to gain an understanding of how the body, mind and spirit work. According to the Chinese, every person's physical and mental health relies on a balance of the five elements. Individuals may have more of one element than another. Of course, ideally, all elements are in balance or harmony. What does this mean? Uh, it means that a person's body contains equal amounts of each element.

TEST 5

PART 1:

1. What time is it?

Speaker 1: Have you got the right time? I think my watch is wrong.

Speaker 2: Ah it's half past two.

Speaker 1: My watch is 20 past

Speaker 2: well, it's 10 minute slow then

2. What's Michelle going to read?

Speaker 1: Can I read your newspaper, Michelle?

Speaker 2: Didn't you bring a book with you?

Speaker 1: Yes, but it's not very interesting

Speaker 2: Oh. Here you are. I'll read a letter from John.

3. How much did the tickets cost?

Speaker 1: Oh hi. Did you have a good time at the theatre last night?

Speaker 2: Well. The play was excellent but the tickets cost 90 dollars each.

Speaker 1: That's not too bad if the play was good.

Speaker 2; No. Perhaps you're right.

4. What is the man going to buy?

Speaker 1: Is everything ready for the holiday?

Speaker 2: I'm just going shopping. I must get those pills I take when I feel travel sick. Do we need anything else from the chemist? We forgot the toothpaste last time.

Speaker 1: I've got that. I haven't got any sunglasses but I can borrow yours, can't I. And I get something to read at the airport.

Speaker 2: Right

5. Which dress is Kate talking about?

Speaker 1: Oh mom. This dress is still dirty.

Speaker 2: It can't be, Kate. I have washed it.

Speaker 1: But it is. The mark on the collar has gone but it's still a small one here. Look. It's in front, just below the button. It's where I spilled some coke last week.

6. When will Jane meet them?

Hi. It's Pete here. John left you a message to say he can't meet you at 8 o'clock as plan because her bus doesn't get into late 15. And it will take 30 minutes to get from the center of town. I told to the tables actually book at 8:45 so that would be fine. And we'll see her then.

7. Which morning activity is for beginners?

At 10am tomorrow morning, there will be swimming lessons at both intermediate and beginner levels. Then there will be volleyball practice at 11:30 for all those of you who are already in one of the teams. Also in the morning, for those of you who already know how to sail, there's a chance to do some practice on your own. There will be lessons in both sailing and windsurfing for beginners after lunch.

8. Which painting does the woman decide to buy?

They're all nice but you see a lot flowers everywhere these days, don't you? So that wouldn't be my choice. The thing with animals actually although I did quite like the one with horses so it looks like it has to be the one with the boat. It will be a change from that bowl of food I have had on the wall all these years anyway.

PART 2

Conversation 1:

Matthew: ... Bye, Mum, see you later.

Mother: How are you getting to college? It's already five to nine. You've missed the bus. Are you going to walk?

Matthew: No, I'm borrowing your car, remember?

Mother: Oh, Matthew. **(Q1) I need it today. If you want to borrow the car you need to ask me several days before.** Sorry, you're going to have to walk. It just isn't convenient today.

Matthew: But I did ask you. We talked about it last week. Don't you remember? **(Q2) I've promised to help Alan move all his books and things after my lecture today.** He's moving to a new flat and his car's broken down. I've got to help him move his things. He can't stay in the old flat after today. I promised him.

Mother: All right, all right. Of course, you must keep your promise. I remember now, you did tell me. **(Q3) But I thought you said next Wednesday. You said the 9th and that's next week when I'm in Birmingham for a meeting so I shan't need the car.**

Matthew: I didn't ask for it next Wednesday! I've got an exam next Wednesday! I can't help Alan when I'm doing an exam, can't I?

Mother: No, I suppose not. Well, I expect you're right. **(Q4) I didn't write it down so it's my fault.** Next time we must both write it down. And make sure we write down the same date.

Matthew: OK, so can I have it today? I need to go or I'll miss my lecture.

Mother: Well, what am I supposed to do? I need to be at work in half an hour.

Matthew: I'll give you a lift there on my way to college. How about that?

Mother: I suppose I haven't got much choice. Come on, then.

Conversation 2

Presenter: OK, now we come to our regular spot on extreme sports, and this week our fearless reporter Tom Walker has been trying out something called indoor skydiving. And he's with me now. Tom, what's this all about?

Reporter: Well, it's the same as skydiving- jumping from an aeroplane and freefalling through the air without opening your parachute for some time – except that you do it **(Q5) in an indoor wind tunnel.** And there's no plane, and no parachute, and, so I was told, no danger! So it gives you a taste of doing an extreme sport, but it isn't quite so extreme.

Presenter: Right, now where did you do it?

Reporter: I did it in a vertical wind tunnel **(Q6) at an adventure sports center called Runaway.**

Presenter: What exactly is a vertical wind tunnel?

Reporter: Well, it's a tunnel that gets filled with air. The air is provided by four enormous industrial fans of a kind that usually provide air for underground systems. These fans produce a column of air that rushes through the tunnel from below at more than 160 kilometers per hour. When you're in the tunnel, **(Q7) you float on this air.** The machine has been described as being like an enormous hairdryer. It allows you to fly as if you had fallen from a plane, but you are only two meters off the ground.

Presenter: And it's completely safe is it?

Reporter: Yes. There are bars across the top of the tunnel to stop you flying off up and out of the tunnel. The tunnel is four meters wide and has glass walls. The only small problem you might have is

that you keep bashing into these walls. **(Q8) But you're not really going to hurt yourself a lot by doing this – the only injuries you are likely to get are sore elbows and knees.** In fact, it's so safe that the center is open to anyone over the age of four. In America, where the idea was invented by the military in 1994, pensioners in their eighties regularly have a go.

Conversation 3

PAM: Hi Jun. As you know, I've asked you here today to discuss the future of our Self-Access Center. **(Q9) We have to decide what we want to do about this very important resource for our English language students.** So, can you tell me what the students think about this?

JUN: Well, from the students' point of view, we would like to keep it. The majority of students say that they enjoy using it because it provides a variation on the classroom routine and they see it as a pretty major component of their course, but we would like to see some improvements to the equipment, particularly the computers; **(Q10) there aren't enough for one each at the moment** and we always have to share.

PAM: Well, yes, the teachers agree that it is a very valuable recourse but one thing we have noticed is that a lot of student are using it to check their personal emails. We don't want to stop you students using it, but we think the **(Q11) computers should be used as a learning resource, not for emails.** Some of us also think that we could benefit a lot more by relocating the Self-Access Center to the main University library building. How do you think the students would feel about that, Jun?

JUN: Well, the library is big enough to incorporate the Self-Access Center, but it wouldn't be like a class activity anymore. Our main worry would be not being able to go to a teacher for advice. I'm sure there would be plenty of things to do but we really need teachers to help us choose the best activities.

PAM: Well, there would still be a teacher present and he or she would guide the activities of the students, we wouldn't just leave them to get on with it.

JUN: Yes, but I think the students would be much happier keeping the existing set-up; they really like going to the Self-Access Center with their teacher and staying together as a group to do activities. **(Q12) If we could just improve the resources and facilities, I think it would be fine.**

PART 3

Talk/Lecture 1:

Dolls have always fascinated me, and that's why, five years ago, I was delighted to be offered the job of running a doll museum.

Dolls have existed for thousands of years, and the earliest dolls we know about we found in graves in ancient Egypt. I only wish we could get one or two for our museum. But we haven't unfortunately got anything as old as that in the museum. All the same, we have got examples from Europe from the twelfth century, but my favorite early dolls are actually from the seventeenth century. They interest me not just because they are early, or fairly early, but also because of the clothes they are wearing. They have their original clothes, and from them we know what the owners wore, since dolls in those days were always dressed like their owners. They were made of the only material readily available for things like this at the time: solid wood and they were painted in great detail. In fact, on the best examples, like the ones in the museum, the detail includes the seventeenth-century make-up.

Dolls like these were very expensive then, and only the very rich could afford them. These days, they're popular with collectors and if you want one today, you have to pay anything up to ten thousand pounds for a doll in perfect condition from this time! By the way, what makes them so valuable is that, as far as a collector is concerned, a doll is only worth collecting if it is in perfect condition, and that means having the original clothes.

Doll collecting has become very fashionable since the museum opened, with people interested in dolls from every period, including later dolls. There's great interest in nineteenth-century examples, when

dolls were no longer made of wood, but began to have soft bodies and real hair. They were very delicate and few have survived, meaning such a doll would be worth about two thousand pounds, perhaps a bit more. Later, in the nineteenth century, you could often take off the doll's hair. If you can, you can often see the maker's name underneath, and of course the right one increases a doll's value.

There was a really big change in dolls at the beginning of the twentieth century. In the museum we have one of the earliest examples, from about 1909, of a doll that's a model of a baby. Previously all dolls, the earliest ones, were little adults.

Talk/Lecture 2

Hello. I'm Stephen Mills. I will travel with you to the Tiger Tour in India, but I'm not your guide. I work as an artist and I'm going to take some photographs of tigers so that I can use them when I paint some pictures later. An expert guide will join the group when we arrive in India, but I'm leading the group until then.

We leave London on the 6th of November, arriving in India the following day. It's a good time of year to visit the wildlife park where the tigers live. The rainy season finishes in October. And later in the year, the park gets more crowded and the tigers become shy.

We'll spend ten days in the wildlife park. There are twenty other types of animals and three hundred types of bird to see as well as tigers. There are eighteen of us altogether and everything is organized for your comfort by the tour company. For example, although we're in the jungle, we won't have to sleep in tents! The hotels where we'll stay are all very comfortable.

To be sure of seeing tigers, we'll stay in two different parts of the wildlife park. We'll spend three days in the north, where we'll travel around in an open truck, and the rest of the time in the south, where we'll travel around on elephants. That should be fun!

On the way back to London, we have dinner and one night's bed and breakfast in the Indian capital, Delhi. There you can either go sightseeing or go shopping, whichever you prefer. But please note that lunch is not provided on our day of departure, as the plane leaves at two in the afternoon.

Now, if there are any questions

Talk/Lecture 3:

Announcer:

For the second in our series about locally- run businesses, we meet Simon Winridge, co- founder of the hugely- successfully Winridge Forest Railway Park, Welcome, Simon. Now, perhaps you can begin by telling us a little bit about how it all started.

Man:

Well, during the 1970s, my wife, Liz and I had just acquired 80 acres of sheep- farming land, and we decided to settle down and have children. Pretty soon we had a daughter, Sarah, and a son, Duncan. The place was wonderful for the kids: they particularly loved trains and gradually built up an enormous network of miniature railway track. I began to develop larger- scale models of locomotives but we didn't think anything more of it until I went on a trip to a theme park near Birmingham and decided we could do a much better job! So we set up a small one ourselves based on the miniature railway and we opened to the public for just a month that year, 1984- in July- our driest month- because our children said they didn't want our guests to have a miserable, wet visit. I dealt with Park business and Liz carried on with the farm work.

It soon became clear that we were onto a winner. We began to extend the railway track and lay it among more interesting landscape by planting trees, which in turn attracted more wildlife, and by making cuttings through the rock.

Nowadays, we're open all year round and we're pleased to say that Winridge is one of the most popular visitor attractions in the area- with 50.000 visitors a year- a million and a half people have been through our doors since we opened.

KEY

TEST 1

A. LISTENING

1B	2C	3C	4C	5C	6B	7C	8A	9A	10B
11C	12D	13A	14B	15C	16D	17A	18B	19C	20D
21B	22C	23C	24A	25B	26D	27C	28B	29A	30D
31B	32D	33D	34D	35C					

B. READING

1B	2A	3B	4B	5B	6B	7C	8D	9C	10B
11A	12D	13A	14B	1C	16A	17D	18C	19A	20D
21A	22C	23D	24B	25C	26D	27B	28A	29C	30D
31A	32B	33A	34B	35A	36C	37D	38C	39D	40B

C. WRITING TASK 1

Phân tích đề bài: Đây là dạng thư than phiền, để đạt điểm tối đa thí sinh cần xác định rõ từng yêu cầu của đề bài để trình bày trong thư, ngôn ngữ cần trang trọng.

Bài viết hoàn chỉnh:

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am writing to express my dissatisfaction with a product I purchased recently from one of your stores.

I recently bought a Samsung Note 10 plus from your store on 177 Nguyen Van Linh street on the 10th of October. However, upon one week of using it, problems started to appear.

The flash of the camera is no longer working. Also, the monitor is getting blurry which makes it difficult for me to see the SMS messages clearly. I was very surprised to discover such problems in a very expensive model.

I hope this matter will receive your immediate attention. In this regard, I insist on getting a refund of my full payment if the replacement will not arrive within one more week.

Thank you in advance.

Yours faithfully,

131 words – 7.5

Bản dịch Tiếng Việt:

Chào ông/bà,

Tôi viết thư này để bày tỏ sự không hài lòng với sản phẩm đã mua từ một trong những cửa hàng của quý công ty.

Gần đây tôi đã mua chiếc điện thoại Samsung Note 10 plus từ cửa hàng địa chỉ 177 Nguyễn Văn Linh ngày 10 tháng 10. Tuy nhiên, khoảng 1 tuần sử dụng thì có nhiều sự cố xuất hiện.

Đèn flash của camera không hoạt động nữa. Không những thế, màn hình bị mờ làm tôi rất khó khăn khi đọc tin nhắn. Tôi rất ngạc nhiên những lỗi như vậy lại có trong một mẫu máy đắt tiền như thế.

Tôi hi vọng sự cố này sẽ nhận được sự quan tâm ngay lập tức. Về sản phẩm này, tôi yêu cầu nhận lại hoàn toàn tiền đã thanh toán nếu tôi không nhận được sản phẩm thay thế trong hơn một tuần nữa.

Cám ơn rất nhiều.

Trân trọng,

C. WRITING TASK 2

Phân tích đề: So với trước đây, hiện nay nhiều người chọn cuộc sống ở một mình. Em nghĩ xu hướng này là thuận lợi hay bất lợi → dựa vào câu hỏi thì đây là dạng bài nêu quan điểm, tuy nhiên để dễ viết hơn thì thí sinh có thể viết giống dạng bài phân tích 2 chiều: thuận lợi và bất lợi.

Dàn bài có 4 đoạn:

Đoạn 1 - Mở bài: 2 câu, trong đó câu 1 là câu giới thiệu bối cảnh kết hợp với chủ đề có biến đổi từ theo đề bài, câu 2 là câu trả lời định hướng bài viết có nêu ý kiến.

Đoạn 2 - Thân bài 1: 5 câu, thân bài 1 cần 2 ý chính để giải thích khía cạnh thuận lợi

Đoạn 3 - Thân bài 2: 5 câu, thân bài 2 cần 2 ý chính để giải thích khía cạnh bất lợi

Đoạn 4 – Kết bài: 1-2 câu để khẳng định, tổng kết lại các quan điểm đã nêu ở trên

Để viết được bài, người viết cần nắm từ vựng chủ đề liên quan, xây dựng ý tưởng lập dàn bài và nắm kỹ các cấu trúc thường dùng để viết bài như:

- it has become far more normal for ...: cái gì đó đã trở nên rất phổ biến
- this trend could have both positive and negative consequences: xu hướng này có cả tác động thuận lợi lẫn bất lợi
- result in: dẫn đến ...
- likely to: có xu hướng
- a rise in: sự tăng lên trong

- face with: đối mặt với
- Các cách diễn đạt câu phức như dùng mệnh đề quan hệ (who), nguyên nhân (because), so sánh (while)

Bài viết hoàn chỉnh:

In recent years, it has become far more normal for people to live alone, particularly in large cities in the developed world. In my opinion, this trend could have both positive and negative consequences in equal measure.

The rise in one-person households can be seen as positive for two primary reasons. On an individual level, people who choose to live alone may become more independent than those who live with family members. A young adult who lives alone, for example, will need to learn to cook, clean, pay bills and manage his or her budget, all of which are valuable life skills. From an economic perspective, the trend towards living alone will result in greater demand for housing. This is likely to benefit the construction industry, estate agents and a whole host of other companies that rely on homeowners to buy their products or services.

On the other hand, the personal and economic arguments given above can be considered from the opposite angle. Firstly, people who live alone may experience feelings of loneliness, isolation and worry. They miss out on the emotional support and daily conversation that family or flatmates can provide, and they must bear the weight of all household bills and responsibilities. Secondly, from the financial point of view, a rise in demand for housing is likely to push up property prices and rents. While this may benefit some businesses, the general population, including those who live alone, will be faced with rising living costs.

In conclusion, the increase in one-person households will have both beneficial and detrimental effects on individuals and on the economy

267 words – 7.5

Bản dịch Tiếng Việt:

Những năm gần đây, việc mọi người muốn sống một mình đã trở thành điều rất bình thường, đặc biệt là ở các thành phố lớn của những nước phát triển. Theo tôi, xu hướng này có những mức độ ảnh hưởng tích cực và tiêu cực gần như nhau.

Sự tăng lên của các gia đình chỉ có một thành viên có thể xem là một điều tích cực bởi những lý do sau. Về khía cạnh cá nhân, những người sống một mình sẽ trở nên độc lập hơn những người ở với gia đình mình. Ví dụ, một người trưởng thành sống một mình sẽ cần học cách nấu ăn, dọn dẹp, tự trả các hóa đơn và quản lý tiền bạc của mình, tất cả những điều này đều là kỹ năng sống cực kì quan trọng. Nhìn từ góc độ kinh tế, xu hướng sống một mình sẽ thúc đẩy các cá nhân tìm

nhà cửa. Điều này tốt cho ngành công nghiệp xây dựng, các công ty bất động sản và các doanh nghiệp khác vẫn đang cung cấp dịch vụ, sản phẩm trong cùng lĩnh vực

Mặt khác, quan điểm ở góc độ cá nhân và kinh tế đã nói trên có thể được nhìn nhận theo một cách trái ngược. Đầu tiên, người sống một mình có thể phải trải qua cảm giác cô đơn, cô lập và lo lắng. Họ không có sự hỗ trợ về mặt tinh thần hay những cuộc nói chuyện hàng ngày mà các gia đình hay những người sống cùng nhau thường có, họ phải gồng gánh một nỗi lo về mọi chi phí, hóa đơn và trách nhiệm một mình. Thứ hai, về góc nhìn tài chính thì nhu cầu tìm nhà riêng ở cũng làm tăng giá đất đai hay nhà thuê. Trong khi điều này có lợi cho các doanh nghiệp thì với phần lớn mọi người, bao gồm những người muốn sống một mình, sẽ phải vất vả hơn đối mặt với chi phí sinh hoạt ngày càng tăng cao.

Kết luận, sự tăng lên của việc lựa chọn sống một mình sẽ có những hiệu ứng tích cực lẫn tiêu cực đối với cá nhân và kinh tế.

D. SPEAKING

Part I

Gợi ý: Trả lời rõ ràng vào bảng vấn đề, có trọng tâm sau đó mở rộng thêm các ý từ 2-3-4 câu tùy tốc độ nói của mỗi người. Tổng thời gian lý tưởng cho câu hỏi phần này là 20-25s

- Do you live in a house or a flat?

Currently, I live in a small house with family, which is located in a small town. It has a living room, 3 bed rooms with attached washroom and a kitchen. I have been living there since I was born.

- **attached:** tích hợp, kèm theo

- What are some advantages of living in an apartment?

I had lived in an apartment for 4 years since I started studying at university. So, I found some difficulties of residing in an apartment such as noise from neighbors, sharing spaces such as yard, balcony or flat roof. You may get trouble with your roommates or neighbors as well.

- **sharing spaces:** không gian chung
- **reside:** ở
- **get trouble with:** gặp phải vấn đề với

- Can you describe your dream house?

Well, if I would be given a chance, I would like to live in a house that is neither too big nor too small, but with just the right size, where there are a living room, just one or maybe two bedrooms with attached washroom and a kitchen. (To me, decorating is very important. I want to do it by myself, following my own style).

- **right size:** kích thước phù hợp
- Do you like travelling?

Of course, I have a strong preference for journey. Not only is travelling the best way to relax, but it also helps me to widen my knowledge. You know, I usually go with my friends or my family. Sometimes, I also choose going alone in a strange city because it gives me the feeling of adventure.

- **have a strong preference for:** thích
- **feelling of adventure:** cảm giác phiêu lưu

- Do you like travelling alone or with others?

Well, I would prefer to travel with others. I guess travelling with a companion is safer because we can support each other if something happens. It is more exciting as we can share all beautiful moments and new experiences.

- **companion:** bạn

- What do you often do on your holiday?

I usually spend my holidays in the mountains. You know, I am a big fan of climbing. Standing on the top of the mountain, I can inhale fresh air as well as see the beautiful picture of landscape below.

- **inhale:** hít thở
- **landscape:** cảnh

Part II

Tập trả lời theo một dàn bài mà bạn quen thuộc, sẽ dễ hơn nếu phân tích từng phương án và làm rõ ưu nhược điểm của từng phương án. Phương án được lựa chọn sẽ có nhiều lý do tích cực hơn.

Bài nói mẫu B2:

Well, I think I would choose a sight-seeing holiday as the most suitable choice for my holiday. You know, there are quite a few clear benefits.

I could say the first thing is that I can visit famous tourist attractions. This is simply because I can enjoy the beautiful scenery and save memory by taking photos. An other advantage is that we can discover new culture. This is valuable since I am interested in learning something new during my holiday.

Regarding a beach holiday, it can't be denied that there are some exciting activities at the beach such as sunbathing, playing water sports or building sandcastles. However, I live in a coastal city, so I quite often go to the beach on the weekend to enjoy seafood and play volleyball with my friends, or just go for walks there. So, I want something different for my holiday.

It is clear that a climbing holiday is also a good idea. This is because I can climb the mountain and camp on the top. The fresh air on there would help me refresh my mind and feel relaxed. That would be so great! But you know to me, a climbing holiday is not suitable because I get arthritis, it is difficult for me to hike.

For all these reasons, a sight-seeing holiday is the best option.

- **famous tourist attractions:** địa điểm du lịch nổi tiếng
- **scenery:** phong cảnh
- **sunbathing:** tắm nắng
- **building sandcastles:** xây lâu đài cát
- **coastal city:** thành phố biển
- **refresh my mind:** giải tỏa đầu óc
- **arthritis:** bệnh khớp

Part III

*Đây là phần thi khó, cần học nhiều từ vựng và cấu trúc câu thường dùng để phân tích các khía cạnh khác nhau của một vấn đề, sự kiện như **thuận lợi, bất lợi, nguyên nhân, vấn đề, giải pháp**. Các chủ đề thường gặp là **công nghệ, môi trường, học tập, trường lớp, các vấn đề ở thành phố**. Lời khuyên cho các bạn ở trình độ B1, B2 là nên nói đơn giản, độ dài vừa phải, cố gắng diễn giải đầy đủ các ý đề bài đã cho, phần gạch chân là đề bài đã cung cấp. Bài tập này thuộc chủ đề công nghệ, thí sinh cần nắm những từ vựng liên quan để trả lời tốt.*

Bài nói mẫu B2

Mobile phones are useful tools at schools in many ways.

Firstly, they play the role of mobile office tools. We can use the apps on it to **create text, presentations slides** and **record necessary things** everywhere in school, without the need of a computer.

Secondly, it enables us access the internet easily and quickly. We can search for information and **download materials** as well as **submit assignments** easily and quickly, which is helpful for our studying.

An other benefit is that they are great means of communication. Phone calls and text messages enables us to **keep in touch with** friends, teachers and parents. **Social networks** which can be accessed with a mobile phone are also great way to **interact with** people around.

Last but not least, it's a way to relax after the learning hours. We can use it to listen to music, take pictures, **surf the webs** or play games in the **break time** and reduce stress.

In conclusion, mobile phones are very beneficial in education today.

- **create text:** tạo văn bản
- **presentations slides:** trình chiếu bài thuyết trình
- **record necessary things:** ghi âm những điều quan trọng
- **download materials:** tải tài liệu
- **submit assignments:** nộp bài tập
- **keep in touch with:** giữ liên lạc
- **social networks:** mạng xã hội

- **interact with:** tương tác với
- **surf the webs:** lướt web
- **break time:** thời gian nghỉ
- **beneficial:** có lợi

TEST 2

A. LISTENING

1A	2B	3B	4B	5C	6A	7B	8A	9B	10B
11C	12D	13A	14B	15C	16D	17B	18D	19A	20A
21C	22B	23C	24A	25D	26A	27B	28D	29D	30C
31D	32B	33A	34A	35C					

B. READING

1D	2A	3D	4B	5C	6B	7A	8D	9C	10C
11A	12B	13D	14A	15D	16C	17A	18B	19C	20D
21A	22C	23A	24B	25B	26D	27B	28C	29D	30B
31D	32B	33D	34B	35C	36A	37C	38A	39B	40D

C. WRITING TASK 1

Phân tích nhanh đề bài: Đây là dạng thư xin lỗi, để đạt điểm tối đa thí sinh cần xác định rõ từng yêu cầu của đề bài để trình bày trong thư, ngôn ngữ cần trang trọng

Bài viết hoàn chỉnh:

Dear Mr and Mrs Smith,

I am writing to sincerely apologise for the disturbance caused during my birthday party last Saturday night.

I was celebrating my 30th birthday with my friends and approximately two hours after the party started, two people, who were friends of a friend, started arguing about an issue that is still unknown to me.

I deeply regret having interrupted your sleep. Please accept my most sincere apologies. I understand that we all enjoy living in a peaceful neighbourhood and whatever happened at my party should not have disturbed you.

I will refrain from holding parties in my unit in the future in order to avoid further problematic events in our residential area.

Once again, my apologies for the inconvenience caused.

Kind regards,

128 words – 7.5

Bản dịch Tiếng Việt:

Thân gửi ông bà Smiths,

Tôi viết thư này để chân thành xin lỗi vì sự làm phiền đã xảy ra trong buổi tiệc sinh nhật của tôi tối thứ 7.

Tôi đang liên hoan sinh nhật lần thứ 30 của mình cùng một số người bạn, khoảng 2 tiếng sau khi tiệc bắt đầu thì 2 người, thực ra là bạn của một người bạn của tôi bắt đầu cãi nhau về một vấn đề tôi không rõ.

Tôi thực sự lấy làm tiếc vì đã làm ông bà thức giấc. Mong ông bà nhận lời xin lỗi chân thành của tôi. Tôi hiểu rằng chúng ta đang sống bình yên trong một khu vực yên tĩnh và những gì xảy ra trong bữa tiệc của tôi không nên ảnh hưởng đến ông bà.

Tôi sẽ không tổ chức tiệc tùng ở chỗ của tôi trong thời gian tới nhằm tránh gây ra những sự việc đáng tiếc tương tự ở khu vực chúng ta đang sống.

Một lần nữa, tôi xin lỗi vì sự bất tiện đã xảy ra.

Trân trọng,

C. WRITING TASK 2

Phân tích đề: Dù ngày càng nhiều người chuyển sang tin tức trên mạng, báo giấy vẫn duy trì như là một nguồn cung cấp thông tin quan trọng. Dựa vào câu hỏi thì đây là dạng bài nêu quan điểm đồng ý hay không đồng ý, với sự phổ biến của việc đọc báo online ở thực tế hiện nay, sẽ dễ hơn nếu ta chọn phương án không đồng ý, nghiêng hẳn về phản báo mạng. (các bạn vẫn có thể viết kiểu cân bằng)

Dàn bài có 4 đoạn:

Đoạn 1 - Mở bài: 2 câu, trong đó câu 1 là câu giới thiệu bối cảnh kết hợp với chủ đề có biến đổi từ theo đề bài, câu 2 là câu trả lời định hướng bài viết có nêu ý kiến **là không đồng ý**

Đoạn 2 - Thân bài 1: 5 câu, thân bài 1 cần 2 ý chính để giải thích vì sao đọc báo mạng rất tiện

Đoạn 3 - Thân bài 2: 5 câu, thân bài 2 cần 2 ý chính để giải thích vì sao báo giấy có nhiều bất tiện

Đoạn 4 – Kết bài: 1-2 câu để khẳng định, tổng kết lại quan điểm là **không đồng ý** với quan điểm đề bài.

Để viết được bài, người viết cần nắm từ vựng chủ đề liên quan, xây dựng ý tưởng lập dàn bài và nắm kĩ các cấu trúc thường dùng để viết bài như:

- have led to: dẫn tới
- have access to: truy cập tới
- come to rely on: trở nên phụ thuộc
- Các cách xây dựng câu phức để tạo nên các ý chặt chẽ: So sánh, nguyên nhân, nhượng bộ

Bài viết hoàn chỉnh:

Today, while many people have access to the Internet to keep up with the latest news, it is said that newspapers will continue as the major source of news. I totally disagree with this view.

The speed and convenience of the Internet in this digital age have led to the increasing popularity of online news. First of all, the Internet is able to provide up-to-the-minute news as it happens, 24 hours a day every day. As long as people have a smart phone or a laptop, they can connect almost instantly to the Internet, surf the websites and access the news which they are interested in all over the world. An other reason is that more and more people now have access to the Internet and this trend appears will continue in the future. Due to the widespread of the Internet, users will come to rely on it as their news source.

In contrast, newspapers have drawbacks which affect their popularity. One major problem of relying on newspapers as a news source is the cost. Competing with freely available news online, newspaper publishers are facing the reality of falling circulation figures. Some major Vietnamese newspapers have now introduced online versions alongside their printed editions to catch up with this trend. Another disadvantage of newspapers is the amount of paper consumed in their production. With growing environmental awareness, there is a body of public opinion which rejects buying newspapers because this involves cutting trees and transporting them to paper mills.

In conclusion, I would argue that newspapers will continue to decline in importance, and more and more people will use the Internet to access the news.

275 words – 7.5

Bản dịch Tiếng Việt:

Hiện nay, khi mà nhiều người truy cập Internet để cập nhật những tin tức mới nhất trên mạng, có ý kiến cho rằng báo giấy vẫn sẽ tiếp tục duy trì như nguồn thông tin quan trọng. Tôi hoàn toàn không đồng tình với quan điểm này.

Trong thời đại công nghệ số như hiện nay, tốc độ và sự tiện lợi của mạng Internet đã đưa tới sự thông dụng ngày càng lớn của báo mạng. Đầu tiên, mạng Internet có khả năng cập nhật tin tức đến từng phút ngay khi sự việc mới xảy ra, 24 giờ hàng ngày. Miễn là mọi người có điện thoại thông minh hoặc laptop đi cùng, họ có thể ngay lập tức kết nối với mạng Internet, lướt web và tiếp cận với những thông tin họ quan tâm trên toàn thế giới. Một lý do nữa là ngày càng có nhiều người có kết nối với mạng Internet và xu hướng này chắc chắn vẫn tiếp tục gia tăng. Tốc độ tiếp cận Internet ngày càng gia tăng thì ngày càng có nhiều người coi đây là nguồn cung cấp thông tin chính của họ.

Trái lại, báo giấy có những mặt hạn chế ảnh hưởng đến sự phổ biến của loại hình này. Một trong những nguyên nhân chính làm nản lòng người đọc chính là chi phí. Khi cạnh tranh với báo mạng được cung cấp miễn phí, những nhà xuất bản báo giấy đang đối mặt với tình trạng doanh số xuất bản được tiêu thụ ngày càng giảm sút. Một số đầu báo chính thống tại Việt Nam giờ đây cũng đưa ra những phiên bản báo mạng song song với bản báo giấy nhằm bắt kịp xu hướng này. Một nhược điểm khác của báo giấy đó là số lượng giấy tiêu thụ trong quá trình sản xuất. Cùng với sự nhận thức về môi trường ngày càng tăng, đã có hẳn một tổ chức công luận từ chối mua báo giấy bởi báo giấy cũng góp phần vào quá trình chặt cây lấy gỗ và chuyển qua các nhà máy sản xuất giấy.

Tóm lại, tôi cho rằng báo giấy sẽ tiếp tục sụt giảm đáng kể, và sẽ ngày càng nhiều người sử dụng mạng Internet để tiếp cận thông tin hơn.

D. SPEAKING

Part I

Gợi ý: Trả lời rõ ràng vào thẳng vấn đề, có trọng tâm sau đó mở rộng thêm các ý từ 2-3-4 câu tùy tốc độ nói của mỗi người. Tổng thời gian lý tưởng cho câu hỏi phần này là 20-25s

- Do you like watching movies?

I have to say I am really crazy about watching films, especially those are about love. It's so fantastic to find myself in some characters. Sometimes, I also like to see comedies in order to cheer me up.

- **crazy about:** cực kì mê
- **characters:** nhân vật
- **comedies:** phim hài
- **cheer me up:** thấy vui lên, vui vẻ

- What kind of movies do you like? Why?

As a great lover of films, I like all sorts of films. However, if I had to choose one, it would be romantic movies, because they are sentimental and sometimes they provide me with moral lessons about love and life.

- **great lover of st:** người cực kì thích một cái gì đó
- **sentimental:** nhẹ nhàng, tình cảm
- **moral lessons:** bài học về đạo đức, quan điểm, cách sống

- Do you prefer watching films on TV at home or at the cinema?

I prefer watching films at the cinema. It provides me with more exciting atmosphere. Besides, the surrounding sound system at the cinema brings the characters to life and enhances special effects. Even I can enjoy a night out with my friends.

- **sound system:** hệ thống âm thanh
- **enhance:** cải thiện, nâng cao
- **special effect:** hiệu ứng đặc biệt
- **night out:** đi chơi cả đêm

- Do you know the people who live next door to you?

I know my neighbors quite well. There are 3 people in their family, including a young couple and a cute son. They're really nice people. They are also very polite, so there are rarely any arguments between us.

- **arguments:** cãi vã, tranh luận

- Do you get on well with your neighbors?

Certainly, it's important to get on well with the people who live next door. I always stop to have a small talk whenever I see them. Sometimes, I help them to take care of their baby or pick him up from kindergarten. And of course, so do they.

- **get on well:** hợp
- **pick sb up:** đón ai đó

- In what way are neighbors helpful?

We all want good neighbors because they are closest people whom we share the daily life with. Therefore, I would like to live nearby friendly and helpful people who can at least smile and say hello whenever we meet each other. Even neighbors can help each other in some necessary cases.

- **necessary cases:** những lúc cần thiết

Part II

Tập trả lời theo một dàn bài mà bạn quen thuộc, sẽ dễ hơn nếu phân tích từng phương án và làm rõ ưu nhược điểm của từng phương án. Phương án được lựa chọn sẽ có nhiều lý do tích cực hơn.

Bài nói mẫu B2:

Well, If I've got an opportunity to go on a holiday to refresh myself, I guess I would stay in a resort near the beach. You know, there are quite a few clear benefits.

I could say the first thing is that I can go swimming, eat delicious seafood and enjoy fresh atmosphere. Those are perfect things to do to escape from my daily routine. An other advantage is that I can get access to modern facilities services, so I believe I could have the greatest experiences during my stay.

Regarding a cottage in the countryside, it can't be denied that it can bring me a chance to be close to nature, well, I can enjoy fresh or clean fruits. Oh, and the people in countryside are so friendly, too. However, I may feel bored due to the lack of exciting activities there. There's no bars and pubs, you know I may find nothing to do at night.

It is clear that a hotel in the mountainous area is also a good idea. This is because I can enjoy the fresh air and cool climate to refresh my mind. That would be so great! But I find it hard to access to modern facilities, there's no theatres, no shopping malls. I am not a fan of mountain climbing either.

For all these reasons, a holiday in a resort is the best option.

- **escape from my daily routine:** thoát khỏi cuộc sống thường nhật
- **close to nature:** gần với thiên nhiên
- **lack of:** thiếu, không có
- **cool climate:** khí hậu mát mẻ
- **a fan of mountain climbing:** một người yêu thích leo núi

Part III

*Đây là phần thi khó, cần học nhiều từ vựng và cấu trúc câu thường dùng để phân tích các khía cạnh khác nhau của một vấn đề, sự kiện như **thuận lợi, bất lợi, nguyên nhân, vấn đề, giải pháp**. Các chủ đề thường gặp là **công nghệ, môi trường, học tập, trường lớp, các vấn đề ở thành phố**. Lời khuyên cho các bạn ở trình độ B1, B2 là nên nói đơn giản, độ dài vừa phải, cố gắng diễn giải đầy đủ các ý đề bài đã cho, phần gạch chân là đề bài đã cung cấp. Bài tập này thuộc chủ đề học tập nên thí sinh cần chuẩn bị những từ vựng liên quan để trả lời tốt.*

Bài nói mẫu B2

There are a number of benefits that studying abroad brings about.

Firstly, it enhances knowledge and experience. We have chance to **broaden our mind greatly** when we **access a more advanced** or **specialized education abroad**. Also, the studying and living environment in another country is different, which gives us **valuable experience** about the culture of that country

Secondly, it promotes career prospects. The training they get from a good education ensure they can do their work well. With a degree as a **proof** for their enquired knowledge and skills, they can have great **job opportunities** with much **better salary**.

*Thirdly, it fosters personal growth. Students learn to be independent, to **overcome homesickness**, perfect their second languages and so on. These help them improve themselves and become more **well-rounded**.*

*Last but not least, you could develop a wider network of relationship with friends and lecturer from other countries. You may **benefit** from their support in many **fields** in the future.*

In conclusion, it seems to me that students should study oversea if they could.

- **enhance:** nâng cao, phát triển
- **broaden our mind greatly:** mở mang tư duy
- **access a more advanced or specialized education abroad:** tiếp cận hệ thống giáo dục tiên tiến và chuyên sâu
- **valuable experience:** kinh nghiệm quý giá
- **proof:** bằng chứng
- **job opportunities:** cơ hội việc làm
- **better salary:** lương cao hơn
- **overcome homesickness:** vượt qua nỗi nhớ nhà
- **well-rounded:** toàn diện
- **benefit:** hưởng lợi từ
- **fields:** các lĩnh vực

TEST 3

A. LISTENING

1B	2A	3C	4C	5C	6A	7B	8B	9D	10C
11D	12B	13A	14B	15A	16B	17D	18A	19B	20A
21B	22B	23C	24C	25A	26C	27A	28D	29C	30B
31B	32B	33B	34A	35B					

B. READING

1B	2C	3D	4C	5B	6B	7C	8D	9C	10A
11D	12C	13A	14D	15C	16A	17D	18C	19B	20B
21C	22B	23C	24A	25C	26A	27D	28D	29C	30D
31B	32B	33D	34D	35A	36B	37A	38A	39D	40C

C. WRITING TASK 1

Phân tích nhanh đề bài: Đây là dạng thư yêu cầu, để đạt điểm tối đa thí sinh cần xác định rõ từng yêu cầu của đề bài để trình bày trong thư, ngôn ngữ cần trang trọng

Bài viết hoàn chỉnh

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am writing to ask if you would be so kind as to give me some details about your hotel's accommodation.

I would like to book accommodation for my family and I from the 11th of March until the 15th. On the 11th I would like to arrive late in the afternoon, and on the 15th, if possible, I would like to have a late check-out at about 4pm.

As we are two adults and a child, I would like to book a one-bedroom suite, if possible. Please, let me know how much it would be for the entire length of our stay and also whether the price includes anything extra like breakfast.

I would also appreciate any information you can offer about places for sightseeing and leisure activities as we will be spending a few days in the town nearby.

Thank you in advance for your kind cooperation.

Yours faithfully,

155 words – 7.5

Bản dịch Tiếng Việt

Chào ông/bà,

Tôi viết thư này để hỏi liệu rằng ông/bà có thể vui lòng cung cấp cho tôi một vài thông tin chi tiết về phòng ốc của khách sạn mình.

Tôi muốn đặt phòng cho gia đình tôi và tôi từ ngày 11 tháng 3 tới ngày 15. Vào ngày 11 tôi sẽ tới trễ vào buổi chiều, còn ngày thứ 15 nếu có thể thì tôi muốn trả phòng trễ một chút khoảng 4 giờ chiều.

Vì chúng tôi gồm 2 người lớn đi cùng một bé nên tôi muốn đặt phòng có một giường. Vui lòng cho tôi biết giá phòng là bao nhiêu trong suốt thời gian ở của chúng tôi và giá có bao gồm bữa ăn sáng hay không.

Tôi cũng rất cảm kích nếu ông/bà có thể gửi tôi thêm một chút thông tin về các địa điểm để đi ngắm cảnh lúc rảnh rỗi vì tôi dự định dành một vài ngày vào thăm khu phố gần đó.

Xin cảm ơn rất nhiều vì sự hợp tác.

Trân trọng,

C. WRITING TASK 2

Phân tích đề: Người sống ở thành phố lớn phải đối mặt với nhiều vấn đề khác nhau trong cuộc sống hàng ngày. Tìm vấn đề và giải pháp. Dựa vào câu hỏi thì đây là dạng bài 2 câu hỏi tìm vấn đề của sự việc và giải pháp để khắc phục. Với dạng bài này thường ta viết 2 khổ thân bài, thân bài 1 phân tích các vấn đề của người dân thành phố đang đối mặt, thân bài 2 phân tích những phương án giải quyết.

Dàn bài có 4 đoạn:

Đoạn 1 - Mở bài: 2 câu, trong đó câu 1 là câu giới thiệu bối cảnh kết hợp với chủ đề có biến đổi từ theo đề bài, câu 2 là câu trả lời định hướng bài viết

Đoạn 2 - Thân bài 1: 5 câu, thân bài 1 cần 2 ý chính để giải thích các vấn đề: giá cao, kẹt xe

Đoạn 3 - Thân bài 2: 5 câu, thân bài 2 cần 2 ý chính để giải thích các phương án xử lý vấn đề đã nêu ở thân bài 1

Đoạn 4 – Kết bài: 1-2 câu để khẳng định

Để viết được bài, người viết cần nắm từ vựng chủ đề liên quan, xây dựng ý tưởng lập dàn bài và nắm kĩ các cấu trúc thường dùng để viết dạng bài này như:

- examine some of these problems in detail: phân tích các vấn đề một cách chi tiết
- propose some solutions: đề xuất các giải pháp
- out of reach for: ngoài tầm tay của
- overrun with sth: quá tải, quá nhiều cái gì
- suffer from: chịu đựng cái gì
- allow sb to do sth: cho phép ai làm gì đó
- Các cách diễn đạt câu phức để tạo các câu chặt chẽ: Nhượng bộ (although), mệnh đề quan hệ (who, which)

Bài viết hoàn chỉnh:

These days, more and more of us are living in big cities. Although cities are very attractive places to live, there are also a lot of serious social problems affecting cities. This essay will examine some of these problems in detail, and then propose some solutions.

There are two primary problems that people are facing in big cities. Firstly, buying a house near the centre is out of reach for people on the average salary, and they have to live outside the city and to commute into work. In central Ho Chi Minh city, for instance, the cost of a one-bedroom flat is 7-10 millions per month which is too high for most of people. Another issue is traffic and air pollution. Most big cities are overrun with cars, and there is a lot of traffic congestion. The exhaust fumes from these cars cause air pollution, and as a consequence, more and more people are suffering from respiratory diseases, such as asthma.

However, these problems could be solved in a number of ways. The first measure is that the government could put more resources into building affordable housing. This would allow more people to buy their own home. An other solution is introducing a congestion charge for cars entering the city centre. Moreover, the government should invest more money in trains and buses, and to slash ticket prices which would encourage more people to use public transport. As a result, number of vehicles on the road would be reduced.

To sum up, although it is clear that cities face a range of problems, it is undoubtedly possible to start to tackle these issues, and improve the quality of life in cities.

283 words – 7

Bản dịch Tiếng Việt:

Hiện nay, ngày càng nhiều người chuyển đến sống với các thành phố lớn. Mặc dù thành phố là nơi rất hấp dẫn để sống, nhưng ở đó vẫn tồn tại nhiều vấn đề xã hội nghiêm trọng ảnh hưởng cuộc sống người dân. Bài luận sẽ phân tích những vấn đề chi tiết và đề xuất một số phương án giải quyết.

Có 2 vấn đề chính mà người dân đang phải đối mặt ở những thành phố lớn. Đầu tiên, mua nhà ở trung tâm là điều hầu như không thể với những người có thu nhập trung bình, và họ phải sống ở những khu vực vùng ven để di chuyển vào trung tâm làm việc. Ví dụ như ở trung tâm thành phố Hồ Chí Minh, chi phí để thuê một căn hộ một giường đã tầm 7-10 triệu đồng một tháng, rất cao so với hầu hết mọi người dân. Một vấn đề nữa ở thành phố lớn là giao thông và ô nhiễm không khí. Hầu hết các thành phố lớn đều có lượng xe lưu thông quá tải, tắc đường xảy ra thường xuyên. Lượng khí thải từ các loại xe gây ra ô nhiễm không khí và khiến người dân bị những bệnh về hô hấp như hen suyễn.

Tuy vậy, những vấn đề này có thể giải quyết được bởi một số phương án. Đầu tiên là chính phủ có thể tập trung thêm nguồn lực xây dựng các khu nhà giá bình dân. Điều này sẽ cho phép nhiều người mua được nhà hơn. Một giải pháp nữa là đưa ra mức phí áp dụng cho các loại xe đi vào trung tâm thành phố. Ngoài ra chính phủ nên đầu tư nhiều tiền hơn vào các phương tiện như tàu và xe buýt, giảm giá vé các loại phương tiện trên sẽ khuyến khích mọi người đi phương tiện công cộng nhiều hơn. Điều đó sẽ giúp cho lượng xe lưu thông trên đường giảm lại.

Tổng kết, dù các thành phố lớn đang đối mặt với nhiều vấn đề, nhưng hoàn toàn có thể giải quyết được để nâng cao cuộc sống của người dân.

D. SPEAKING

Part I

Gợi ý: Trả lời rõ ràng vào thẳng vấn đề, có trọng tâm sau đó mở rộng thêm các ý từ 2-3-4 câu tùy tốc độ nói của mỗi người. Tổng thời gian lý tưởng cho câu hỏi phần này là 20-25s

- Do you like to go to the park?

Certainly, I usually walk in the park with my pet or my friends. Sometimes, I go to the park with my family at the weekends. The atmosphere there is very fresh with many big trees and immense greens.

- **immense:** rộng rãi

- Do people go to parks in your area?

Yes. As you may see, there many people who walk in the park every morning and late afternoon. Public parks provide people in my area with opportunities to be physically active.

- **physically active:** vận động

- What make a good park?

From my point of view, an idea park is one which has a lot of trees and ponds to look at, lots of grass to walk on and fresh air to enjoy. A good park should have lots of walking paths that people can meander along. Well, it should be centrally located and accessible to people of all generations and walks of life.

- **pond:** hồ
- **meander:** đi tản bộ, lang thang, đi dạo
- **walking paths:** lối đi bộ
- **be centrally located:** nằm ở trung tâm
- **accessible:** dễ đến, dễ tiếp cận
- **walks of life:** các đối tượng với nhiều ngành nghề khác nhau

- What is your favorite pet?

Keeping pets is one of my hobbies and the one I like best is dogs, especially Buli dogs. Dogs are believed to be the most royal pet. Besides, dogs are very intelligent so they can understand our mood. Playing with dogs enables me to relax after hours of working.

- **royal:** trung thành
- **intelligent:** thông minh
- **mood:** cảm xúc

- Do you have a pet at home?

Of course, I have a Bull dog at home. I have had him for almost one year and I call him Bin. There are many wrinkles in his face, which makes him look so cute. My Bull is gentle and funny. Whenever I return home, he comes to me and acts so fondly. It seems to me that he can understand my thoughts and gestures. I love him so much.

- **wrinkles:** nếp nhăn
- **gentle:** hiền
- **fondly:** âu yếm, dễ thương

- **thoughts and gestures:** suy nghĩ và cử chỉ

- What are the benefits of keeping pets?

As far as I concerned. Keeping pets can bring us many advantages. Well, they may be our good friends. We will have quality time with them by walking them to the park or gossiping with them. Besides, I think it's a good way to make more friends with those who share the same interest of raising pets with us.

- **quality time:** Thời gian vui vẻ hạnh phúc
- **gossiping:** trò chuyện riêng
- **raising pets:** nuôi thú cưng

Part II

Tập trả lời theo một dàn bài mà bạn quen thuộc, sẽ dễ hơn nếu phân tích từng phương án và làm rõ ưu nhược điểm của từng phương án. Phương án được lựa chọn sẽ có nhiều lý do tích cực hơn.

Bài nói mẫu B2:

Well, If my friend wanted to take up a new hobby, I guess I would suggest him trying yoga. You know, there are quite a few clear benefits.

I could say the first thing is that yoga can help him improve his physical and mental health. He doesn't have to spend lots of time being outdoors, he could be fitter and healthier by practicing regularly at home. An other advantage is that he can have a fresh and peaceful mind, which is helpful for his learning.

Regarding playing piano, it can't be denied that it can help him play the pieces of music he likes, well, it's a great way to relax. However, piano takes much time to learn and practice, and a good piano is expensive, too.

It is clear doing charity is also a good idea. This is because he can help others and learn how to sympathize for others, but my friend is a shy, silent person and not confident sometimes. For all the reasons above, doing yoga is the best option for my friend.

- **suggest:** giới thiệu
- **physical and mental health:** sức khỏe về thể chất và tinh thần
- **outdoors:** bên ngoài, ngoài trời
- **fresh and peaceful mind:** đầu óc thư thái, thoải mái
- **pieces of music:** các bản nhạc
- **sympathize:** cảm thông

Part III

*Đây là phần thi khó, cần học nhiều từ vựng và cấu trúc câu thường dùng để phân tích các khía cạnh khác nhau của một vấn đề, sự kiện như **thuận lợi, bất lợi, nguyên nhân, vấn đề, giải pháp**. Các chủ đề thường gặp là **công nghệ, môi trường, học tập, trường lớp, các vấn đề ở thành phố**. Lời khuyên cho các bạn ở trình độ B1, B2 là nên nói đơn giản, độ dài vừa phải, có*

gắng diễn giải đầy đủ các ý đề bài đã cho, phần gạch chân là đề bài đã cung cấp. Bài tập này thuộc chủ đề du lịch nên thí sinh cần chuẩn bị những từ vựng liên quan để trả lời tốt.

Bài nói mẫu B2

It's true that visiting a foreign country is really beneficial to people.

To begin with, when we travel to other countries, we can refresh ourselves. Visiting a foreign country means that we have to live in a **brand new environment**, so we have to change ourselves **to adapt** to it.

Next, we can gain lots of experience, too. When we come to **tourist destinations** and take part in certain activities there such as going around, playing games, enjoying local foods and drinks, we can earn a lot of **precious experience**.

An other benefit of visiting a foreign country is that it gives us a great chance for us to make new friends. In a new environment, we have to communicate with people that don't say the same language. we will have many new friends from many countries in the world and **broaden our relationship network**.

Last but not least, if we traveled to an English speaking country, we would be able to practice English with native speakers, which can help us to improve our English skills as well as social skills.

- **brand new environment:** môi trường mới mẻ
- **adapt:** thích nghi
- **tourist destinations:** địa điểm du lịch
- **precious experience:** kinh nghiệm quý giá
- **broaden our relationship network:** mở mang mối quan hệ

TEST 4

A. LISTENING

1C	2B	3A	4A	5C	6A	7C	8C		
9D	10D	11B	12C	13A	14B	15C	16B	17D	18C
19A	20A	21C	22D	23D	24A	25A	26C	27D	28A
29D	30-D	31C	32A	33B	34B	35B			

B. READING

1B	2C	3A	4A	5D	6D	7C	8D	9B	10A
11D	12A	13B	14C	15 D	16A	17C	18B	19D	20D
21C	22A	23D	24C	25C	26B	27D	28B	29 D	30A
31B	32B	33B	34C	35C	36A	37D	38D	39A	40D

C. WRITING TASK 1

Phân tích nhanh đề bài: Đây là dạng thư yêu cầu, để đạt điểm tối đa thí sinh cần xác định rõ từng yêu cầu của đề bài để trình bày trong thư, ngôn ngữ cần trang trọng

Bài viết hoàn chỉnh

Dear Sir/Madam,

The purpose of this letter is to express my opinion about your magazine.

I purchased the magazine because it includes topics that relate to my hobby of bird watching. I often seek out new places to visit to take photos of birds and your magazine seems to provide lots of good recommendations.

What I loved the most about your current issue was the article describing places to go bird watching in local national parks. I especially like the way you covered the latest developments in the parks that support birdwatchers.

I would like to suggest you to continue producing material which is useful and enjoyable to read. Also, I suggest that you make the magazine more concise and with fewer images so it is lighter and even more appealing.

I hope you find my comments and recommendations helpful.

Yours sincerely,

142 words – 7.5

Bản dịch Tiếng Việt

Chào ông/bà,

Mục đích của tôi khi gửi thư này là để chia sẻ quan điểm của tôi về tạp chí của quý công ty.

Tôi đặt mua tạp chí ở quý khách vì nó cung cấp nhiều chủ đề liên quan tới sở thích của tôi là ngắm chim. Tôi thường đi tìm những nơi mới để chụp hình các loài chim và tạp chí của bạn đã cung cấp cho tôi rất nhiều gợi ý hay.

Điều tôi thích nhất ở ấn phẩm hiện tại là những bài báo miêu tả những nơi có thể đi quan sát chim trong công viên quốc gia. Tôi đặc biệt thích cách mà bạn cung cấp những cập nhật mới nhất từ công viên để hỗ trợ những người yêu chim chóc như tôi.

Tôi mong bạn tiếp tục cho ra những tư liệu hay và hữu ích như thế. Ngoài ra tôi cũng muốn tạp chí có thể được thiết kế gọn gàng và rõ ràng hơn, với ít hình ảnh hơn thì tờ tạp chí sẽ nhẹ nhàng và trông hấp dẫn hơn.

Mong rằng những gợi ý của tôi sẽ có ích cho tòa soạn.

Trân trọng,

C. WRITING TASK 2

Phân tích đề: Nhiều sinh viên đang đi học nhưng vẫn đi làm vì nhiều lý do. Theo bạn lợi ích của việc đi làm thêm có trội hơn bất lợi? Dựa vào câu hỏi thì đây là dạng bài nêu quan điểm cá nhân, tuy nhiên ta có thể viết tương tự dạng phân tích 2 chiều đối lập với 2 khổ thân bài, thân bài 1 phân tích các lợi ích của việc sinh viên đi làm thêm, thân bài 2 phân tích những bất cập, trong bài viết có đưa ra quan điểm cá nhân rõ ràng là mặt nào trội hơn.

Dàn bài có 4 đoạn:

Đoạn 1 - Mở bài: 2 câu, trong đó câu 1 là câu giới thiệu bối cảnh kết hợp với chủ đề có biến đổi từ theo đề bài, câu 2 là câu trả lời định hướng bài viết

Đoạn 2 - Thân bài 1: 5 câu, thân bài 1 cần 2 ý chính để giải thích những thuận lợi của việc đi làm thêm: kiếm được thu nhập và mở rộng mối quan hệ

Đoạn 3 - Thân bài 2: 5 câu, thân bài 2 cần 2 ý chính để giải thích bất cập của việc đi làm thêm khi đang đi học: dễ bị xao nhãng việc học vì quá ham đi làm và dễ bị lừa đảo.

Đoạn 4 – Kết bài: 1-2 câu để khẳng định quan điểm

Để viết được bài, người viết cần nắm từ vựng chủ đề liên quan, xây dựng ý tưởng lập dàn bài và nắm kĩ các cấu trúc thường dùng để viết dạng bài này như:

- become increasingly popular: trở nên rất là phổ biến
- both sides of this issue: 2 mặt của vấn đề

- enable sb to do sth: cho phép ai làm gì
- help sb to do sth: giúp ai làm điều gì
- distract sb from st: làm ai đó xao nhãng khỏi cái gì
- too exhausted to do sth: quá mệt để làm gì
- Các cách diễn đạt câu phức để tạo các câu chặt chẽ: Nhượng bộ (although), mệnh đề quan hệ (who, which), nguyên nhân (because)

Bài viết hoàn chỉnh:

Taking part-time jobs has become increasingly popular among university students. Besides advantages, working part-time also brings some certain disadvantages. This essay will discuss both sides of this issue and give my personal opinion.

On the one hand, doing part-time jobs offers students a large number of benefits. Firstly, students can earn money themselves while attending to colleges. Taking a part-time job, in this point, students can pay a part of their living cost and at the same time relieve their parents' burden. Secondly, working part-time enables students to broaden their relationship particularly with many people at their workplace namely the managers or colleagues, which may help them to find a job more easily in the future. Moreover, undergraduates working part-time are likely to be more confident than the others when they start a job after graduation.

On the other hand, there are some disadvantages, too. One of the main drawback is that working part-time might distract learners from their study. For instance, they might be too exhausted after working to focus on their academic studying. Some students may skip classes or forget to do assignments due to their workload. Moreover, these young people might be deceived by the advertisements of partime jobs which may result in losing their money without gaining anything.

For all reasons mentioned above, there are both pros and cons to students' doing part-time jobs. However, I am convinced that the advantages far outweigh the disadvantages. Therefore, students should take a chance to work part-time so as to gain more experiences and skills for their future jobs.

260 words – 7

Bản dịch Tiếng Việt:

Đi làm thêm hiện nay đã trở thành một hoạt động phổ biến đối với các bạn sinh viên. Bên cạnh những lợi ích mà nó mang lại, việc vừa làm vừa học cùng lúc cũng mang đến những nhiều vấn đề. Bài luận này sẽ thảo luận hai mặt của vấn đề trên và kèm theo quan điểm của cá nhân tôi.

Một mặt, việc đi làm thêm mang lại cho sinh viên rất nhiều lợi ích. Thứ nhất, sinh viên có thể tự mình tạo ra thu nhập. Điều này rất quan trọng cho những sinh viên vì các bạn có thể trang trải

một phần chi phí sinh hoạt, như vậy có thể giúp gia đình giảm một phần gánh nặng tài chính. Thứ hai, đi làm thêm sẽ giúp các bạn sinh viên mở rộng mối quan hệ của mình với những người tại nơi làm việc như đồng nghiệp, sếp. Nhờ vào điều đó, các bạn sẽ có nhiều cơ hội việc làm hơn khi ra trường nhờ sự giúp đỡ của những người quen biết. Ngoài ra, các bạn sinh viên có đi làm thêm cũng thường tự tin hơn các bạn khác khi họ đi làm chính thức sau khi tốt nghiệp

Mặt khác, việc đi làm thêm mang lại cho sinh viên nhiều bất. Một trong những khó khăn đầu tiên là đi làm thêm sẽ làm sinh viên sao nhãng việc học trên trường. Ví dụ, sinh viên có thể thấy mệt mỏi khi ngồi trên giảng đường sau quãng thời gian làm việc bên ngoài, một vài sinh viên có thể cúp tiết hoặc quên làm bài tập ở trường do quá ham đi làm. Một bất lợi khác là các bạn sinh viên có khả năng bị lừa đảo bằng những quảng cáo về các công việc hấp dẫn. Sinh viên dễ bị mất tiền oan, hoặc đi làm mà không được lợi ích gì, mất thời gian vô ích.

Kết luận, việc làm thêm cũng có những khía cạnh tích cực lẫn tiêu cực khác nhau. Theo quan điểm của tôi, thuận lợi của việc đi làm thêm là nhiều hơn so với bất lợi, nên sinh viên cũng nên tìm kiếm, chọn lọc những việc làm thêm có ích để trau dồi thêm kinh nghiệm và kỹ năng cho công việc trong tương lai

D. SPEAKING

Part I

Gợi ý: Trả lời rõ ràng vào thẳng vấn đề, có trọng tâm sau đó mở rộng thêm các ý từ 2-3-4 câu tùy tốc độ nói của mỗi người. Tổng thời gian lý tưởng cho câu hỏi phần này là 20-25s

- What do you do in your spare time?

Whenever I have free time, I usually listen to music. I am a big fan of pop music: *Son Tung MTP-hay trao cho anh, ...* It brings me simple sounds which help me to relax after hard - workings days. I also have an interest in reading books. You know, I usually read some comics to amuse myself. Well, my favorite comic book is Doreamom and I have a collection of these comics.

- **a big fan of:** thích
- **amuse myself:** vui vẻ, giải trí
- **comic:** truyện tranh

- Do you prefer spending your time alone or with others?

Well, instead of staying alone, I really like spending my time hanging out with my family and friends. They can give me much useful help in my work as well as interesting ideas to enjoy life. Staying beside them, I never feel alone with terrible mood. Sharing time with others makes my brain energetic and it works effectively later.

- **hang out:** đi chơi
- **terrible mood:** tụt mood (buồn)
- **energetic:** đầy năng lượng

- **effectively:** hiệu quả

- What are good hobbies and bad hobbies?

Oh, this is an interesting question. From my point of view, good hobbies are those that give us the opportunity to develop new skills. For example, reading books or travelling helps us to broaden our knowledge. Bad hobbies, well on the other hand, may result in our acquiring bad habits. Playing computer games can make us neglect our studies and work. Smoking do harm to our health.

- **broaden our knowledge:** mở mang kiến thức
- **neglect:** xao nhãng
- **harm:** có hại

- Do you enjoy playing computer games? Why/why not?

I am not a big fan of computer games because my eyesight is not good enough to sit in front of the computer screen for long hours to play games. Additionally, I dislike the imaginary characters and the unreal world in the computer games which do harm to the mental health of players.

- **imaginary characters:** nhân vật tưởng tượng
- **unreal world:** thế giới ảo
- **mental health:** thần kinh

- What kinds of games have you ever played? Why do you play these games?

I rarely play games but when I play games, I often choose quiz games with numerous questionnaires. Being a player in these games, I can practice how to response quickly, how to deal with obstacles under time pressure and how to logically think about a matter. Possibly, it would rather be helpful than violent ones.

- **quiz:** câu đố
- **numerous questionnaires:** nhiều câu hỏi
- **response:** phản hồi
- **obstacles:** vấn đề khó
- **logically think:** suy nghĩ logic
- **violent:** bạo lực

- Do you think computer games are good for small children? Why/why not?

Absolutely not. Concerning health problems, their eyesight will be negatively affected if they are addicted to playing computer games. Moreover, they may get mental disorder when playing computer games too much. Most importantly, game players become more aggressive and violent, causing conflicts and more crime in the community.

- **growth of kids:** sự phát triển của trẻ nhỏ
- **physical and mental health:** sức khỏe thể chất lẫn tinh thần
- **mental disorder:** rối loạn thần kinh
- **aggressive:** hung hăng
- **conflict:** xung đột
- **crime:** tội phạm

Part II

Tập trả lời theo một dàn bài mà bạn quen thuộc, sẽ dễ hơn nếu phân tích từng phương án và làm rõ ưu nhược điểm của từng phương án. Phương án được lựa chọn sẽ có nhiều lý do tích cực hơn.

Bài nói mẫu B2:

Well, if my friend wanted her English to be better, I would suggest her communicating with foreigners. There are some clear benefits following.

First of all, when she talks to people from English speaking countries, it can help her improve her speaking skill. She also has a chance to hear many stories from different countries in the world, which can broaden her horizon. An other reason is that there are more and more foreigners visiting our city, so it's very easy to find someone to practice English with, for example, she can go to some English cafés.

Speaking of watching films to learn English, actually it's a good way to expand her vocabulary, her listening skill can be improved a lot if she is a fan of it. However, I think it's kind of difficult for her to understand because she's just a beginner, she may be distracted from learning as well.

Finally, I have to admit that reading books can help her improve her reading skill, but it needs self-discipline and concentration which my friend doesn't have. So, this way may not for her.

To sum up, I believe the best way to learn English for my friend is to practice with foreigners.

self-discipline: tính kỉ luật

concentration: sự tập trung

Part III

*Đây là phần thi khó, cần học nhiều từ vựng và cấu trúc câu thường dùng để phân tích các khía cạnh khác nhau của một vấn đề, sự kiện như **thuận lợi, bất lợi, nguyên nhân, vấn đề, giải pháp**. Các chủ đề thường gặp là **công nghệ, môi trường, học tập, trường lớp, các vấn đề ở thành phố**. Lời khuyên cho các bạn ở trình độ B1, B2 là nên nói đơn giản, độ dài vừa phải, cố gắng diễn giải đầy đủ các ý đề bài đã cho, phần gạch chân là đề bài đã cung cấp. Bài tập này thuộc chủ đề học tập (có kết hợp 1 số từ chủ đề công nghệ) nên thí sinh cần chuẩn bị những từ vựng liên quan để trả lời tốt.*

Bài nói mẫu B2

Nowadays, learning on the Internet has become increasingly popular because of its great benefits, especially to students.

In the first place, online learning is very convenient. You know, students can study whenever and wherever they want. Only with a mobile phone or a computer connected to the Internet, they are able to get access to a **rich source of information** on almost any subjects that they're interested in.

Secondly, it is very affordable to study online. Well, students can do research using online resources at very **low cost**. Many websites even provide free access to their **huge source of materials**, this helps learners save a big amount of money when studying.

An other benefit is that students can study at their own place, they can save time and money to travel to formal classes.

Last but not least, online courses are more interesting thanks to the application of technology. It is true that technology is a powerful tool to engage students. It can make students more involved in the lesson due to the combination of sounds, images, games and so on.

In conclusion, studying on the Internet brings considerable benefits to learners.

- **rich source of information:** nguồn thông tin dồi dào
- **low cost:** chi phí rẻ
- **huge source of materials:** nguồn tư liệu khổng lồ

TEST 5

A. LISTENING

1C	2B	3B	4C	5C	6C	7B	8A		
9C	10C	11C	12D	13A	14C	15B	16B	17B	18D
19C	20B	21D	22B	23A	24D	25B	26A	27C	28C
29D	30D	31C	32A	33D	34A	35B			

B. READING

1B	2C	3A	4C	5B	6D	7A	8C	9C	10B
11C	12C	13C	14B	15C	16C	17B	18C	19D	20A
21D	22C	23B	24B	25A	26D	27C	28A	29B	30D
31B	32C	33B	34B	35C	36A	37 D	38A	39D	40B

THANK YOU